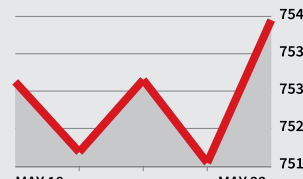


SENSEX 75415.35 (+231.99)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	23719.30	+64.60
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.35	+0.06
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.69	-0.51
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	157484.00	-419
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	266000.00	+1321



RECOVERY PATH.

Adani Group’s major concerns ease as legal uncertainties and funding pressures recede, says global brokerage Bernstein **p8**

AUTO FOCUS.

Updated Tata Punch.ev delivers premium features, stronger range and performance **p4**

QUICKLY.

MARKET APPETITE

Central Bank of India OFS subscribed 2.35 times



New Delhi: The offer-for-sale of the Central Bank of India on Friday approved a record surplus transfer of ₹2.87 lakh crore to the Central government for FY26. Last year, the reserve bank had transferred ₹2.69-lakh crore. “Despite the hefty dividend, markets may remain cautious amid rising risks of fiscal slippage, forex pressures and tighter policy expectations going ahead,” said Madhavi Arora, Chief Economist at Emkay Global Financial Services.

₹2,850 CRORE DEAL

Dalmia Bharat to buy JAL’s cement assets from Adani

Ahmedabad: Dalmia Bharat Ltd will invest ₹2,850 crore to acquire a 5.2 mtpa cement capacity portfolio and associated assets from Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL), as part of the insolvency resolution process being implemented under the Adani Group-led resolution plan. Its wholly owned arm Dalmia Cement (Bharat) Ltd executed a fresh business transfer agreement on May 21 with JAL and Adani Infra (India) Ltd. **p2**

RBI transfers record surplus of ₹2.87 lakh crore to Centre

BIG PAYOUT. Dividend to give near-term liquidity boost, but impact will depend on govt spending

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India on Friday approved a record surplus transfer of ₹2.87 lakh crore to the Central government for FY26. Last year, the reserve bank had transferred ₹2.69-lakh crore.

“Despite the hefty dividend, markets may remain cautious amid rising risks of fiscal slippage, forex pressures and tighter policy expectations going ahead,” said Madhavi Arora, Chief Economist at Emkay Global Financial Services. Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist at the Bank of Baroda, said the payout could alter the fiscal situation only if there are slippages on the expenditure or revenue side, “whether because of lower excise duty collections, higher subsidies or lower non-tax revenues such as support from oil marketing companies.”

RISK BUFFER

The RBI board decided to transfer ₹1.09 lakh crore to the Contingent Risk Buffer

FISCAL CUSHION

- The RBI transferred ₹1.09 lakh crore to the Contingent Risk Buffer (CRB), up sharply from ₹44,861.7 crore last year, at 6.5% of balance-sheet
- Its balance-sheet expanded 20.6% y-o-y to ₹91.97 lakh crore as of March 31, 2026
- Gross income rose 26.4% in FY26, while net income before risk provisioning stood at ₹3.96 lakh crore



(CRB) for FY26, sharply higher than ₹44,861.7 crore a year earlier, with the buffer at 6.5 per cent of the balance-sheet. Under the revised Economic Capital Framework, the RBI must maintain the CRB within a range of 4.5-7.5 per cent of its balance-sheet.

“A key reason for the larger payout was the reduction in the CRB from 7.5 per cent to 6.5 per cent. Since the RBI balance-sheet is around ₹91 lakh crore, the 1 percentage point reduction effectively released about ₹91,000 crore,” said Sachchidanand Shukla, Group Chief Economist at Larsen & Toubro.

The RBI’s balance-sheet expanded 20.6 per cent to ₹91.97 lakh crore as of March

31, 2026. Gross income rose 26.42 per cent year-on-year during FY26, while expenditure before risk provisions increased 27.6 per cent.

Net income before risk provisioning and transfers to statutory funds stood at ₹3.96 lakh crore, compared with ₹3.13 lakh crore in FY25.

BoB’s Sabnavis said that the balance-sheet expansion reflected both forex and open market operations, noting that the RBI had conducted a large number of OMOs, in which it bought government securities and earned interest income.

Emkay’s Arora estimated robust earnings from around \$180 billion of forex sales, offsetting higher provision-

ing and mark-to-market losses.

LIQUIDITY BOOST

Economists said that the dividend could provide a near-term liquidity boost, though the actual impact would depend on the pace of government spending in the coming months.

Core liquidity was at a surplus of ₹3 lakh crore at the end of April. Arora made a case for a more durable liquidity infusion of the magnitude of ₹7-8 lakh crore over FY27 due to leakage because of the persistent forex interventions by the RBI.

L&T’s Shukla said bond markets were likely to react positively in the near term due to improved fiscal arithmetic and liquidity conditions, though the relief could be temporary amid higher state fiscal deficits and rising global bond yields.

“Bond market yields could harden because the implication is that the RBI has delivered broadly what was expected. That means the fiscal position could remain under strain, and government borrowing may increase,” Sabnavis said.

‘Payout may offer limited cushion on subsidy burden, lower revenue visibility’

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The RBI’s payout to the Centre, 6.7 per cent higher than last year, is expected to provide only partial relief to government finances as rising subsidy burdens and lower revenue expectations linked to the West Asia crisis threaten to strain the FY27 fiscal arithmetic.

Economists remain divided over the extent of support the transfer will provide, with some viewing it as a useful buffer against higher expenditure pressures and others arguing that the payout may not prevent a breach of the fiscal deficit target.

BUDGET DEPENDENCE

In the FY27 Budget, the Centre had projected ₹3.16 lakh crore of non-tax revenue from ‘Dividend/Surplus of Reserve Bank of India, Nationalised Banks and Financial Institutions’, implying that the RBI transfer alone accounts for over 90 per cent of the BE.

However, West Asia tensions are expected to weigh on the Centre’s finances through both lower revenues and higher expenditure. Economists estimate that the fertilizer subsidy bill could rise by over ₹70,000 crore,



Analysts expect the fiscal position to remain under pressure due to expectations of higher fertilizer and fuel subsidies and lower tax collections and dividends from oil marketing companies

while the recent excise duty cuts on fuel may lead to a revenue loss exceeding ₹1 lakh crore.

“This is a marginal increase in non-tax revenues which will be useful to partly neutralise some of the expected increase in food, fertilizer and petroleum subsidies in the wake of the West Asian crisis,” said DK Srivastava, Chief Policy Advisor at EY India.

DK Pant, Chief Economist, India Ratings & Research, noted that the transfer would have been over ₹64,500 crore higher had the RBI maintained the contingency risk buffer at last year’s level.

The higher allocation to the contingency risk buffer would strengthen the central bank’s ability to intervene in financial markets, he said, adding that the surplus transfer would “reduce some

pressure on fiscal deficit”.

FISCAL RISKS

However, Upasna Bhardwaj, Chief Economist at Kotak Mahindra Bank, termed the surplus transfer lower than expected, thereby “limiting the levers for the government in terms of managing the fiscal slippage risks”, although she does not foresee risk of additional market borrowing for now.

Aditi Nayar, Chief Economist at ICRA, said the fiscal position is likely to remain under pressure due to expectations of higher fertilizer and fuel subsidies as well as lower tax collections and dividends from oil marketing companies. “We expect the Centre’s fiscal deficit target for FY27 of 4.3 per cent of GDP to be breached by 40 bps, assuming an average crude oil price of \$95/barrel during the fiscal,” she said.

‘Global uncertainty slows overseas remittances under LRS in FY26’

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Heightened global uncertainty and the geopolitical climate led to a marginal dip in India’s outward remittances under the Liberalised Remittance Scheme (LRS) in FY26.

As per RBI Bulletin data, the total outward remittances under LRS slipped 2 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to \$28.9 billion in FY26. In FY25, total LRS remittances stood at \$29.6 billion.

In an indication of tougher conditions for education abroad, the decline was led by a steep drop of over 20 per cent in remittances towards studies abroad at \$2.3 billion compared to \$2.9 billion.

Remittances towards international travel dropped about 3 per cent to \$16.5 billion. However, the reduction in these seg-

Outward remittances decline in FY26

	(\$ billion)	
	FY25	FY26
Total LRS remittances	29.6	28.9
Towards travel	16.9	16.4
Towards studies abroad	2.9	2.3
Towards investment in equity/debt	1.7	2.6

Source: RBI

ments was offset by a large increase in the remittances towards investment in foreign equity/debt, which grew 56 per cent y-o-y to \$2.7 billion in FY26.

In March, travel remittances fell to \$1.09 billion from \$1.13 billion in March 2025. Indicating a growing need to track outward foreign remittances by purpose, in its May Bulletin, the

RBI also provided a break up of the travel remittances based on the purpose of the travel.

Out of \$1.09 billion, the spends for holidays and settlement of credit card transactions abroad together made up \$0.62 billion. Travel for education (including fees, hostel expenses, etc.) made up \$ 0.45 billion.

LOW-COST DESTINATIONS

Analysts had told *businessline* earlier that a fall in spends for overseas education was because of tightening visa regulations in the US, coupled with weak job markets globally, especially for STEM roles. This meant that students were opting for new, lower-cost destinations, they added. Similarly, in case of travel, the depreciation of the rupee had been nudging Indians to travel to less expensive locations abroad.

Also read **p5**

At over 33 mt, India’s official wheat buy nears this year’s target

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Wheat procurement by the government this season has reached 33.39 million tonnes (mt) as on May 21.

This is about 1 million tonnes less than the target, but up 13 per cent from 29.64 mt in the corresponding period last year.

Last year, the government procured 30 mt of wheat, but with a higher production of 120.21 mt, this year’s purchase target has been fixed at 34.5 mt.

Due to a delayed start and the slow pace of purchase, the target looked an uphill task. But with pressure from the Opposition and farmer organisations, the government stepped up purchases.

Read more on **p10**

HILLS ARE BURNING



BATTLING THE BLAZE. A firefighter tries to control a fire that broke out in an Almora forest in Uttarakhand on Friday. The State has recorded 309 wildfires this year, affecting 257 hectares of forest area. Uttarakhand Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami on Friday ordered the recruitment of 1,000 forest guards to strengthen efforts to control raging wildfires across the State **ANI**

Delhi heatwave pushes gig workers to breaking point

Platforms say they are stepping up heat mitigation efforts for frontline workers

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

As Delhi’s temperature hovers around 44°C, gig workers delivering food, groceries and e-commerce parcels say the heatwave is pushing them to physical exhaustion even as the pressure to stay logged on and complete more trips leaves little room for rest.

DOWNSIDES

For platform workers, income is tied directly to each completed ride or delivery. Taking a break means losing out on incentives and daily earnings in a business where there are no fixed salaries, paid leave or guaranteed income buffers.

Coupled with this is the anxiety about algorithm-based penalisation by restriction of access to high-value orders, automated



Missing one delivery invites penalties, keeping workers logged on regardless of the weather **REUTERS**

lockouts that freeze accounts for hours if requests are skipped and disqualification from essential daily bonus tiers. “People are falling sick and anxious. But if we stop working, the income stops,” a delivery worker told *businessline*, not wishing to be identified.

Sangita (name changed) is a single mother supporting two children and aged in-laws. Her husband left

her some years ago. With no source of income, she trained as a masseuse and now works for Urban Company. That means lugging a heavy portable cot and other accessories for every client visit.

“You can’t stop,” she said, reflecting the precariousness of app-based work, especially in times of extreme weather stress.

SEEKING COVER

Shaik Salauddin of the Indian Federation of App-Based Transport Workers has written to the government, demanding the introduction of binding national heatwave protections for workers under the Code of Social Security, 2020.

Platforms say they are stepping up heat mitigation efforts for frontline workers. A Flipkart spokesperson said seasonal prepared-

ness and frontline well-being are important elements of its operating model. “Seasonal adaptations based on local conditions have been made to ensure adequate availability of hydration and refreshment options for wishmasters across hubs and during routes,” the spokesperson said.

According to Amazon India, advanced heat-index monitoring systems, structured breaks, job rotations, hydration guidelines, electrolyte supplements and first-aid readiness are built into the company’s daily operations.

Eternal, which owns Zomato and Blinkit, said it had strengthened insurance coverage and ramped up access to rest points and hydration facilities at dark stores and through collaboration with restaurant partners.

Quad Foreign Ministers to meet in Delhi on May 26; W.Asia war, assertive China top agenda

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

With the West Asia crisis prolonging, threatening global energy security and critical supply chains and China’s growing assertiveness in the Indo-Pacific region, India will host a crucial Quad Foreign Ministers’ meeting in the capital on May 26.

The Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) confirmed on Friday that Australian Foreign Minister Penny Wong, Japanese Foreign Minister Toshimitsu Motegi, and US Secretary of State Marco Rubio will all attend the meeting at the invitation of External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar.

“They will exchange views on advancing Quad cooperation across priority areas, review progress on ongoing Quad initiatives, and reflect on recent developments in



External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar **ANI**

the Indo-Pacific region and other international issues of mutual concern,” per an MEA statement.

WEST ASIA CONFLICT

The West Asia conflict, between the US/Israel and Iran, that is posing a threat to global energy security and supply as the blockade of the Strait of Hormuz continues, is set to be an important issue for discussion, a source tracking the matter said. Russia’s war on Ukraine,

The upcoming dialogue marks the first formal gathering since mid-2025 meeting in Washington

which has been ongoing for four years, may also be on the agenda, the source added.

The upcoming dialogue marks the first formal gathering of the Quad Foreign Ministers since their mid-2025 meeting in Washington.

Other items that are expected to be taken up for discussion include maritime security, critical technologies, cybersecurity, climate change, and supply chain resilience. The Quad Foreign Ministers are expected to deliberate on China’s growing assertiveness, in the Indo-Pacific particularly in the South China Sea. The Minis-

ters are likely to emphasise the need for strict adherence to international maritime laws and reinforce their commitment to maintaining freedom of navigation in these vital trade corridors, the source added.

BILATERAL MEETINGS

Wong, Motegi and Rubio are also scheduled to hold separate bilateral meetings with Jaishankar and call on Prime Minister Narendra Modi to discuss deeper security and economic ties, the MEA said.

On Friday, Tokyo confirmed that Foreign Minister Motegi will arrive in India on Monday for a comprehensive three-day visit. Washington announced a four-day itinerary for Rubio, beginning May 23.

His travel schedule includes official visits to Kolkata, Agra, and Jaipur, underscoring the deep and multi-faceted nature of the US-India partnership.

QUICKLY.

Ramco Systems sees 5X jump in Q4 net profit



Chennai: Ramco Systems, the software firm from Chennai's Ramco Group, reported a 5x jump in consolidated net profit of ₹25 crore for the quarter ended March 2026 against ₹5 crore in the same quarter last year. Revenue from operations for the quarter went up by 19.3 per cent to ₹185 crore from the ₹155 crore in Q4FY25. Revenue growth was primarily driven by the acceleration of recurring revenue, which grew by 15 per cent, the company said in a statement. For the full year FY26, consolidated net profit stood at ₹42 crore against a loss ₹34 crore in FY25. Revenue from operations stood at ₹708 crore (₹596 crore). The company's order bookings, as of March 2026, stood at \$51.7 million while the cash balance stood at \$13.3 million. **OUR BUREAU**

Disbursements drive Repco Home Fin Q4 net



Chennai: Repco Home Finance reported a standalone net profit of ₹129 crore in Q4 FY26, compared to ₹125 crore in Q4 FY25. Net interest income grew 16 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) to ₹207 crore in the quarter, compared to ₹178 crore in Q4 FY25. The performance was driven by increased lending as loan disbursements stood at ₹1,186 crore in Q4 FY26, a 22 per cent growth over Q4 FY25. **OUR BUREAU**

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Honda Cars India (HCIL) on Friday said it will introduce sedans and sports utility vehicles (SUVs), including compact SUVs with all powertrain options — flex-fuel and electric vehicles (EVs) — when the demand grows in the market. The company plans to launch 10 products by 2030 and six within this financial year, said top company officials. However, it will not bring back any hatchback to the Indian market and its compact sedan Amaze will remain as the entry-level car in its portfolio, they added. “We are looking at all the possibilities for the future... We always consider for options. For us, small car is the Amaze and now we are global looking at a sub 4-metre SUV for the Indian market. Our first priority has always been the domestic market and ex-

Dalmia Bharat to buy JAL’s cement assets for ₹2,850 cr

GOING STRONG. Dalmia Bharat’s total cement capacity will increase to 54.7 mtpa

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad



FRESH DEAL. Dalmia Cement (Bharat) Ltd executed a fresh business transfer deal on May 21 with Jaiprakash Associates Ltd and Adani Infra to acquire cement undertakings in MP and UP

Dalmia Bharat Ltd will invest ₹2,850 crore to acquire a 5.2 million tonne per annum (mtpa) cement capacity portfolio, along with associated assets from Jaiprakash Associates Ltd (JAL), as part of the insolvency resolution process being implemented under the Adani Group-led resolution plan. Its wholly owned subsidiary Dalmia Cement (Bharat) Ltd executed a fresh business transfer agreement on May 21 with Jaiprakash Associates Ltd and Adani Infra (India) Ltd for the acquisition of cement undertakings located at Rewa (Madhya Pradesh), Chunar, Churk and Sadwa in Uttar Pradesh, the company stated in a regulatory filing with the stock exchanges on Friday. The assets comprise an in-

tegrated unit at Rewa, grinding units at Chunar and Churk and a blending unit at Sadwa, together aggregating 5.2 MTPA cement capacity and 3.3 MTPA clinker capacity. **THERMAL POWER** The transaction also includes 99 MW of thermal power capacity across the facilities and railway siding in-

frastructure at Rewa and Chunar, along with a common railway siding at Churk, which is expected to support logistics efficiency and reduce transportation costs. The deal has been signed at an enterprise value of ₹2,850 crore and is expected to be completed within two weeks, after which the assets will be integrated into Dalmia Bharat’s operational

Hindalco Q4 net halves on one-time expense of ₹4,171 cr at Novelis plant

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Hindalco Industries, an Aditya Birla Group company, reported that its net profit in the March quarter more than halved to ₹2,597 crore against ₹5,284 crore logged in the same period last year, largely due to an one-time expense of ₹4,171 crore related to two fire incidents at Novelis’ Oswego plant in the US last year. Revenue was up 20 per cent at ₹78,133 crore (₹64,890 crore), while EBITDA increased 9 per cent

to ₹11,197 crore (₹10,296 crore) in the quarter under review. The company announced dividend of ₹5 a share and set the record date as July 10.

FIRE INCIDENTS Last year, there were two fire incidents at Novelis’ plant at Oswego in the US. Novelis will incur costs of ₹4,171 crore related to the repairs, clean-up and other expenses related to this event until the operations are fully-restored and this was recorded as exceptional expenses, said the company. Aluminium up-

Scorecard			(in ₹ cr)
	Q4 FY26	Q4 FY25	
Revenue	78,133	64,890	
Net profit	2,597	5,284	
EPS (Diluted) (₹)	11.67	23.75	

stream sales in India were up marginally at 3.39 lakh tonne (3.32 lt) and revenue increased to ₹11,418 crore (₹10,311 crore).

ALUMINIUM SALES EBITDA per tonne was up 4 per cent at \$1,756 (\$1,684). Downstream aluminium sales were up 18 per cent at

1.24 lakh tonne, while revenue jumped 35 per cent to ₹4,867 crore. EBITDA per tonne was down 6 per cent at \$226 as the Aditya FRP plant was being ramped up to its optimal levels. Copper metal sales were down 5 per cent at 1.28 lakh tonne. Revenue was up 52 per cent at ₹22,156 crore, while EBITDA increased to ₹907 crore (₹614 crore). The fall in TC/RCs was offset by strong operational performance and higher realisation in byproducts such as sulphuric acid.

3M India Q4 net profit zooms 201%

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Post-it notes-maker 3M’s India division recorded a net profit surge of 201.7 per cent on a year-on-year (y-o-y) basis in the fourth quarter of FY26 at ₹215 crore due to double-digit growth across major segments such as healthcare, industry, safety and transportation. Revenue from operations grew 16.77 per cent y-o-y to ₹1,399 crore in Q4FY26, while EBITDA grew 12.08 per cent y-o-y to ₹269 crore. Healthcare saw the maximum growth of 21.30 per cent y-o-y to ₹283 crore as domestic demand for medical equipment increased. This was followed by safety with 19.49 per cent growth at ₹455 crore, which was above the global average growth rate of the company in this sector. Consumer goods saw growth of 15.7 per cent at ₹135 crore and transport by 12.03 per cent at ₹518 crore.

segmented growth... The new segment, which is emerging strong, is the 4 meters and that is where Honda is focusing,” said Kunal Behl, Vice-President, Marketing and Sales, HCIL.

NEW PRODUCTS Meanwhile, Nakajima said India is among the top three focus markets to realise Honda’s future growth, which will be driven by a strong pipeline of new products and the company’s efforts are to achieve cost competitiveness. “This year is a landmark year for us with six strategic launches that will sharpen our competitive edge and reinforce our brand position in the market. Recently we announced that we will be launching new models under two categories — under 4 metres and the midsize category. Last time, in Japan, we mentioned 10 models, but currently we are counting more than 10 [by 2030],” he said.

GOING PLACES. (left to right) Kunal Behl, V-P, Marketing & Sales, HCIL; Takashi Nakajima, President & CEO, HCIL; and Yujiro Sujino, Director, Marketing & Sales

ports come secondary,” said Takashi Nakajima, President and CEO of Honda Cars India. On the West Asia crisis, he said there is not much change in the demand side in the Indian market, and the market is doing good because of the GST reduction since September last year. On the sedan market, the company said India still has a

strong market with CAGR of around 8.5 to 9 per cent over the last five years, and that is why Honda’s Amaze and City still have a strong demand. “The hatchback segment, five years ago, was contributing 40 per cent of the total industry, but now has gone down to 23 per cent, so there is a big change... India as a market is getting more matured and it’s getting more

Scorecard				(in ₹ crore)
	Q4 FY26	Q4 FY25	% change	
Net profit	1,520	1,362.15	11.5	
Revenue	6,080	5,241	16.0	
EPS (basic) (₹)	55.40	49.69	11.5	

₹6,080 crore during the quarter under review, against ₹5,241 crore in the corresponding quarter in FY25. For the full financial year FY26, the company reported a jump of 25 per cent y-o-y in consolidated net profit at ₹5,634 crore, compared to ₹4,504 crore in FY25. Similarly, the consolidated revenue from operations grew 24 per cent y-o-y to ₹23,407.56 crore last year, compared to ₹18,870 crore in the previous financial year. **ENFIELD SALES** Royal Enfield recorded its highest-ever annual sales, surpassing 1.2 million units

in FY26, marking the second consecutive year it has crossed one million in annual sales. Total volumes stood at 12,27,977 units, a 22 per cent y-o-y increase, the company said, adding that domestic sales grew 23 per cent to 11,07,343 units, while international volumes grew 20 per cent with 1,20,634 motorcycles exported. “FY26 has been an exceptional year for Eicher Motors and Royal Enfield, marked by strong growth, record volumes and a continued focus on our global ambitions during our 125th anniversary. We also marked a major milestone in April 2026 with our entry into the electric mobility space via

the launch of the Flying Flea C6. International business remains a key priority as we steadily deepen our presence in markets like Brazil,” said B Govindarajan, Managing Director, Eicher Motors, and Chief Executive Officer, Royal Enfield.

GLOBAL IDENTITY This year, the company also took the brand into new cultural spaces, ranging from gaming collaborations to marquee community rides, to strengthen its global identity, he said. “To power our next phase of growth, we have committed to significant investments, including the brown-field capacity expansion at Cheyyar with ₹958 crore and our strategic expansion plan at Tada in Andhra Pradesh, both aimed at building future-ready capacity to support our long-term projected growth,” added Govindarajan.

TTK Prestige FY26 net profit soars 45%

Our Bureau
Bengaluru



Bengaluru-based kitchen and home appliances company TTK Prestige swung to a net profit of ₹36.08 crore in Q4 FY26 from a loss of ₹42.39 crore in the corresponding quarter in the previous financial year. This was primarily aided by higher revenue and improved operating performance. The net profit for the full financial year of 2026 was recorded at ₹156.67 crore, up 45 per cent from ₹108.01 crore in the previous fiscal. Revenue from operations shot up 12.26 per cent y-o-y to ₹729.17 crore, an increase from ₹649.56 crore in Q4 FY25. The revenue for the full financial year of 2026 saw a 9.53 per cent increase at ₹2,973 crore. The company introduced a range of innovative go-to-

steady growth, supported by resilient domestic demand, urbanisation and evolving consumer preferences across categories such as pressure cookers, cookware, gas stoves and small appliances, said the company. Despite headwinds such as supply chain disruptions, commodity price fluctuations and geopolitical uncertainties, the industry sustained growth on the back of robust domestic demand. Replacement purchases, higher incomes, organised retail growth, modular kitchen adoption and increased non-gas appliance demand supported the momentum. Profit before exceptional items and tax rose to ₹58.39 crore in Q4 FY26 from ₹45.38 crore a year earlier. The quarter also included a one-time exceptional loss of ₹1.82 crore linked to labour code-driven employee benefit adjustments. TTK

Prestige posted 9.6 per cent sales growth in FY26, supported by growth across product categories and sales channels, ending its recent low-growth phase. **KEY SEGMENTS** The company maintained leadership in key segments, while new products contributed over 30 per cent of sales. Commenting on the performance, Venkatesh Vijayaraghavan, MD and CEO, speaking in a post quarter investor call, said: “Overall, the pressure of the supply chain, the pressures of rising raw material prices and also the uncertainty of geopolitical tensions continue to weigh on this industry as well as it is being seen across the country.” From a TTK Prestige perspective, the company had a Q4 growth of around 14.4 per cent for the domestic market, he added.

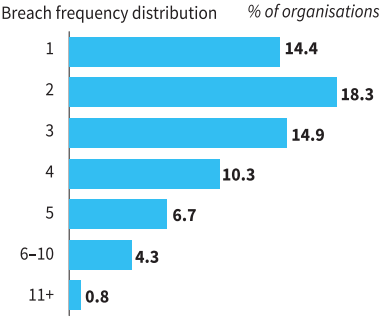
VISUALLY.

Compiled by Yashaswani Chauhan | Graphic: Visveswaran V

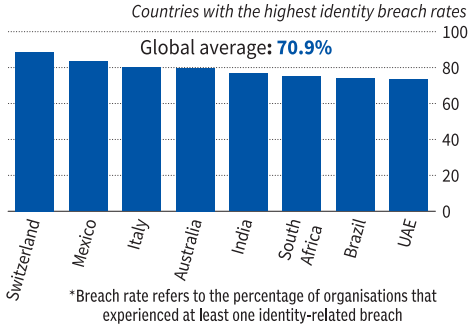
Stolen identities fuel cyberattacks

Identity-related breaches are becoming a major cybersecurity threat globally, with hackers increasingly exploiting stolen credentials, weak machine identities, and third-party access systems. The State of Identity Security 2026 report found that more than 70 per cent of organisations suffered identity breach last year, with average recovery costs crossing \$1.64 million. The report is based on a survey of 5,000 IT and cybersecurity leaders across 17 countries

Most companies face at least two breaches



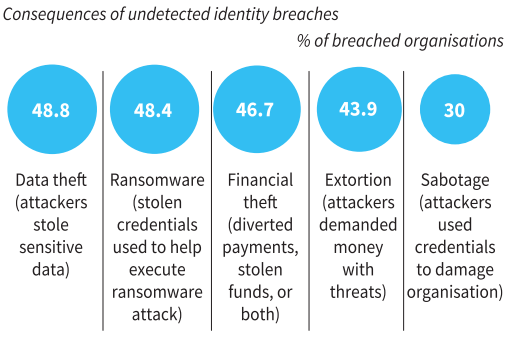
India reports higher breach rates* than the global average



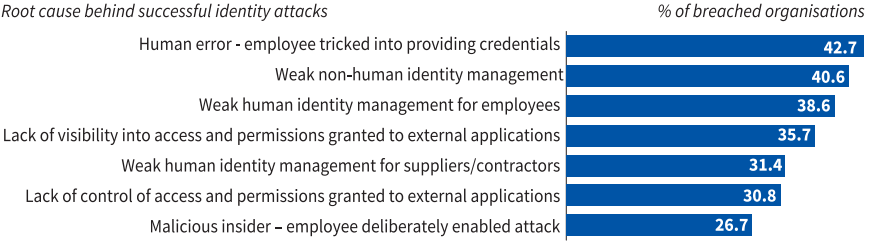
Energy and government sectors face the highest exposure

Industry-wise breach rates	Breach rate (%)
Energy, oil/ gas and utilities	80.3
Central/Federal government	78.4
Construction and property	76.1
Manufacturing and production	73.6
Retail	72
Lower Education	71.1
Financial services	71
Media, leisure & entertainment	70.9

Data theft and ransomware remain the biggest fallout



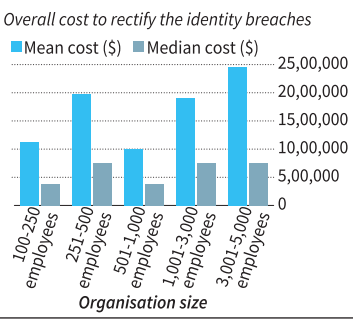
Weak machine identities emerging as major cybersecurity gap



Companies are still not monitoring digital identities frequently enough

Activity	Review identity governance policies	Rotate/ audit service accounts and NIHS	Monitor for credential leaks	Check for common passwords	Monitor for unusual logins
Continually	10.5	11.1	17.9	19.2	24.1
Weekly	22.9	23.1	26.6	24.6	25.3
Quarterly	33.4	37.7	31.4	30.4	28.2
6-Monthly	22.6	19.7	16.6	18	15.8
Yearly+	10.1	7.5	6.6	6.1	6.2

Cyber attack recovery costs rise sharply for larger organisations



Source: The State of Identity Security 2026 Report

‘Honda to launch 10 cars by 2030, six this year’

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi



GOING PLACES. (left to right) Kunal Behl, V-P, Marketing & Sales, HCIL; Takashi Nakajima, President & CEO, HCIL; and Yujiro Sujino, Director, Marketing & Sales

Honda Cars India (HCIL) on Friday said it will introduce sedans and sports utility vehicles (SUVs), including compact SUVs with all powertrain options — flex-fuel and electric vehicles (EVs) — when the demand grows in the market. The company plans to launch 10 products by 2030 and six within this financial year, said top company officials. However, it will not bring back any hatchback to the Indian market and its compact sedan Amaze will remain as the entry-level car in its portfolio, they added. “We are looking at all the possibilities for the future... We always consider for options. For us, small car is the Amaze and now we are global looking at a sub 4-metre SUV for the Indian market. Our first priority has always been the domestic market and ex-

Manali Petrochemicals’ Q4 net profit more than doubles on exceptional gain

Our Bureau
Chennai

Manali Petrochemicals Ltd, the Chennai-based petrochemical manufacturer, more than doubled its consolidated net profit at ₹29 crore for the fourth quarter ended March 31, 2026, against ₹11 crore for the corresponding quarter last year. Revenue was up 23 per cent at ₹293 crore (₹230 crore). During the quarter, the company said there was a gain on divestment of Notedome Ltd and its subsidiary Notedome Europe GmbH, amounting to ₹52 crore (net of transfer expenses incurred), and this has been recognised as exceptional item. For FY26, the consolidated net profit increased by over four times to ₹130 crore (₹29 crore) on a 14 per cent increase in revenue at ₹786 crore (₹647 crore).

Q4 AT A GLANCE

- Net profit rose to ₹29 crore (₹11 crore)
- Revenue stands at ₹293 crore (₹230 crore)
- Board recommends a dividend of ₹0.50/share for FY26

company reported a nine-fold increase in net profit at ₹27 crore in Q4 against ₹3 crore on a 50 per cent increase in revenue at ₹248 crore (₹164 crore). For FY26, the company reported a standalone net profit of ₹35 crore on a net loss of ₹8 crore for the previous year on a 21 per cent increase in revenue at ₹786 crore (₹647 crore).

DIVIDEND PROPOSAL The board of MPL has recommended a dividend of ₹0.50 per share (10 per cent) for FY26, subject to approval

of the members. Ashwin Muthiah, Chairman of MPL and Founder Chairman of AM International, Singapore, said the March quarter performance was good despite broader macroeconomic pressures, particularly rising input costs and unhindered imports. Improved raw-material efficiencies, better realisations and contributions from overseas subsidiaries supported the results. “It reflects our continuous focus on internal cost discipline, productivity gains and the strategic shift towards premium speciality chemical solutions,” he said. “Given the ongoing geopolitical uncertainties, we remain cautiously optimistic in the near term,” he added. The company said that the holding company (MPL) received an insurance claim of ₹8 crore towards the stocks affected by Cyclone Michaung in October 2025.

Eicher Motors Q4 net profit jumps to ₹1,520 crore

S Ronendra Singh
New Delhi

Led by strong volume growth and focus on global products, Eicher Motors Ltd (EML) on Friday reported a consolidated net profit of ₹1,520 crore for the fourth quarter ended March 31 (Q4 FY26), recording a year-on-year (y-o-y) growth of 11.5 per cent, compared to ₹1,362.15 crore in the same period in the previous year. Consolidated total revenue from operations also grew 16 per cent y-o-y to

₹6,080 crore during the quarter under review, against ₹5,241 crore in the corresponding quarter in FY25. For the full financial year FY26, the company reported a jump of 25 per cent y-o-y in consolidated net profit at ₹5,634 crore, compared to ₹4,504 crore in FY25. Similarly, the consolidated revenue from operations grew 24 per cent y-o-y to ₹23,407.56 crore last year, compared to ₹18,870 crore in the previous financial year.

in FY26, marking the second consecutive year it has crossed one million in annual sales. Total volumes stood at 12,27,977 units, a 22 per cent y-o-y increase, the company said, adding that domestic sales grew 23 per cent to 11,07,343 units, while international volumes grew 20 per cent with 1,20,634 motorcycles exported. “FY26 has been an exceptional year for Eicher Motors and Royal Enfield, marked by strong growth, record volumes and a continued focus on our global ambitions during our 125th anniversary. We also marked a major milestone in April 2026 with our entry into the electric mobility space via

the launch of the Flying Flea C6. International business remains a key priority as we steadily deepen our presence in markets like Brazil,” said B Govindarajan, Managing Director, Eicher Motors, and Chief Executive Officer, Royal Enfield.

GLOBAL IDENTITY This year, the company also took the brand into new cultural spaces, ranging from gaming collaborations to marquee community rides, to strengthen its global identity, he said. “To power our next phase of growth, we have committed to significant investments, including the brown-field capacity expansion at Cheyyar with ₹958 crore and our strategic expansion plan at Tada in Andhra Pradesh, both aimed at building future-ready capacity to support our long-term projected growth,” added Govindarajan.

businessline.

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QUICKLY.

Forex kitty drops
\$8 billion to \$689 billion



Mumbai: The country's forex reserves dropped \$8.094 billion to \$688.894 billion during the week ended May 15, the Reserve Bank of India said on Friday. The overall reserves had jumped by \$6.295 billion to \$696.988 billion during the week ended May 8. For the week ended May 15, foreign currency assets, a major component of the reserves, decreased by \$6.483 billion to \$545.904 billion, the central bank's data showed. Value of gold reserves also declined \$1.536 billion to \$119.317 billion during the week, the RBI said. [PTI](#)

RBI injects ₹81,590 crore liquidity via VRR auction

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India on Friday injected ₹81,590 crore transient liquidity into the banking system through a three-day variable rate repo auction. In a release, the RBI said the funds were infused at a 5.26 per cent cut-off rate. Meanwhile, the RBI said it will conduct four-day VRR auction for ₹1.50 lakh crore on May 25. [PTI](#)

Central Bank of India OFS over-subscribed 2.35 times

SELL-OFF BEGINS. This is first offer-for-sale in a PSU this fiscal

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The offer-for-sale of the Central Bank of India on Friday was over-subscribed by 2.35 times as non-retail investors showed optimism. With this, the government has decided to exercise the green shoe option and thus 8 per cent of its stake is being offloaded.

The offer price is ₹31, while share prices closed at ₹31.30 on Friday, which is over 7 per cent lower than previous closing.

“Offer-for-sale in Central Bank of India received enthusiastic response from investors and was over-subscribed 2.35 times on the first day. The government has decided to exercise the entire green shoe option,” Secretary in the Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM), Arunish Chawla said in a social media post.

Further, he said that retail investors and employees get to bid on May 25.

This is first OFS in a public sector institution during the current fiscal year. At the floor price, the government can earn over ₹2,244 crore. The sale of the entire 8 per cent will bring down the government's stake to 81.27 per



GOOD RESPONSE. Retail investors and staff get to bid on May 25

cent. This means another 6.27 per cent will be required to be sold to meet the minimum public shareholding norm, as suggested by market regulator SEBI.

On April 30, the bank reported a 30 per cent year-on-year (y-o-y) decline in fourth quarter (Q4FY26) standalone net profit at ₹724 crore against ₹1,034 crore in the year-ago quarter as it took a one-time impact of recognition of Deferred Tax Asset (DTA). The one-time impact of DTA recognition at about 25 per cent as against about 35 per cent amounted to ₹632 crore. In FY26, the bank's standalone net profit was up about 15 per cent y-o-y at ₹4,369 crore (₹3,785 crore in FY25).

INTERIM DIVIDEND

The bank's board approved fourth interim dividend of ₹0.60 per equity share having face value of ₹10 each for

FY26. The board also approved capital raising plan for FY27 aggregating to ₹7,000 crore via through equity and debt.

Net interest income in the reporting quarter was up 18 per cent y-o-y at ₹4,002 crore (₹3,399 crore in the year ago period). Other income, including fee-based income, treasury income and recovery in written-off accounts, declined 33 per cent y-o-y to ₹1,150 crore (₹1,714 crore).

Loan loss provisions declined 22 per cent y-o-y to ₹647 crore (₹830 crore). Net interest margin declined to 3.07 per cent against 3.40 per cent in the year ago period. GNPA's position improved to 2.67 per cent of gross advances as at March-end 2026 against 3.18 per cent as at March-end 2025.

Net NPA position, too, improved a shade to 0.49 per cent of net advances against 0.55 per cent.

India, Cyprus sign six pacts to strengthen ties across mobility, innovation, education

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India and Cyprus signed six agreements on Friday, including one on a Comprehensive Framework of Cooperation on Mobility, for easier movement of skilled workers and students.

In their bilateral consultations on Friday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Cyprus President Nikos Christodoulides elevated their ties to a strategic partnership and unveiled a five-year roadmap for defence cooperation.

“Welcoming the signing of the MoU on Comprehensive Framework of Cooperation on Mobility and the launch of a pilot European Union Legal Gateway Office in India, the leaders noted its role in promoting legal pathways for movement of professionals, skilled workforce and students and strengthening people-to-people ties between India and the EU,” per a joint statement issued after the bilateral meeting.

The agreements signed by the two sides also include ones for deeper cooperation in areas of innovation, technology, education, culture as well as a joint working group on counter-terrorism.

Modi and Christodoulides also highlighted the oppor-



STRATEGIC ALLIANCE. Prime Minister Narendra Modi with President of the Republic of Cyprus Nikos Christodoulides in New Delhi on Friday [SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA](#)

tunities that will arise through the implementation of the historic India-EU FTA concluded earlier this year and implementation of the ambitious India-Middle East-Europe Economic Corridor.

“Cyprus not only currently holds the Presidency of the European Union Council but is also emerging as an important investment gateway between India and the whole of Europe,” Modi said.

“Cyprus is one of India's top 10 investors; over the

past decade, investment from Cyprus to India has almost doubled. Trust has grown between the two countries,” he added.

NEW AVENUES

Modi noted in his statement that the strategic partnership will unlock commercial capital and open new avenues for Indian companies in Cyprus's infrastructure, energy, and agriculture sectors, while simultaneously boosting investment in India's booming shipping and maritime industries.

“The relationship between India and Cyprus has stood the test of time and again, with today's decision to upgrade the ties to strategic partnership, we are going to give new ambition and new momentum to our relationship,” he said.

Modi said Indian professionals and students living in Cyprus are strengthening ties between the two countries and the two sides would soon conclude a comprehensive Migration and Mobility Partnership, as well as a Social Security Agreement.

‘Venezuelan President unlikely to visit India next week’

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

Venezuela's interim President Delcy Rodriguez is unlikely to visit India amid the postponement of the first International Big Cat Alliance (IBCA) summit, scheduled early next month, due to the Ebola outbreak in Africa, sources said.

US Secretary of State Marco Rubio had mentioned Rodriguez's possible visit to India next week while talking to the American media on Thursday before departing for his diplomatic trip to Sweden and India.

“We also think there's op-

portunities with Venezuelan oil. In fact, it's my understanding that the interim President of Venezuela will be travelling to India next week as well,” Rubio said while pitching for India-US energy cooperation.

While the Ministry of External Affairs has not commented on the statement, sources close to the development said that Rodriguez was not visiting. “No, the Venezuelan interim President is not visiting India next week,” the source said.

Rodriguez was reportedly scheduled to visit New Delhi next week to attend the inaugural IBCA summit on June 1-2.

India blocks China's request for WTO dispute panel on IT, solar

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India has officially blocked China's first request for the setting up of a dispute settlement panel at the WTO challenging its tariffs on specific high-tech goods and certain measures within its Solar Module Programme that incentivise local value addition.

“At the WTO's dispute settlement body (DSB) meeting on Friday, Beijing noted that it was not able to reach a mutually satisfactory solution in the consultations with India that were held on the issue and it had to, therefore, request for the panel,” a

Geneva-based official said.

While India was able to block China's request for a dispute settlement panel this time, WTO rules specify that a country can't do so for a second time if the request is repeated by the complainant at a subsequent meeting of the DSB.

CUSTOMS DUTIES

Beijing alleges that New Delhi imposes customs duties on about a dozen imported IT products, including smartphones, that exceed



the bound rates established in India's WTO commitments. It says India is supposed to maintain zero tariffs on the identified IT goods. But India maintains that these products do not fall under its zero tariff commitments under the IT Agreement of 1996 as these

didn't exist then. China also claims that India's Solar Module Programme violates WTO rules by offering cash grants to domestic producers contingent on local value addition requirements. Beijing argues these incentives discriminate against foreign imports and constitute illegal incentives tied to the use of domestic goods.

India expressed regret over China's request for a WTO dispute panel and declined to accept it. It noted that it had engaged in exten-

sive consultations in good faith to reach a mutually satisfactory resolution, expressing surprise that Beijing had failed to genuinely consider the context of the policies, the source said. India strongly maintained that all the measures in question are fully compliant with WTO law.

Once the WTO's Dispute Settlement Body establishes the panel, it will hear arguments from both nations before issuing its final ruling. However, if either country

appeals the decision, the case will effectively enter a legal vacuum. Because the WTO Appellate Body currently lacks the required quorum of judges to function — due to a prolonged deadlock over appointments — any appeal will land in a permanent backlog, leaving the dispute unresolved indefinitely.

With a dysfunctional Appellate Body, an unfavourable decision by the dispute panel will not lead to any penalties on India if it decides to appeal it.



GUJARAT ENERGY TRANSMISSION CORPORATION LIMITED
REGISTERED & CORPORATE OFFICE, SARDAR PATEL VIDYUT BHAVAN,
RACECOURSE, VADODARA – 390 007
www.getcogujarat.com

TENDER NOTICE NO. ACE (P&C): TN – 03: 2026-27

[A] CIVIL: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ CIVIL - 612, 613, 614, 615, 616, 617, 618, 619, 620:- (1) Construction of Control Room Building (FF), Foundations, Cable Trench, Comp. Wall, RCC Road & misc. civil works on pile foundations at 66 kV Pipodara-3 S/s, Ta.-Mangrol & Dist. Surat & 02 Nos. of opposite bay at 220 kV Kim S/s under Bharuch circle, (2) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, C'Wall, RCC Road & Misc. Civil works etc. at 66 kV Khengarpara S/s Ta. Tharad, Dist. Banaskantha under Palanpur Circle, (3) Construction of Retaining cum compound wall, Area Grading, Earthwork for Embankment & Soil Improvement at proposed 66 kV Talaja Chokdi S/s, Ta. Veraval-Patan, Dist. Gir Somnath under Junagadh Circle, (4) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, Comp. wall, RCC Road, Yard water supply, Watchman cabin etc. at 66 kV Bhadaj-2 S/s & Other end of any 66 kV S/s Ta. Ghatlodia, Dist. Ahmedabad Under Nadiad Circle, (5) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, precast Compound Wall, RCC Road & Misc. civil works at 66 kV Lalavadar S/s, Ta. & Dist. Amreli under Amreli Circle, (6) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, Compound Wall, RCC Road etc. at 66 kV Khatiyavant S/s, and 02 number of opposite end Feeder Bay at 220 kV Kawant S/s Ta. Kawant, Dist. Chhotaudepur under Construction Division Jambuva under Jambuva Circle, (7) Construction of pile foundations for 66 kV D/C tower for transmission line from 66 kV Dhordo to 66 kV Mota Rann S/s Ta. Bhuj, Dist. Kutch under Anjar Circle, (8) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, Compound Wall, RCC Road, etc. at 66 kV Sevasi-2 S/s Ta. & Dist. Vadodara and 2 Nos. of Opposite end feeder bays at 66 kV S/s under Construction Division Jambuva under Jambuva Circle, (9) Construction of Control Room Building, Foundations, Cable Trench, Compound Wall, RCC Road, etc. at 66 kV Ankodiya S/s Ta. & Dist. Vadodara and 2 Nos. of Opposite end feeder bays at 66 kV S/s under Construction Division Jambuva under Jambuva Circle.

[B] LINE: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ E-451, 460, 461, 464/ UP/RATING/ TL/ 66kV/ 132kV/ 220kV/ S&E:- (1) Supply, installation, testing & commissioning of conversion of (i) 66 kV Jarod - Amliyara S/C line (ii) 66 kV Gotri - Vidyutnagar 1&2 D/C line (iii) 66 kV Karjan- Kashipura S/C line (iv) 66 kV Jambuva B - Dabhoi S/C line (v) 66 kV Karjan - Gotri B Line-1 & 2 D/C line (Karjan & Gotri Jurisdiction) (vi) 66 kV Karjan - Gotri-B 1&2 D/C line tap to Atladara (tap portion) (vii) 66 kV Karjan - Gotri-B Line-1&2 D/C line tap to Makarpura (tap portion including Vadsar LILO Portion) (viii) 66 kV Sankheda - Rustamura S/C line (ix) 66 kV Nandesari-Mogar-2-ND1 S/C line (x) 66 kV Gorwa - Chhani A 1&2 D/C line (xi) 66 kV Sama - Chhani-A S/C line (xii) 66 kV Amaliyara - Chhani-A S/C line with ACSR DOG conductor into equivalent HTLS Conductor (Equivalent weight of ACSR DOG conductor with Higher Ampacity) of Jambuva Circle, (2) Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 132 kV D/C Jambuva – Itola TSS line on 132 kV D/C Panther tower with ACSR Panther Conductor & 48F OPGW cable having route length of 7.47 km for drawl of 60 MW Power by Western Railway for 132 kV Itola TSS under LTOA – Deposit work thereof under Option – 1A under Construction Division Jambuva of Jambuva circle on turnkey basis, (3) Supply, Erection, Testing & Commissioning of 66 kV D/C line on D/C panther tower with AL-59 Conductor (Eq. Wt. to ACSR Panther Conductor) from 400 kV Mevasa substation to 66 kV Moda substation package-2 from AP-41/1 to AP-75 having Overhead line length 15.59Rkm under Anjar Circle. (Only OH Portion), (4) supply, Installation, testing & commissioning of conversion of 220 kV Dahej - Haldarwa line-1 & 220 kV Dahej- Haldarwa line-2 of Bharuch Circle with ACSR Zebra Conductor into equivalent HTLS Conductor (Equivalent weight of Zebra Conductor with Higher Ampacity).

[C] SUBSTATION: ACE (P&C)/ CONTRACTS/ E-429, 450:- (1) Design, engineering, manufacturing, supply, erection, testing & commissioning of 01Nos. of 220/132 kV 150MVA Transformer No-5 Bay at 400 kV Asoj S/s under Jambuva circle on EPC basis excluding Civil works, (2) Supply, Erection, Testing, and commissioning of 66 kV equipment's & materials on Turnkey basis including civil works for 66 kV Substations and associated transmission lines (OH only) (Package-3 i.e., Mehsana Zone and Surendranagar Circle).

Above tenders are available on website www.getcogujarat.com (for view and download only) & tender.nprocure.com (for view, download and online tender submissions).

Note: Bidders are requested to be in touch with our websites till opening of these tenders.

Date: 23/05/2026 **I/c. Additional Chief Engineer (Procurement & Contracts)**



THE RAMCO CEMENTS LIMITED
Regd. Office: “Ramamandiram”, Rajapalayam-626 117.
Corporate Office: 98-A, Dr. Radhakrishnan Salai, Chennai 600 004.
CIN :L26941TN1957PLC003566; E-mail: ksn@ramcocements.co.in

EXTRACT OF CONSOLIDATED AUDITED STATEMENT OF PROFIT AND LOSS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026
Rs. in Crores

S.No.	Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
		Audited (refer Note No. 7)	Un-Audited	Audited (refer Note No. 7)	Audited	
		31-03-2026	31-12-2025	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-03-2025
1.	Total Income	2,622.08	2,122.86	2,409.72	9,070.22	8,559.57
2.	Net Profit before exceptional items and tax	99.16	4.07	35.32	317.93	119.90
3.	Exceptional Items [Refer Note No.5]	74.17	479.00	10.83	553.17	199.41
4.	Net Profit for the period before tax	173.33	483.07	46.15	871.10	319.31
5.	Net Profit for the period after Tax attributable to - Equity shareholders of the Parent - Non-Controlling Interest Total	150.69 0.03 150.72	385.59 0.04 385.63	27.41 (1.76) 25.65	698.65 0.14 698.79	272.65 (3.08) 269.57
6.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period after tax attributable to - Equity shareholders of the Parent - Non-Controlling Interest Total	147.15 0.03 147.18	386.06 0.04 386.10	3.05 (1.86) 1.19	699.17 0.16 699.33	282.88 (3.10) 259.78
7.	Paid up Equity Share Capital	23.63	23.63	23.63	23.63	23.63
8.	Other Equity				8,069.88	7,418.02
9.	Securities Premium Account				50.59	50.59
10.	Net worth				8,093.88	7,442.14
11.	Paid up Debt Capital				3,852.05	4,652.10
12.	Capital Redemption Reserve				1.63	1.63
13.	Debenture Redemption Reserve				-	-
14.	Debt-Equity Ratio (in multiples)				0.48	0.63
15.	Debt Service Coverage Ratio (in multiples)				1.19	1.18
16.	Interest Service Coverage Ratio (in multiples)				3.04	2.40
17.	Earnings Per share of Re. 1/- each (Rs. p) (Not Annualized) Basic: Diluted:	6.38 6.38	16.31 16.31	1.16 1.16	29.56 29.56	11.53 11.53

Notes:-

- The above is an extract of the Quarterly Audited Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly Audited Financial Results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges at www.bseindia.com, and www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website at <https://www.ramcocements.in/investors/financials>
- For the other line items referred in regulation 52(4), 54(2) & (3) of Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015, pertinent disclosures have been made to the stock exchanges and can be accessed on the websites of the stock exchanges viz. www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com and that of the Company's website <https://www.ramcocements.in/investors/financials>
- The financial results have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) prescribed under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with relevant rules thereunder and in terms of regulations 33 & 52 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (as amended). The said financial results were reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their Meetings held on 22-05-2026.
- The Board of Directors have recommended a dividend of Rs.2.50/- per equity share of Re.1/- each for the financial year 2025-26
- Exceptional Items comprises of -

Rs. in Crores

Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
	Audited [Refer Note No.7]	Un-Audited	Audited [Refer Note No.7]	Audited	
	31-03-2026	31-12-2025	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-03-2025
(a) Profit on sale of investments (after consolidation adjustments)	-	-	-	-	149.70
(b) Profit on sale of surplus lands	67.90	505.62	10.83	573.52	49.71
(c) Impact on account of Social Security Code, 2025 due to Past Service Cost	6.27	(26.62)	-	(20.35)	-
Total	74.17	479.00	10.83	553.17	199.41

6. Key Standalone financial information

Particulars	Quarter Ended			Year Ended	
	Audited [Refer Note No.7]	Un-Audited	Audited [Refer Note No.7]	Audited	
	31-03-2026	31-12-2025	31-03-2025	31-03-2026	31-03-2025
Total Income	2,618.32	2,119.10	2,404.90	9,055.92	8,539.10
Net Profit before tax	176.89	485.63	49.26	879.23	465.74
Net Profit after tax	146.39	386.91	30.99	693.62	417.39

7. The figures for the quarter ended 31-03-2026 and 31-03-2025 are the balancing figures between audited results in respect of full financial year and published year to date upto the third quarter of the relevant financial year.

8. The Previous period figures have been re-grouped/re-stated wherever necessary

For THE RAMCO CEMENTS LIMITED

Chennai
22-05-2026



P.R.VENKETRAMA RAJA
MANAGING DIRECTOR

QUICKLY.

Skoda Epiq unveiled with two battery options



The Czech brand has revealed details of its upcoming all-electric compact SUV, set to broaden its EV portfolio. It is based on the MEB+ platform. The Epiq will be offered with two battery options — a 38.5-kWh LFP pack and a larger 55-kWh NMC unit — paired with three power outputs ranging from 85 kW to 155 kW. The top-spec Epiq 55 sprints from 0-100 kph in 7.4 seconds and offers a claimed 430-km range. Fast charging of up to 133 kW allows a 10-80 per cent charge in roughly 23 minutes.

Mercedes-AMG unveils most ambitious electric sportscar



The German marque has revealed the GT 4-door coupe, its first bespoke EV built on the new AMG.EA platform. Power comes from a three-motor setup — two at the rear and one at the front — producing up to 860 kW in GT 63 guise. Paired with a 106-kWh battery and 800-V architecture, the flagship sprints from 0-100 kph in 2.1 seconds and claims up to 700 km of range. Ultra-fast 600-kW charging enables a 10-80 per cent top-up in just 11 minutes, while AMG has even engineered a simulated V8 soundtrack to retain its trademark drama.

Suzuki Burgman 150 launched in Columbia



Suzuki has introduced a larger and more premium take on its maxi-scooter line-up. Power comes from a 149 cc air-cooled single-cylinder engine producing 14.2 bhp and 1.46 kg-m, paired with a CVT. The scooter rides on 14-inch wheels and gets features such as a TFT display, keyless ignition, dual-channel ABS and traction control. This could certainly be a tempting proposition for the Indian market, so watch this space.

@TheMotorGram



Packs a Punch

UPPER CUT. The Tata Punch.ev builds on its strong foundations to make a compelling EV that punches above its weight

Ruman Devmane

So far, the sub-compact-SUV class hasn't seen a more convincing entry than the Tata Punch. This applies even more strongly in EV form, where the Tata Punch.ev is in a field of its own. The face-lifted version launched earlier this year, therefore, had it easy, given the strong foundations it had to build up from. A little restyling, some feature updates and the Punch.ev would have continued to find takers effortlessly. That's not how Tata approached it, though. The updated Punch.ev is a significantly reconfigured car.

On the outside, the Punch.ev sure is striking if not handsome, and its butch appearance and concept-car-like surfaces are certainly appealing. As a part of its 2026 update, it now features a cleaner front end, a revised rear and light grey body cladding all around, which works to good effect. It wears its colours quite effortlessly, too, as you can tell from this rather vibrant hue our test car came coated in. The 16-inch alloys look smart, too.

THE INTERIORS

The cabin is even more impressive. It's a delightfully premium space, with abundant use of light colours, and rather nice finishes and materials. The quality of the interior in the touch-and-feel department as well as visually is solid and, more importantly, feels consistent. There's a measured heft to the stalks (borrowed from the Sierra), a chunkiness to the air-con vents and the screen integration feels neat as well. A delightful touch is the 90-degree aperture of all four doors, which makes ingress and egress a breeze. The lower half of the dash and centre console is, unfortunately, a sea of piano black and while the controls are intuitively laid out, it quickly becomes tedious to keep clean. The steering wheel

has a premium grip, although the piano-black band featuring an illuminated Tata emblem is a questionable choice, given how scuff-prone it is. Behind it are two nicely finished paddles (to activate four levels of regenerative braking) and the digital instrument screen that lies beyond has quite a modern layout. The front row of seating, a set of plush, spacious and well-finished seats with a central armrest, is now ventilated on the top-spec car, with the three-level function being activated by a button integrated into the seat base (on the door side). The air-con, too, is a strong unit that cools the cabin rapidly, not necessitating rear AC vents.

The back seat is, in itself, well-designed. It offers good thigh support and headroom is quite good, too, but there simply isn't enough legroom on offer, unless you're 5'7" or shorter. While I could seat myself behind the driver's seat (set to my driving position), my knees dug a fair bit into the seatback which, fortunately, is soft. Although manageable for a short drive, I suppose.

I do, however, feel that Tata could perhaps slim the seatbacks down a fair bit to create that crucial bit of rear kneeroom. The boot is spacious for a car of this size, although there's no spare wheel even in the form of a space-saver. In other news, there is now a sunroof with a manually retractable shade.

POWER SUPPLY

To drive, you've got to push a button on the dash while holding the brakes and then use a rather chintzy rotary drive selector to choose the mode. This unit, featuring a chrome diamond-pattern bezel with an integrated screen looks rather nice, but from my experience requires a bit of patience to operate at first. In a rush, say, on a busy road, you may find yourself in 'N' (or worse, 'R') instead of the intended 'D' mode, but I suppose it's a matter of getting used to. Beyond a point, I gave up and simply gave the screen a quick



FEEL GOOD FACTOR. The Punch.ev's cabin is decidedly upmarket and feature packed. Ventilated seats and a neat infotainment screen add value but the rear seat is tight on space

glance just to be sure.

When you finally get going, the Punch.ev impresses even more. It now features a 30- or 40-kWh battery pack, depending on the variant, going up from the previous car's 25/30 kWh. Charging receptiveness has also moved up to 65 kW from the previous version's 50 kW, which greatly improves charge times. The performance benefits, too, are clear as daylight. Power delivery is clean and quite strong, and even in Eco-

nomy mode (City and Sport are the higher modes), it offers great urban driveability. Sport, in fact, is almost too energetic; it's fun for short bursts, although newer drivers will do well to stay clear of it given the torque steer it generates and its eagerness to lunge forward.

Other than the obvious EV-specific takeaway, i.e., a silent drive experience, the Punch.ev does well in its overall calibration, giving quite healthy responses. This extends to

the suspension, too. While ride quality is a tad firm at low speeds, it absorbs most surface irregularities decently as speeds rise. The well-insulated cabin amplifies this behaviour, giving you a heightened sense of premiumness. High-speed stability is really impressive, although under aggressive cornering, there is a noticeably strong degree of body roll that will make you back off. On the whole, though, for a car of its size and class, you definitely won't feel like you're driving a compromise. Far from it.

PUNCH LINE

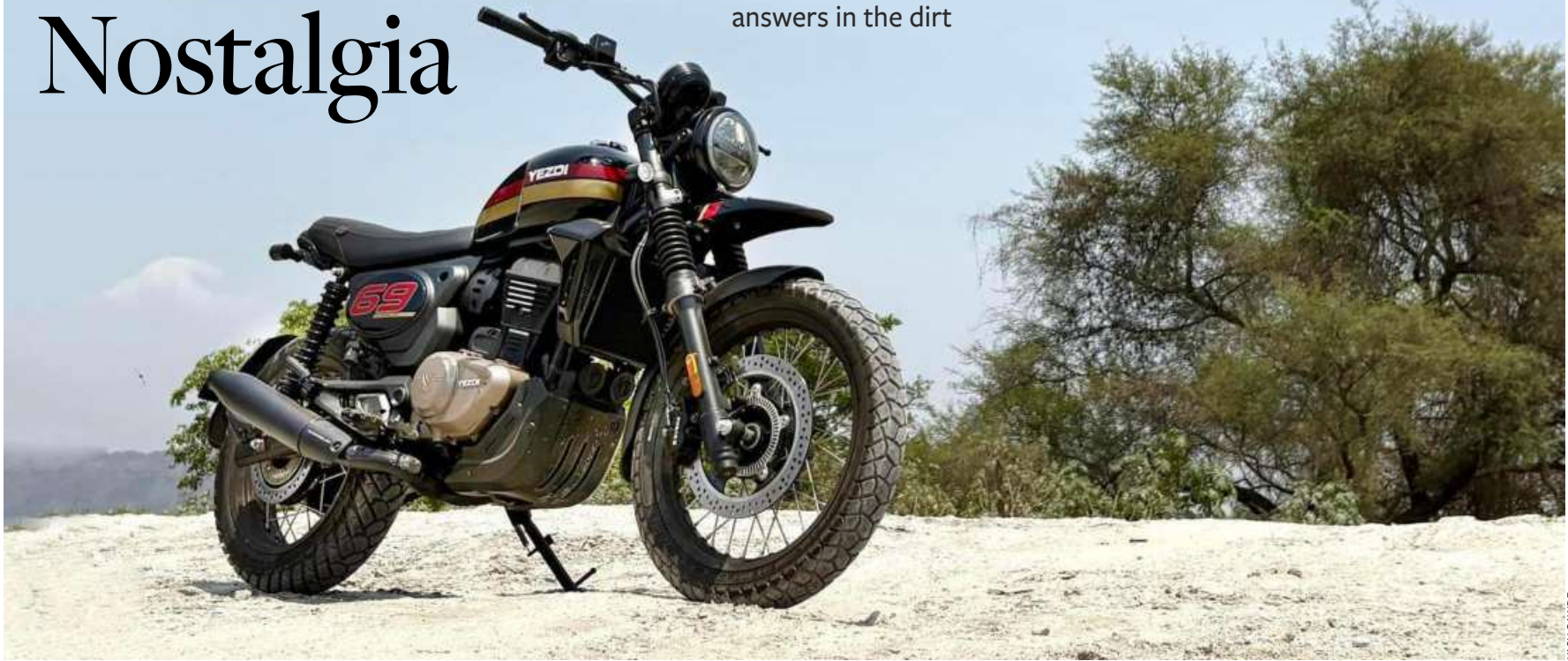
Now, for the Punch.ev's party trick. Fully charged, the Punch.ev displayed a range of 275 km in Economy mode, 260 km in City mode and 230 km in Sport. These are only slightly optimistic indications, I'm happy to report, and driven in a measured manner, you should be able to comfortably extract 250 km without venturing into an alarmingly low state of charge. I was able to charge it from 51 per cent to 100 per cent in 57 minutes using a 60-kW charger, and Tata claims you can charge it from 10-80 per cent in 30 minutes. A 3.3-kW portable charger is supplied as standard, and Tata even retails a 7.2-kW wall charger for an additional sum.

If you thought Tata was done delivering punches with the Punch.ev, wait till you hear about how much more affordable it is compared to the version it has replaced. With prices ranging from ₹9.69 lakh to ₹12.59 lakh (ex-showroom), the Punch.ev is cheaper by ₹30,000 (base) to — wait for it — ₹1.85 lakh (top). Viewed in isolation, too, this is admirable pricing for what is undoubtedly a well-packaged car with the only sore point being its cramped backseat. An ideal urban sub-compact EV for your urban sub-compact family? At the moment, the Punch.ev is in a field of its own. As it always was, then.

@TheMotorGram

Not Just Nostalgia

ONE FOR THE DIRT. The Yezdi Scrambler gets a serious rethink from its makers. Is the result as intended? We went looking for answers in the dirt



Ruman Devmane

My previous stint with a Yezdi Scrambler had left me hugely unimpressed; it felt bulky and crude, and definitely not capable enough to justify its name tag. When the updated Scrambler was announced, I kept my expectations firmly in check.

What I didn't expect was for it to surprise me. Before we go

there, let's take a moment to walk around it. The Scrambler looks decidedly neo-retro and largely well-finished, and the design certainly lends itself well to brighter colours — our test bike came in possibly the least flattering shade. Its tall-ish stance and wide handlebar with a cross bar suit its 'scrambler' aspirations well and the 200 mm of ground clearance amplifies its go-anywhere look. The 19/17-inch front/rear wire spoke wheels with on/off-road pattern MRF Mogrip Meteor FM2

tyres complete the picture. The Scrambler's lack of appeal so far was never owing to its design anyway. It was the riding experience. Fortunately, Classic Legends' focus in this exercise has been on the engine. Rebranded 'Katar' (meaning a knife of some sort), the 334cc single-cylinder liquid-cooled engine now produces 29.5 bhp and 3 kg-m, marginally higher than before. The older bike's twin exhausts have been replaced with a single unit, which has resulted in a significant weight saving;

Yezdi claims a wet weight (without fuel) of 174 kg.

RIDE QUALITY

This lightness reflects the instant you start riding. No motorcycle from the brand has felt as sprightly so far and it isn't just impressive in relative terms; it's genuinely fun to ride! Analogue in its sensations yet fairly refined (it isn't butter-smooth by intent, I think), the Scrambler's engine is a thoroughly enjoyable and lively one. Acceleration is energetic

from standstill and the mid-range adds tractability to the proceedings. The top end is pretty strong, too, with speeds in excess of 130 kph coming easily to the Scrambler. The 6-speed gearbox is niggly-free but is no benchmark, and the clutch feel is certainly well-judged. On another note, I can't say the Scrambler's is an evocative exhaust note, but it is loud and somewhat racy, if that matters to you. Overall, the riding experience is contemporary and fun, and this can be said of its per-



TRAIL AND ERROR. The revised engine gets rebranded, looks well-finished and delivers strong performance. The seat is too soft and not pillion-friendly. Suspension travel could be better, and instruments are also hard to read

formance in the city and out on the highway, too!

Another of the Scrambler's strengths is its agility. It has evolved into a flickable, engaging motorcycle, its goals further assisted by better ergonomics — the older Scrambler was messy on that front. Especially since you sit virtually upright, with a tall, wide handlebar falling into your hands (quite 'Yezdi of yore'), there's a lot of leverage on offer and this really helps have fun with it. Braking is quite strong, too, and in the departments of on/off-road grip, the Scrambler sails through, at least in dry conditions.

It's when you intently take it off the road, ironically its domain if the nameplate is anything to go by, that the Scrambler lets you down a bit. On flat, loose surfaces, it's fun to ride (almost everything

is!), but it's not necessarily a motorcycle that's designed for tough terrain. Suspension travel isn't generous (150 mm front/130 mm rear) and it doesn't feel quite supple, which would have been really encouraging. In other words, it delivers the right optics but not necessarily the function that needed to follow.

With its introductory price tag of ₹2 lakh (ex-showroom), the Scrambler is handsomely priced and undercuts its peers (Scram 440 and Scrambler 400 X) by a fair bit. An easy buy, then? Mostly, yes, but that's if its nuances as a scrambler (or the lack thereof) are a lower priority for you than the visual appeal of one. Or if you plan to stick to tarmac and don't mind leaving the pillion at home.

@TheMotorGram

Net FDI rises in FY26 on higher gross inflows; portfolio investment flows weaken

Our Bureau
Chennai

Net foreign direct investment (FDI) into India rose sharply to \$7.6 billion in in FY26, with March 2026 being the second consecutive month of positive net inflows. Net FDI was \$959 million in FY25, as per RBI data.

The net FDI was driven by gross investment inflows rising to \$94.5 billion in FY26 compared to \$80.6 billion in FY25. Repatriation rose marginally to \$53.6 billion from \$51.5 billion.

However, outward direct investments by Indian companies rose to \$33.3 billion from \$28.2 billion in FY25.

Increased inflows lift net FDI			
		FY25	FY26
1	Direct investment into India (in \$ billion)	29.1	40.9
2	Direct investment by India (in \$ billion)	28.2	33.3
Net FDI (1-2)		0.9	7.6

Source: RBI

“During 2025-26, both gross and net foreign direct investment inflows were higher than the previous year. In March, net FDI remained positive for the second consecutive month, despite a deceleration in gross FDI on account of relatively low repatriation and outward FDI. The rupee depreciated in May, with renewed geopolitical tensions and elevated crude oil prices

exerting pressure,” the RBI said in its May Bulletin.

However, the positive rise in net foreign direct investment was overshadowed by a steep drop in foreign investment inflows.

With the West Asia war straining the rupee and forex reserves of the country, total foreign investment flows (both direct and portfolio investment) recorded an outflow of \$11.7 billion in March



2026, the first month of the US-Iran crisis.

In March 2025, the corresponding foreign investment flows witnessed an inflow of \$7.3 billion.

For the full year FY26, foreign investment flows recorded an outflow of \$9 billion compared to an inflow of \$4.5 billion in FY25.

India’s near-term outlook somewhat clouded by supply-side pressures, says RBI Bulletin

Press Trust of India
Mumbai

India’s near-term outlook is somewhat clouded by supply-side pressures, and the spillover impact of the West Asia conflict on domestic inflation needs to be monitored, according to the RBI Bulletin.

While the global economy remained shadowed by uncertainties in West Asia, an article in the Bulletin said domestic economic activity exhibited resilience in April.

“The conflict in West Asia continued to exert pressure on commodity markets, global trade flows and supply chains, contributing to the



volatility in financial markets. India has entered this phase from a position of macroeconomic strength,” the article on the state of the economy said.

“Domestic demand continues to be the key driver of growth. However, the near-term outlook is somewhat clouded by supply-side pres-

sures. Although headline inflation remains firmly within the tolerance band, the pass-through to domestic prices needs to be monitored,” it said.

INFLATION & TRADE

Retail inflation rose to 3.5 per cent in April, driven mainly by food inflation.

Against the backdrop of the Iran war, the article said constricted shipping routes and trade flows increased supply-chain pressures to their highest levels since 2022. Prices of commodities, for which the Strait of Hormuz is a critical transit route, remained elevated in April and early May.

Base metal prices, includ-

ing aluminium, zinc and nickel, rose due to supply disruptions and higher fuel costs. “Financial conditions, crude oil prices and capital flows continue to pose challenges to the external sector outlook,” it said.

The merchandise trade deficit widened in April 2026 over March 2026 primarily on account of crude oil and gold imports.

Nevertheless, robust services exports, positive net FDI flows, foreign exchange reserve buffers and a number of proactive policy measures undertaken by the government and the Reserve Bank are likely to cushion the economy against external headwinds, it said.

AP to rope in anchor investor for ₹29,000-cr mega shipbuilding cluster

G Naga Sridhar
Amaravati

The Andhra Pradesh government is in the process of roping in a global major as an anchor investor for the ₹29,000-crore mega shipbuilding cluster coming up at Dugarajapatnam in Tirupati district.

With a 1,053-km-long coastline, Andhra Pradesh is betting big on developing its maritime economy.

South Korea’s HD Hyundai, Samsung and Japan’s



MT Krishna Babu, Special Chief Secretary, Infrastructure and Investments

Imabari are top global players in the shipbuilding industry. An announcement on

the anchor investor is likely soon. A special purpose vehicle (SPV) has already been formed for the mega shipbuilding cluster with a capacity of 1.2 million tonnes.

The total investment has been pegged at ₹29,253 crore.

While the government will take care of land and marine infrastructure development worth ₹5,289 crore, the anchor investor will develop the core shipbuilding cluster with an investment of ₹23,964 crore, MT Krishna

Babu, Special Chief Secretary, Infrastructure and Investments, Andhra Pradesh Government, told *businessline*.

MARITIME ECOSYSTEM

The proposed cluster, with an estimated investment of about ₹29,253 crore, seeks to create a globally competitive commercial shipbuilding hub and develop an integrated maritime ecosystem, the official said.

According to Abhishek Kumar, Chief Executive Officer, Andhra Pradesh Mari-

time Board (APMB), the process of acquiring 2,170 acres has already commenced. A major extent of this land is in Tirupati while a small portion of it will extend into Nellore district.

The preparation of a detailed project report is also underway.

The establishment of a mega shipbuilding cluster is part of the efforts to position Andhra Pradesh as a hub for global shipbuilding, aligning with the Maritime India Vision 2030 and Maritime Amrit Kaal Vision 2047.

NATIONAL AGRICULTURAL COOPERATIVE MARKETING FEDERATION OF INDIA LTD
Naman Centre, A Wing, Unit No. 803, C-31 G Block, Opp. Punjab National Bank, Bandra Kurla Complex, Mumbai-400051

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that property bearing Gala No. A2 on the First Floor of Mega Mall, Opp. Oshiwara Depot, Survey No. 6 (Part), CTS No. 1/1A (Part) Village Mauij Goregaon, Taluka Borivali, Mumbai 400104, is under attachment of the Sheriff of Mumbai since 2011 under proceedings in the matter pending before the Hon'ble Bombay High Court in Execution Application No. 581 of 2010 (NAFED VS SGI & ORS.). The said property alongwith other units bearing Unit Nos. A-1, A-2 and A-3 on the First Floor; Unit Nos. A-1, A-2 and A-3 on the Second Floor; and Unit Nos. 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 18 and 19 on the Third Floor of the said Mega Mall were put to auction by the Sheriff of Mumbai in February 2025 and the same have been auctioned and purchased by one Trison Developers LLP upon confirmation of sale thereof but the Hon'ble High Court vide its Order dated 25.02.2025 passed by Hon'ble Mr. Justice Riyaz Chagla.

Public at large is hereby warned not to deal with the said property being Gala No. A-2 Gala No. A2 on the First Floor of Mega Mall, Opp. Oshiwara Depot, Survey No. 6 (Part), CTS No. 1/1A (Part) Village Mauij Goregaon, Taluka Borivali, Mumbai 400104 in any manner whatsoever. If any person deals with the said property, he shall be responsible for all legal consequences including contempt proceedings.

Dated this 22nd day of May, 2026.

REPCO HOME FINANCE LIMITED
CIN - L65922TN2000PLC044655
Registered Office: Repco Tower, No. 33, North Usman Road, T.Nagar, Chennai 600 017
E-mail: cs@repcohome.com Website: www.repcohome.com

Corporate Office: Third Floor, Alexander Square, Old No.34 & 35, New No.2, Sardar Patel Road, Guindy, Chennai-600032
Ph: (044) - 42106650 Fax: (044) - 42106651

EXTRACT OF STATEMENT OF AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER/YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH , 2026

S.No.	Particulars	STANDALONE					CONSOLIDATED				
		QUARTER ENDED		YEAR ENDED		(Rs.in Crore)	QUARTER ENDED		YEAR ENDED		
		31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.12.2025 (Un-audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)		31.03.2026 (Un-audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	31.03.2026 (Audited)	31.03.2025 (Audited)	
1.	Total Income from Operations	454.17	457.13	425.34	1,797.69	1,714.89	454.17	457.13	425.34	1,793.90	1,711.10
2.	Net Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)	148.30	148.97	144.46	586.04	577.83	148.30	148.97	144.46	582.25	574.04
3.	Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)	148.30	148.97	144.46	586.04	577.83	148.30	148.97	144.46	582.25	574.04
4.	Net Profit for the period after tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary Items)	129.11	108.77	124.71	452.77	449.21	135.18	115.44	130.42	475.42	471.25
5.	Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]	127.96	108.87	123.70	451.20	448.14	133.30	115.54	129.41	473.54	470.18
6.	Paid up Equity Share Capital	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56	62.56
7.	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)	3,842.34		3,444.32	3,842.34	3,444.32	3,978.17		3,557.81	3,978.17	3,557.81
8.	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 10/- each) (for continuing and discontinued operations) (in Rs.)										
(a) Basic		20.64	17.39	19.93	72.37	71.80	21.61	18.45	20.85	75.99	75.33
(b) Diluted		20.64	17.39	19.93	72.37	71.80	21.61	18.45	20.85	75.99	75.33

Notes: The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly/Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 and 52 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/Annual Audited Financial Results are available on the Stock Exchange websites, namely: The National Stock Exchange of India Ltd-www.nseindia.com ; BSE Limited -www.bseindia.com and the Company's website-www.repcohome.com

Place : Chennai
Date : 21.05.2026

For Repco Home Finance Ltd.,
Sd/- (T.Karunakaran)
Managing Director & CEO

THIRUVANANTHAPURAM REGIONAL CO-OPERATIVE MILK PRODUCERS' UNION LTD.
Head Office: "KsheeraBhavan", Pattom, Thiruvananthapuram – 695004.
Phone: 0471-2447109 Fax: 2449567 email:ppm.trcmpu@gmail.com Website:www.milmatrcmpu.com/

TENDER NOTICE
23.05.2026
Tenders are invited for the following items at TRCMPU:

SI NO	ITEM	E-TENDER ID	APPROXIMATE TENDER VALUE (IN RS)
1	Supply of PET bottles	2026_KCMMF_852569_1	3,20,00,000

Specifications and details of the Tenders are available in E-tender portal (<https://tenders.kerala.gov.in>). Last date for submission of e-tender is on 06-06-2026, 02:00 PM. (The details are also available in the website – www.milmatrcmpu.com for reference).

MAITHON POWER LIMITED
(Contracts Department)
Maithon Power Ltd, Village: Dambhui, PO Barbindia, PIN-828205, District-Dhanbad

NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST

The Maithon Power Limited, a joint venture between Tata Power and DVC invites expression of interest from eligible vendors for the following packages:

S. No.	Ref. No	Package Description
1	2000094448	Housekeeping Services & Toilet Cleaning at MPL Karma Awaas & AAHAR#III for 2 Years

For details of pre-qualification requirements, bid security, purchasing of tender document etc., please visit our website URL- <https://www.tatapower.com/tender>
Eligible vendors willing to participate may submit their expression of interest along with the tender fee for issue of bid document latest by **31-May-26**.

VIKAS WSP LIMITED
Regd. Office: Railway Road Siwani, Haryana, India, 127046, Corporate Office: B-86/87, Udyog Vihar RIICO, Industrial Area, Sri Ganganagar, Rajasthan, India, 335002. CIN: L24139HR1988PLC030300
Email : csvikaswsp@id@gmail.com Website : <http://www.vikaswsp.com>

PUBLIC NOTICE -37th ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

This communication is regarding the Thirty Seventh(37th) Annual General Meeting(AGM) of **VIKAS WSP LIMITED** which will be held on **Wednesday, 24th June, 2026 at 11:30 AM (IST)**through Video Conferencing (VC) facility/other audio-visual means ("OAVM") as permitted by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs(MCA) & Securities and Exchange Board of India(SEBI) to transact the businesses as set out in the Notice convening the AGM which will be sent to members through e-mail separately.

Members who have not yet registered their e-mail addresses are requested to follow the process mentioned below for registering their e-mail addresses to receive the Notice of the AGM and Integrated Annual Report electronically and to receive Login credentials:

a. **For Members who hold shares in Electronic Form and email address not registered:** Members who hold shares in Electronic Form and have not updated their email address/Bank details, please update the details in your demat account as per the process advised by their Depository Participant(s).

b. i. **For Members who hold shares in Physical Form:** Members who hold shares in Physical Form and have not updated their email address/Bank details are requested to update the details in prescribed Form ISR-1 and other relevant forms duly filled along with self-attested supporting documents to the Company's RTA i.e. M/s. MUFCO Intime India Private Limited at delhi@in.mnms.mufg.com. Members may download the prescribed forms from the Company's website i.e. www.vikaswsp.com in in & the website of the RTA i.e. delhi@in.mnms.mufg.com. Any member in case of any query concerning participation in the Annual General Meeting may write to the company delhi@in.mnms.mufg.com or csvikaswsp@id@gmail.com.

This notice is being issued for the information and benefit of all the shareholders of the Company in Compliance with the applicable circulars of the MCA and SEBI.

Saraj Kumar Senapati,
Company Secretary cum Compliance officer
M.No.- F2898
By order of the Resolution Professional
Mr. Darshan Singh Anand-
Resolution Professional

Date : 23.05.2026
Place: Siwani, Haryana
IBBI Reg. No.: IBBIPA-002/IP-N00326/2017-18/10931

SHILPA MEDICARE LIMITED
Registered office # 12-6-214/A-1, Hyderabad Road, Raichur-584135 CIN No. - L85110KA1987PLC008739
Website - www.vbshilpa.com, Email - info@vbshilpa.com ,Telephone -+91-8532-238704

Extract of the Standalone and Consolidated audited Financial Results for the Quarter and Year Ended 31.03.2026

Sl. No.	Particulars	STANDALONE					CONSOLIDATED				
		Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (AUDITED) (UNAUDITED)	Quarter ended 31.12.2025 (UNAUDITED)	Quarter ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Previous year ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Quarter ended 31.03.2026 (AUDITED)	Quarter ended 31.12.2025 (UNAUDITED)	Quarter ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)	Year Ended 31.03.2026 (Audited)	Previous year ended 31.03.2025 (Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	20,111	16,686.00	12,621.00	59,703	47,741.00	43,699	41,028.00	33,082.00	153,887	128,643.00
2	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)	4,965	2,360.00	3,441.00	12,871	15,107.00	7,710	7,407.00	4,355.00	26,603	15,418.00
3	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period before tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	7,802	2,140.00	(991.00)	14,813	10,533.00	12,045	6,085.00	1,527.00	29,531	12,233.00
4	Net Profit / (Loss) for the period after tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	7,096	1,411.00	(563.00)	13,297	6,789.00	10,779	4,458.00	1,451.00	24,333	7,830.00
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period	7095	1,401.00	(758.00)	13,286	6,594.00	10,756	4,875.00	1,212.00	24,719	7,599.00
6	Equity Share Capital	1,956	1,956.00	978.00	1,956	978.00	1,956	1,956.00	978.00	1,956	978.00
7	Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve) as shown in the Audited Balance Sheet of the previous year.					269,382.00	263,716		-	257,164	235,292.00
8	Earnings Per Share (of Rs. 1/- each)(for continuing operations) -(in Rs)		(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)			(Not annual-ised)	(Not annual-ised)		
1) Basic:		3.63	0.72	-0.29	6.80	3.48	5.51	2.28	0.74	12.44	4.02
2) Diluted:		3.63	0.72	-0.29	6.80	3.48	5.51	2.28	0.74	12.44	4.02

Notes:

1. The above is an extract of the detailed audited financial results for quarter and year ended March31, 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full set of audited financial results for the quarter and year ended March 31,2026 are available on the Stock Exchange Websites(www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com)and on the Company's Website:www.vbshilpa.com

2. The Board of directors of the Company has recommended a final dividend of Rs.0.60/-per equity share(face value of Re.1/-)for the Financial Year 2025-26 at its meeting held on May 22,2026.

3. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Director at its meeting held on 22 May, 2026

Date: 22.05.2026
Place: Raichur

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
Sd/-
Omprakash Inani
Chairman

Power equation

Peak demand being capably met, but storage important

We are in the midst of a searing summer — and peak power demand (which lasts for a brief duration in a day) — is breaking new records. On May 21, this touched 270 GW at about 3 pm. The power requirement ebbs as evening sets in, and climbs again after sundown, when home ACs come to life, touching about 250 GW. It is during this second spike that the power system is really stretched, leading to occasional outages — since about 150 GW of solar capacity is out of reckoning.



A deficit between rising demand and assured supplies is met largely by captive generators supplying on the spot market, and at prices as high as ₹10 a unit — the limit set by law. However, rising power demand is now being met with less fuss — when compared with the alarming regional blackouts of yesteryears. It is interesting that while thermal power accounts for 70 per cent of electricity generated over the course of any given day, this dips to 60 per cent or less between noon and 2 pm in summer when peak demand soars; here, solar power pitches in with 30 per cent. In the evening hours, other sources such as hydel, gas, wind, nuclear and storage comprise 30 per cent of units generated — with hydel and gas being able to ramp power output more quickly than any source. During the day, much more solar power is generated than the grid can absorb, while thermal power cannot be ‘backed down’ quickly to adjust for this supply. Under electricity rules, thermal power output cannot be backed down below a point. This is because it affects costs of operations, creates maintenance issues; above all, it takes more time than hydel or gas, for thermal power to be ramped up when needed.

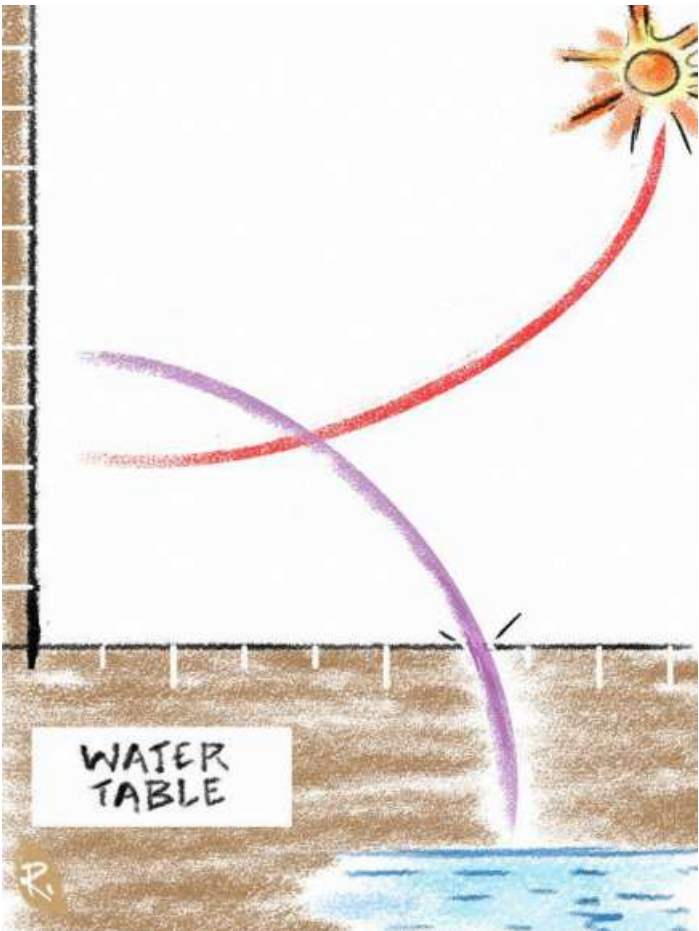
However, China has re-engineered its thermal power plants, allowing them to ‘flex’ capacity to accommodate renewables supply. This may be worth looking at as an option, since it needs to be seen against solar power forgone. However, the impact on PPAs needs to be worked out. In view of the rising role of solar in the energy mix, the role of battery storage in capturing excess daytime output can hardly be overstated. This push makes sense because grid infrastructure is unable to keep pace with rising capacity in renewables. The National Electricity Plan 2023 projects a requirement of 208 GWh of battery storage energy systems by 2030. The Centre has announced a number of incentives.

According to analysts, tendered battery storage capacity stands at 90 GW today, up from about 7GW eight years ago. To meet future power needs, the power generated must be stored and used efficiently. This is all the more because a renewables dominated system cannot operate at much more than 50 per cent installed capacity, as it is weather-dependent. In this context, a push for nuclear could play a role in plugging future power deficits.

Looking ahead this year, the prospect of a weak monsoon could prolong a period of high demand in September and October, even as hydel and gas supplies remain constrained. The Centre should be prepared for such a situation.

POCKET

RAVIKANTH



SURENDAR SINGH

The global trading system is shifting from a rule-based order to a more fragmented, transactional, and power-oriented system shaped by geopolitical contestation, regional conflicts, trade protectionism, supply chain realignment, the rise of regionalism, and bilateralism.

According to the World Trade Organisation, a total of 69 RTAs has been implemented globally between 2020 and 2025. India has also signed trade agreements with Mauritius, Australia, the United Arab Emirates, Oman, and the United Kingdom. Recently, it has formalised a trade agreement with the European Union and has released a joint statement to sign a trade deal with the United States.

Some policymakers, and geopolitical experts contend that India’s increased interest in FTAs in the post-pandemic world demonstrates a broader shift in its trade strategy from defensive to a more calibrated and pragmatic approach.

India’s trade agreements with the UK and the EU are portrayed as vehicles for improved market access, export diversification, supply chain realignment, and regulatory convergence. These trade agreements undoubtedly open up new business opportunities for domestic firms and integrate them into global value chain networks.

The broader discourse on these two trade agreements presents a rose-tinted view in terms of potential economic gains in labour-intensive sectors, such as textiles and clothing, gems and jewellery, leather, pharmaceuticals, and machinery products. They are also considered as important source of economic dynamism and competitiveness in a rapidly changing global trading environment.

However, this narrative largely overlooks how India’s commitments in these trade agreements undermine its trade policy flexibilities. The potential implications of these commitments in the case of the India-UK CETA and India-EU FTA are immense and extend beyond bilateral contexts. Such commitments not only sabotage India’s economic interests but also set precedents that may constrain India’s trade policy autonomy and negotiating space in future trade deals.

INDIA-UK CETA

First, the chapter on government procurement under the India-UK CETA states that procuring entities in both countries shall receive “no less than favourable treatment” to goods, services, and suppliers. It further contends that UK firms can qualify as

Recent FTAs could erode our policy space



RED FLAGS. Trade pacts with the UK and EU appear to boost market access. But the fineprint suggests trouble for MSMEs, pharma and digital policymaking

GETTY IMAGES

class II local suppliers with a domestic content of 20 per cent, thereby possibly enjoying the same preferential treatment as Indian suppliers.

This provision may enable UK firms to access Indian government procurements and tenders thereby limiting the potential business opportunities for domestic companies. Given the relative financial strength, scale and technological capabilities, it is unlikely that Indian suppliers can compete with UK firms in government tenders.

Furthermore, it significantly constrains the ability of Indian policymakers to incentivise MSMEs and start-ups participate in government tenders. This will adversely impact India’s grand initiatives, such as Atmanirbhar Bharat and Make in India, which focus on bolstering domestic manufacturing capabilities.

Second, a close review of disciplines related to intellectual property rights under the India-UK CETA states that parties recognise the importance of “preferable and optimal route to promote and ensure access to medicine is through voluntary mechanisms, such as voluntary licensing.” The inclusion of the voluntary licensing mechanism in the IPR chapter dilutes India’s well-established practice of invoking

The voluntary licensing mechanism in UK pact dilutes compulsory licensing, which allows domestic generic producers to supply medicines in a national emergency

compulsory licensing to allow domestic generic producers to supply medicines at the time of a national emergency.

The most concerning provision of the IPR chapter is the elimination of the patent working disclosure requirement, thereby giving undue favour to global pharmaceutical giants. This has significant implications for our generic drug producers, as they primarily rely on “working disclosure” as an important source of market information and intelligence. This can delay the entry of generic drugs into the market, thereby severely limiting access and availability of low-cost medicines for millions of people.

EU AGREEMENT

Third, a significant concern for India in its trade agreement with the EU is the chapter on trade and sustainable development, as it integrates non-trade issues (labour and environment) in India’s FTA template. Provisions related to labour and the environment can easily be instruments of disguised protectionism. It is a different matter that the legal text clearly states that these disciplines should not be used for “protectionist trade purposes”, and that the “violation of fundamental principles and rights” at work cannot be invoked.

This provision is open to different interpretations. It provides significant leeway to EU policymakers to challenge Indian exports produced in sectors where labour practices and wage structures differ from EU norms, creating space for them to invoke disguised barriers to trade.

In this context, the EU’s green trade measures such as deforestation regulations, CSDDD, and CBAM, will certainly impose strict scrutiny on

India’s labour and environmental practices. These green trade measures may offset the potential market access benefits of India’s labour-intensive exports.

Fourth, provisions on digital trade in trade agreements with the UAE, the UK, and the EU are in ‘best endeavour’ language; however, the real challenge is likely to arise when India negotiates digital trade disciplines in ongoing FTA talks with the US and South Korea.

Interestingly, the digital trade chapter of the India EU FTA prevents India from demanding access to source code of EU firms’ software and AI systems thereby significantly constraining power of Indian regulators to understand and regulate AI system.

Further, it also places restrict on Indian authorities to audit algorithms even during investigations. There is a high possibility that the US trade negotiators will put tremendous pressure on Indian trade negotiators to convert these ‘best endeavour’ languages into slightly stronger language, possibly hard commitments in a few areas. Digital trade commitments through trade agreements could subsume significant policy space to frame domestic digital policies.

Indian policymakers should be cautious and pragmatic while negotiating trade agreements, ensuring that the quest for market access, export diversification, and GVC integration does not come at the cost of policy sovereignty, regulatory constraints, and, most importantly, development imperatives.

The writer is an Associate Professor, Jindal School of Liberal Arts and Humanities, O.P. Jindal Global University, Sonapat. Views expressed are personal

Weather-induced school closures hurt the poor

Schools shift to online teaching during heat waves or pollution. Poor children suffer, as they cannot access instruction

Dibyasree Ganguly

India’s education policy today rightly emphasises better learning outcomes, equitable and inclusive education. But for millions of children, the basic condition that makes all of this possible — uninterrupted schooling — is increasingly becoming a challenge.

This is different from school dropouts, which is usually seen as the primary cause of learning disruption. The reasons for dropout are many in India, such as poverty or social factors like child marriage and gender roles prioritising boys’ education, leaving girls to perform domestic chores, among others. This is particularly seen at the secondary level, where dropout rates are substantially higher than in primary schooling, and retention remains a challenge despite higher enrolment.

Increasingly, extreme weather and pollution are also leading to schools being shut.

The problem is not just limited to schools being shut; the alternative, online education, is far from equal. For many children, a shift to online classes is not a smooth substitute for classroom learning, but it is just the beginning of exclusion, as the Covid experience shows.

Findings from the latest third round

of the India Human Development Survey (IHDS-3), conducted in 2022-24, clearly capture this divide. Among children aged 5-15 who were enrolled during the pandemic, 52 per cent of those in private schools were offered online classes during the closure period, compared with only 30 per cent in government schools.

Similarly, 45 per cent of private-school students received educational videos or other online learning material, compared with just 25 per cent of government-school students. Most strikingly, 61 per cent of children in government schools reported that their school shared nothing at all, compared with 43 per cent in private schools. These findings reflect a wider national pattern, with a Ministry of Education report showing that in several large States, between 40 and 70 per cent of school-going children lacked access to digital devices during the pandemic.

Teachers’ accounts from the IHDS-3 survey help explain why this gap was so difficult to bridge. Among Grade 3 teachers, those in government schools were more likely than their private-school counterparts to report barriers such as poor electricity, weak internet access, and lack of devices — constraints that students themselves had to grapple with. They were also more likely to point to limited digital



SCHOOL CHILDREN. Access issues
MOORTHY RV

skills among students and parents, as well as home circumstances that hindered learning. Remote education fell short not only due to technological gaps, but also because learning from home was shaped by unequal household circumstances.

UNEQUAL ACCESS

Children already studying in less advantaged settings are more likely to lose access to instruction altogether and less likely to recover quickly deepening long-term inequalities.

That is why the challenge in education goes beyond curriculum, teacher training, and school infrastructure, even though all of these are important. Such discussions often assume that schooling continues without interruption. But

when environmental shocks repeatedly push children out of classrooms and into highly unequal home-based learning conditions, the central policy question becomes one of continuity: who can remain connected to learning when the school gates are shut?

India is not short of digital education initiatives. PM eVIDYA was launched to provide multimodal access to education, while DIKSHA serves as a national platform for digital learning content. Samagra Shiksha has also expanded digital and ICT support within the broader school education framework, and NEP 2020 places clear emphasis on equitable and inclusive education.

But the existence of schemes does not by itself guarantee continuity in learning.

Where households lack stable connectivity, adequate devices, digital familiarity, or supportive learning environments, the children are unable to benefit from them.

As environmental disruptions become more frequent, measures for continuity in learning must be built into mainstream education policy — through stronger digital access, low-tech alternatives, community-based support, and effective last-mile delivery.

The writer is an Associate Fellow, NCAER - National Data Innovation Centre. Views expressed are personal

✉ **LETTERS TO EDITOR** Send your letters by email to bleditor@thehindu.co.in or by post to ‘Letters to the Editor’, The Hindu Business Line, Kasturi Buildings, 859-860, Anna Salai, Chennai 600002.

Climate concerns

The UN General Assembly’s support for the International Court of Justice ruling on climate responsibility is a welcome step in strengthening global climate action. The resolution gives climate-vulnerable nations, especially small island countries, stronger diplomatic and legal grounds to demand accountability from major carbon-emitting nations. However, the resolution does not fully address the concerns of developing countries like India. Developed nations, which benefited from centuries of industrialisation and colonial exploitation, bear a

greater historical responsibility for the present climate crisis. Hence, climate action must follow the principle of equity and differentiated responsibilities. At the same time, India should remain committed to its green-transition targets.
M Jeyaram
Sholavandan (TN)

Educational challenges

Apropos the Editorial “Reforming schools” (May 22), India’s education system has expanded access impressively, yet the real challenge lies in keeping students engaged and

prepared for a fast-changing economy. As the gig sector and artificial intelligence reshape work, schooling must evolve from rote learning to skill-based education. Adolescents leaving school early for low-wage jobs reflect a system that fails to connect learning with livelihood. Secondary education should integrate digital fluency, critical thinking, and creativity alongside foundational literacy. The goal must be to make staying in school economically and intellectually rewarding. When education equips students for

higher-value roles rather than repetitive tasks, families will see long-term merit in learning.
K Chidanand Kumar
Bengaluru

Rupee stress

This refers to RBI’s decision to conduct a ₹1 lakh crore VRR auction on May 22 and a separate \$5 billion USD-INR buy/sell swap auction with a 3-year tenor to inject long-term liquidity into the banking system. While both measures improve liquidity, the concern is whether such dual infusion could add further pressure on the INR, which is already

weakening sharply against the dollar. The key question is whether abundant liquidity should be prioritised at a time when the rupee is under stress. RBI may be trying to balance two objectives — preventing a liquidity squeeze caused by forex interventions while supporting growth and banking liquidity. However, critics may argue that excessive liquidity support during persistent rupee weakness could send a dovish signal to currency markets and contribute to further INR depreciation pressure.
Srinivasan Velamuri
Chennai

Mazagon Dock looking to set up mega shipyard in Maharashtra

EXPANDING FOOTPRINT. Project will create jobs, MSME opportunities, says Chairman

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders Ltd (MDL) is seriously evaluating the construction of a mega shipyard in Maharashtra, Chairman and Managing Director Capt Jagmohan said on Friday.

This is a part of its wider strategy to expand its footprint and support the Indian government's ambitions to become among top-five ship building nations in the world.



NEW AVENUES. Capt Jagmohan, MD and Chairman, Mazagon Dock Shipbuilders, speaking at *The Hindu's* Maharashtra Infrastructure Conclave 2026 in Mumbai on Friday. **EMMANUEL YOGINI**

AMBITIOUS PROJECT
Earlier this year, MDL acquired a 51 per cent stake in Colombo dockyard and the Mumbai-headquartered de-

fence sector PSU is looking for further growth opportunities.

"While East Coast clusters are under active

construction, we are seriously evaluating mega shipyard opportunity in Maharashtra," he said at *The Hindu's* Maharashtra Infra-

structure Conclave. He felt such a project could open up largescale employment, new MSME opportunities and export potential for the State of Maharashtra.

The MDL Chairman has sought the State government support in the form of a suitable waterfront site, single-window time-bound mechanisms, infrastructure and skilling.

Capt Jagmohan said MDL had executed warship and submarine projects worth ₹84,000 crore from its Mumbai yard in the past 15 years. "Our internal estimates suggest 40 per cent of this value (around ₹34,000 crore) has flown into Mumbai's local economy and surrounding areas," he said.

Jubilant Pharmova revenue jumps 14%, PAT at ₹442 crore

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Jubilant Pharmova Ltd reported full-year revenue of ₹8,280 crore for FY26, up 14 per cent year-on-year, driven by strong performance in its contract drug manufacturing, allergy immunotherapy, and generics businesses. EBITDA rose 8 per cent to ₹1,326 crore, while normalised profit after tax grew 7 per cent to ₹442 crore.

Full-year EBITDA margin narrowed by 99 basis points to 15.9 per cent, largely due to a temporary shutdown of the Montreal facility following FDA observations.

The company also cited rising demand from large US pharma companies seeking domestic manufacturing capacity in light of new US tariffs, which it said is generating increased interest in capacity at Spokane.

For the March quarter alone, revenue grew 19 per cent year-on-year to ₹2,290 crore, while EBITDA rose a modest 2 per cent to ₹363 crore. Net debt to EBITDA stood at 1.3x as of March 2026, up from 1.1x a year earlier, as the company continues to invest in capacity expansion. Shares of Jubilant Pharmova closed 0.52 per cent lower at ₹1,006.35 on the NSE on Friday.

Retailers wary of costs despite stable demand

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Retailers in the country recorded 7 per cent year-on-year growth in April, reflecting steady demand across categories and regions, according to the latest survey released by the Retailers Association of India.

However, the industry body flagged concerns about cost pressures. It added that while discretionary purchases remain selective, essential categories are sustaining momentum.

Retailers are focusing on sharper inventory planning and operational efficiencies to maintain margins.

Kumar Rajagopalan, Executive Director and CEO, RAI, said, "Retail in India has witnessed a modest 7 per cent growth in April '26. Decent but not exciting. Global cost pressures are real, and they are showing up in how businesses are operating across categories. India has navigated these pressures better than many others. Consumers still want to spend — that intent is there. But retailers are being careful, and rightly so."

Region-wise, West India reported the highest growth



at 9 per cent followed by South at 8 per cent, while North and Pan-India growth stood at 7 per cent each. East India recorded relatively moderate growth at 5 per cent.

SEGMENT GROWTH
In terms of categories, consumer durables and electronics segment led with 11 per cent growth in April year-on-year.

While food and grocery segment recorded 9 per cent growth, apparel and QSR segments saw 8 per cent growth each. Retailers continue to navigate a demand environment marked by cautious consumer spending and increasing operating costs, RAI noted.

Sports goods and beauty and wellness segments posted about 5 per cent growth each. Furniture and furnishings segments posted the lowest growth at 4 per cent.

Colgate Q4 sales rise 9%; FY26 net slips to ₹1,325 cr

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Colgate-Palmolive India reported a sharp recovery in the March quarter, led by premium oral-care products, higher advertising spends and improving urban demand, even as its full-year attributable net profit declined in FY26 due to GST-related impact and a weak first half.

Revenue from operations rose 9 per cent year-on-year to ₹1,583 crore in Q4 FY26 from ₹1,452 crore in the year-ago period, an absolute increase of ₹131 crore. Attributable net profit was broadly flat at ₹353 crore versus ₹355 crore a year earlier, while adjusted attributable profit, excluding one-offs, exceptional items and the GST-led inverted duty structure impact, grew 9.2 per cent year-on-year, according to the company.

For FY26, revenue from operations remained flat at ₹5,984 crore, while attributable net profit declined 1.8 per cent to ₹1,325 crore from ₹1,349 crore in FY25. The company said the reported decline was largely due to GST-related inverted duty structure impact and a high base from exceptional tax-refund interest income in

the prior year. The second half of FY26 showed a clear recovery trend, with H2 net sales growth of 5.2 per cent, indicating improving demand conditions after a softer first half.

"Strong rebound in growth with broad-based performance across portfolio," Colgate said in its earnings release, adding that it continued to invest behind consumption-building initiatives.

ADVERTISING SPEND
Advertising spend in Q4 rose 10 per cent year-on-year to ₹199 crore, or 12.6 per cent of net sales, as the company stepped up investments behind premium oral-care products and consumer outreach programmes. Full-year advertising spend stood at ₹819 crore, or 13 per cent of sales.

Despite the higher investments, Colgate maintained one of the strongest profitability profiles in the FMCG sector. Gross margin stood at 69.6 per cent in Q4 and 69.3 per cent for FY26, while EBITDA margin came in at 32.2 per cent for the quarter and 31.2 per cent for the full year. The board declared a second interim dividend of ₹24 per share, taking the total FY26 payout to ₹48 per share.

Swelect Energy Q4 PAT at ₹11 cr

Our Bureau
Chennai

Energy solutions company Swelect Energy Systems reported a consolidated net profit of ₹11 crore for the quarter ended March 2026 against ₹8 crore in the same quarter last year. Revenue from operations for Q4FY26 fell to ₹202 crore from ₹218 crore in Q4FY25. For the full year FY26, consolidated net profit stood at ₹57 crore against ₹14 crore in FY25.

"FY26 EBITA expanded 30 per cent to ₹187.46 crore, numbers that reflect significant improvement in the company's operating performance. We are well-positioned to reach our goal of 1GW independent power producer portfolio in a two-year time frame," said Arulkumar Shanmugasundaram, MD and CEO, Swelect Energy Systems Ltd.

GAR POWER & URBAN INFRA		GMR Power and Urban Infra Limited					
Regd. Office: Unit No - 12, 18th Floor, Tower A, Building No. 5, DLF Cyber City, DLF Phase - III, Gurugram- 122002 Haryana, India. Cp. + 91 124 6637750, E. gpollics@gmrgroup.in, W. www.gmrpulp.com, (CIN): L4540HR2019PLC125712		Extract of the Statement of Consolidated Financial Results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026					
		(₹ in crore)					
SL No.	Particulars	Quarter ended		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		31.03.2026 (Refer note b)	31.12.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2025 (Refer note b)	31.03.2025 Audited	31.03.2025 Audited	31.03.2025 Audited
1	Total income from operations	2,004.09	1,868.96	1,737.37	7,331.86	6,343.97	
2	Profit/(loss) from continuing operations (before Tax and Exceptional items)	2.30	53.13	(126.69)	(182.59)	(123.44)	
3	Net profit/(loss) before Tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional items)	2.30	(71.81)	166.89	781.17	1,776.28	
4	Net (loss)/profit after Tax from continuing operations (after Exceptional items)	(113.51)	(159.90)	177.49	586.62	1,737.90	
5	Net (loss)/profit after Tax from discontinued operations	(0.05)	(0.37)	(128.45)	27.07	(185.65)	
6	Net (loss)/profit after Tax from continuing and discontinued operations (4+5)	(113.56)	(160.27)	49.04	613.69	1,552.25	
7	Total comprehensive (loss)/ income for the quarter/year	(118.64)	(162.07)	15.28	598.33	1,478.57	
8	Paid-up equity share capital (face value of ₹5 each)	390.51	357.42	357.42	390.51	357.42	
9	Reserves (Other equity)				1,718.12	360.31	
10	Earnings per share (not annualised) (for Continuing and discontinued operations)	(1.47)	(2.36)	0.61	8.26	20.72	
	Diluted (in ₹)	(1.47)	(2.36)	0.61	8.20	20.72	
		Extract of the Statement of Standalone Financial Results for the quarter and year ended March 31, 2026					
		(₹ in crore)					
SL No.	Particulars	Quarter ended		Quarter ended		Year ended	
		31.03.2026 (Refer Note b)	31.12.2025 Unaudited	31.03.2025 (Refer Note b)	31.03.2025 Audited	31.03.2025 Audited	31.03.2025 Audited
1	Total income from operations	90.96	100.81	104.41	367.28	480.89	
2	Net (loss)/profit before Tax and Exceptional items	(37.32)	(10.40)	(3.26)	(118.23)	9.65	
3	Net (loss)/profit before Tax after Exceptional items	(178.53)	8.20	50.06	(149.57)	746.60	
4	Net (loss)/profit after Tax and Exceptional items	(178.53)	8.20	50.06	(149.57)	746.60	
5	Total comprehensive (loss)/ income for the quarter/year	(366.32)	1,058.28	(149.02)	1,041.52	(1,094.55)	
6	Paid-up equity share capital (face value of ₹5 each)	390.51	357.42	357.42	390.51	357.42	
7	Reserves (Other equity)*				3,204.49	1,296.60	
10	Earnings per share (not annualised)				(2.06)	10.91	
	Basic (in ₹)	(2.35)	0.12	0.70	(2.06)	10.91	
	Diluted (in ₹)	(2.35)	0.12	0.70	(2.06)	10.91	
		* Includes fair valuation through other comprehensive income of ₹(-) 9,634.40 crore for the year ended March 31, 2026 (₹(-) 10,445.44 crore for the year ended March 31, 2025).					
		Notes					
		a. The above is an extract of the detailed format of quarterly results filed with the stock exchanges under regulations 33 of Listing Regulations. The quarterly financial results in the detailed format are available on Company's website viz. www.gmrpulp.com and on the websites of BSE (www.bseindia.com) and NSE (www.nseindia.com). The results can be accessed by scanning the QR code.					
		b. Figures for the quarter ended March 31, 2026 and March 31, 2025 represent the difference between audited figures for the financial year and the limited reviewed figures for the nine months period ended December 31, 2025 and December 31, 2024 respectively.					
		c. The above results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee in its meeting on May 20, 2026 and approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on May 21, 2026.					
		For and on behalf of the Board of Directors Srinivas Bommidala Vice-Chairman & Managing Director (DIN - 00061464)					
		Date: May 21, 2026					
		GMR GROUP-PUL/32/PREM ASSOCIATES					

HARIOM		HARIOM PIPE INDUSTRIES LIMITED					
		CIN: L27100TG2007PLC054564					
		Registered Office: 3-4-174/12/2, SAMARPAN, 1st Floor, Near Pillar No. 125, Hyderabad, Attapur, K.V. Rangareddy, Rajendranagar, Telangana, India, 500048.					
		Website: www.hariompipes.com; Email: cs@hariompipes.com; Phone: 040-24016101					
		EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026.					
		(Figures in Lakhs, Except EPS)					
Particulars	Standalone		Consolidated				Year Ended
	Quarter Ended Audited	Quarter Ended Un-Audited	Quarter Ended Audited	Quarter Ended Audited	Quarter Ended Un-Audited	Quarter Ended Audited	
1. Total Income	31.03.2026 51,668.00	31.12.2025 36,434.85	31.03.2026 40,014.81	31.03.2025 1,68,014.65	31.03.2026 1,35,984.35	31.03.2025 61,664.56	31.03.2026 1,08,011.21
2. EBITDA	6,387.46	4,523.82	4,885.11	20,941.85	17,542.61	6,386.44	20,939.39
3. Net Profit/(Loss) before exceptional item and tax	4,177.81	1,556.43	2,345.43	10,386.41	8,310.22	4,169.47	10,374.43
4. Net Profit/(Loss) after exceptional item and tax	3,018.34	1,161.47	1,724.02	7,582.77	6,172.60	3,009.99	7,570.78
5. Total Comprehensive Income for the period	3,022.00	1,161.24	1,720.03	7,585.73	6,171.66	3,013.65	7,573.74
6. Equity Share Capital	3,096.73	3,096.73	3,096.73	3,096.73	3,096.73	3,096.73	3,096.73
7. Other Equity (Ind NCL Share)				61,567.52	54,170.69		54,170.69
8. Earnings per share (face value of Rs10/- each) (for continuing and discontinuing operations)							
Basic (Rs.)	9.75	3.75	5.66	24.49	20.25	9.72	24.45
Diluted (Rs.)	9.75	3.75	5.57	24.49	19.93	9.72	24.45
		Note:					
		1. EPS is not annualized for the quarter ended March 31, 2026, March 31, 2025 and December 31, 2025.					
		2. The audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results have been prepared in accordance with the recognition and measurement principles prescribed under the applicable Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) notified under Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013. These results have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and subsequently approved by the Board of Directors at its meeting held on May 22, 2026. The Statutory Auditors have audited the said financial results and issued their report with an unmodified opinion.					
		3. The above is an extract of the detailed format of financial results filed with Stock Exchanges under Regulations 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.					
		The full formats of audited financial results are available on the websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. www.bseindia.com/www.nseindia.com and on the website of the Company www.hariompipes.com.					
		For and on behalf of Board of Directors Hariom Pipe Industries Limited Sd/- Rupesh Kumar Gupta Managing Director DIN: 00540787					
		Date: May 22, 2026 Place: Hyderabad					

LTM offers to buy Randstad's tech, consulting biz in Europe, Australia

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

LTM and Randstad announced that the former has issued an offer to acquire Randstad's Technology and Consulting Services business in France, Germany, Belgium, Luxembourg and Australia, representing over \$500 million (€469 million) in annual revenue, for up to €160 million on a cash-free, debt-free basis, the company said in a regulatory filing on Friday.

The proposed acquisition, expected to be completed by Q3 FY27, would expand LTM's presence in key markets, primarily across aerospace and defence, automotive, utilities and BFS.

It would enable local domain expertise and regional capabilities in domain-driven digital engineering, cybersecurity and IoT, supported by onshore and nearshore delivery through centres in Romania and Portugal.

Per the filing, Randstad Digital France SAS (France) is headquartered

in France and operates in France, Romania and Germany.

Randstad Digital BV (Netherlands) is headquartered in the Netherlands and operates in Belgium, Luxembourg and Portugal.

Finxl Professional Services Pty Ltd (Australia) operates in Australia.

DIVERSIFIED PORTFOLIO
This would create a more diversified portfolio for LTM — expanding its scale in Europe and Australia, enhancing its position in regulated and high-growth verticals through marquee customer relationships.

Venu Lambu, CEO & MD of LTM, said, "This acquisition would strengthen our ability to deliver compliant, domain-driven artificial intelligence services and sovereign solutions in markets that are strategically important to us."

This acquisition is proposed to be completed through LTM's wholly-owned subsidiary — LTIMindtree UK Ltd.

Bikaji rides volume wave, eyes margin defence amid oil inflation

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Bikaji Foods International Ltd posted an 18 per cent jump in revenue from operations to ₹720.9 crore in the fourth quarter of FY26, driven largely by a 16.1 per cent underlying volume growth.

For the full year, revenue touched ₹2,993.9 crore, up 14.4 per cent, with gross margins expanding 290 basis points to 35.1 per cent.

COO Manoj Verma told *businessline* that the volume surge was partly a one-time effect. "Post-GST, the benefits were passed in terms of volume only...

this is not a sustainable one. This is one-off case which has happened," he said. The company has already taken a price increase of approximately 3 per cent to offset rising edible oil costs.

The company's retail store count doubled from 13 to 26 over FY26, with retail revenue jumping 130.9 per cent to ₹134.9 crore. Export revenues surged 52.3 per cent year-on-year to ₹146.8 crore.

Bikaji's stock has delivered a CAGR of 24 per cent over the past two years against the BSE Sensex's 14 per cent, with market capitalisation at ₹16,100 crore as of March 31, 2026.

3M		3M INDIA LIMITED			
Regd Office: Plot No. 48-51, Electronics City, Hosur Road, Bengaluru - 560100 CIN:L31300KA1987PLC013543 Website: www.3m.com/in Email: investorhelpdesk.in@mmm.com					
Extract of the Financial Results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026					
(Rs. in Lakhs, except per share data, unless otherwise stated)					
Particulars	3 months ended 31 March 2026	12 months ended 31 March 2026	3 months ended 31 March 2025	12 months ended 31 March 2025	
	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	Unaudited	(Audited)	
Total income from operations (including other income)	1,411.23	5,138.50	1,211.74	4,515.82	
Net Profit for the period (before tax, Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	248.93	928.36	225.22	773.41	
Net Profit for the period before tax (after Exceptional and / or Extraordinary items)	289.17	894.03	225.22	773.41	
Net (Loss) / Profit for the period after tax	215.34	522.32	71.37	476.07	
Total comprehensive (loss) / income for the period [Comprising Profit / (Loss) for the period (after tax) and other comprehensive income/ (loss) (after tax)]	217.09	522.07	69.98	471.25	
Equity share capital	11.27	11.27	11.27	11.27	
Reserves (excluding revaluation reserves as per Ind AS)		1,756.88		1,835.23	
Earnings per share (in Rs.) (of Rs. 10/- each)					
a) Basic (in Rs.)	191.16	463.66	63.36	422.60	
b) Diluted (in Rs.)	191.16	463.66	63.36	422.60	

Notes:

1. The above unaudited financial results of 3M India Limited have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and thereafter approved by the Board of Directors at their meeting held on 22 May 2026.

2. The financial results of the Company have been prepared in accordance with Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS) as notified by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs pursuant to Section 133 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 3 of the Companies (Indian Accounting Standard) Rules 2015, as amended and in terms of Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

3. The above is an extract of the detailed format for the unaudited financial results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026 filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 33 of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format for the unaudited financial results for the quarter and year ended 31 March 2026 are available on the Stock Exchange websites viz. www.bseindia.com, www.nseindia.com and on the Company's website (https://www.3mindia.in/3M/en_in/company-in/about-3m/financial-facts-local/). The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code provided below.

4. The Company had filed an application for an Advance Pricing Agreement ("APA") on 28 March 2018 to resolve certain ongoing transfer pricing related tax litigation matters pertaining to financial years 2014–15 to 2022–23. Following multiple discussions and negotiations with the APA authorities, the Company received the final draft APA approved by the Central Board of Direct Taxes ("CBDT") on 6 January 2026 which got subsequently signed on 23 February 2026. Accordingly, the Company has recognised tax expense of Rs. 139.47 crores and related interest thereon of Rs. 31.49 crores during the year ended 31 March 2026.

5. On 21 November 2025, the Government of India notified the four Labour Codes - the Code on Wages, 2019, the Industrial Relations Code, 2020, the Code on Social Security, 2020, and the Occupational Safety, Health and Working Conditions Code, 2020 - consolidating 29 existing labour laws. The Ministry of Labour & Employment published Central Rules and FAQs to enable assessment of the financial impact due to changes in regulations. The Company has evaluated and disclosed the incremental impact of these changes using the best information currently available, consistent with the guidance provided by the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India. Considering the materiality and regulatory-driven, non-recurring nature of this impact, the Company has presented such incremental impact amounting to Rs. (40.24) crores as an exceptional item in the financial results for the quarter and Rs. 34.33 cores for year ended 31 March 2026. The increase is primarily on account of past service cost for gratuity due to change in wage definition for employees. The Company continues to monitor the finalisation of Central/ State Rules and clarifications from the Government on other aspects of the Labour Code and would provide appropriate accounting effect on the basis of such developments as needed.



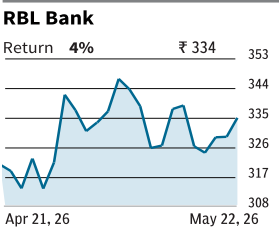
For and on behalf of the Board
3M India Limited

Aseem Joshi
Managing Director

Place: Bengaluru
Date : 22 May 2026

QUICKLY.

RBL Bank: Emirates NBD open offer opens on June 1



New Delhi: Dubai-based Burmans' Emirates NBD open offer to acquire an additional 26 per cent stake in RBL Bank from the open market would open on June 1 and close on June 12. The open offer is for the acquisition of up to 44.56 crore equity shares of face value of ₹10 each, representing 26 per cent of RBL Bank, a regulatory filing said. The price for the open offer has been fixed at ₹280 per share, along with applicable interest of ₹2.38 per unit, it said. Shares of RBL Bank closed at ₹334.30, up 1.78 per cent on the BSE. The identified date is May 15, 2026, for the purpose of determining the public shareholders to whom the letter of offer would be sent, it said.

SEBI allows staff to work from home for 8 weeks

Mumbai: The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has allowed certain employees to work from home (WFH) one day a week and has deferred internal programmes involving travel and hospitality expenses for eight weeks, beginning May 25, following Prime Minister Narendra Modi's call for energy conservation. SEBI's Human Resources Department issued an administrative advisory on Thursday, allowing officers in Grades A to C to work from home once a week on a rotational basis. Officers in Grade D (Deputy General Manager) and above, however, will continue to attend office physically on a regular basis.

BROKER'S CALL.

ICIIC Securities

INDIQUE SPACES (BUY)
Target: ₹263
CMP: ₹162.10
Indique Spaces Ltd (Indique) delivered a strong FY26 result on the back of operational area rising to 7.8 msf as of Mar'26, along with FY26 mature centre occupancy at 88 per cent. FY26 IGAAP EBITDA (cash EBIT) doubled y-o-y to ₹250 crore at an IGAAP EBITDA margin of 17.4 per cent (up 490 bps y-o-y). We build in same-store pricing growth of about 5 per cent for operational seats over FY26-28E. The balance revenue contribution will likely come from new seats, which are expected to grow at a 20 per cent CAGR over the same period. Meanwhile, VAS revenue will likely remain at 15 per cent of pure seat revenue, matching FY26 levels. We estimate the operational area to rise from 7.8 msf in FY26 to 11.3 msf in FY28E, with portfolio occupancy hovering at about 82 per cent. While we build in a 26 per cent revenue CAGR over FY26-28E, we estimate a 31 per cent IGAAP EBITDA CAGR (post all lease rental payments) over the same period. Consequently, IGAAP EBITDA margins should expand 143 bps to 18.7 per cent in FY28E (vs. 17.2 per cent in FY26) as rental expenses on upcoming assets reduce as a percentage of operating revenue. Additionally, annual utility cost savings of over ₹20 crore from the Karnataka solar power plant will likely contribute to this margin expansion. We maintain Buy with a revised TP of ₹263 (earlier ₹283) at an unchanged 15x Sep'27E EV/EBITDA, factoring in higher capex spend.
Key risks: Office leasing slowdown and pricing pressures.

Equirus Securities

APOLLO HOSPITALS (LONG)
Target: ₹9,444
CMP: ₹8,359.75
Apollo Hospitals Enterprise (APHS) reported robust 18 per cent y-o-y consolidated topline growth in Q4-FY26, with all three segments firing in tandem - hospitals and pharmacy sustaining healthy growth trajectories while group margins benefited from a meaningful narrowing of online-pharmacy losses and strong margin in Apollo Health and Lifestyle Ltd (AHL). Hospital revenue rose 16 per cent y-o-y to ₹3,270 crore, with ARPP up 9.2 per cent on a richer case mix (CONGO-T: +22 per cent). We model a 16 per cent revenue CAGR over FY26-FY28E, as about 1,400 beds get commercialised by FY28 (around 900 in FY27; balance in FY28). Pharmacy revenue rose 20 per cent y-o-y to ₹2,850 crore, driven by 21 per cent offline growth. A combination of 600 annual store additions, mid-teen SSSG & high-teen online GMV growth should sustain this momentum, pointing to an 18 per cent revenue CAGR over the medium term. While FY27 absorbs near-term margin dilution from capacity additions, we model 100bps of group EBITDA margin expansion to 16 per cent over FY26-FY28E. Key drivers are: EBITDA accretion as new hospitals scale, higher contribution from high-value CONGO-T specialties and pharmacy profitability improving as digital turns EBITDA positive. Retain Long with a SOTP-based Mar'27 TP of ₹9,444, valuing hospitals/pharmacy/AHL businesses at 26x/25x/15x EV/EBITDA.

businessline is not responsible for the recommendations sourced from third party brokerages. Reports may be sent to: blmarketwatch@gmail.com

Worst may be over for Adani: Bernstein

TROUBLE FREE. Brokerage says concerns around leverage, pledged shares and overseas funding have eased

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Global brokerage Bernstein believes the worst may be over for the Adani Group as concerns around leverage, promoter share pledges and access to overseas capital have eased significantly after recent developments in the US legal cases involving the conglomerate. Bernstein said the group had weathered two major crises in the last four years — the January 2023 Hindenburg short-seller report and the US SEC-DoJ related developments that began in November 2024. “With the latest news from the US, both seem to be behind,” the brokerage said in its report titled “India Infra: Adani Group — The Hard-Bank”, adding that “a key overhang has been removed”. Bernstein said many

global funds had stayed away from Adani stocks while awaiting clarity on the US proceedings, leaving most group companies under-owned despite sharp recoveries from their lows. However, the brokerage said the group’s “execution prowess” and ability to build large infrastructure assets at scale had never been seriously questioned. The brokerage said the group has three structural advantages — access to large land parcels, ability to gain market share from government-run businesses and execution efficiency in large-scale projects. Adani Green Energy’s roughly 2,50,000-acre renewable energy land bank with transmission connectivity and Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone’s dominance in container traffic are examples of these strengths. Bernstein maintained an ‘Outperform’



MAJOR HURDLE. Many global funds had stayed away from Adani Group stocks while awaiting clarity on the US proceedings, leaving most of them under-owned

rating on Adani Ports and Special Economic Zone and Adani Power, citing strong market positioning and growth visibility. It retained a ‘Market-Perform’ rating on Ambuja Cement, saying operational performance continues to lag peers despite cheaper valuations. The brokerage also maintained an ‘Underperform’

rating on Adani Green Energy, saying valuations remain expensive even after correcting from the pre-Hindenburg levels. **DEBT EXPANSION** On debt, Bernstein said net group debt had increased by around ₹1 trillion since September 2024 due to aggressive capital expenditure, particularly in renew-

ables and infrastructure expansion. Still, it said earnings growth had remained strong, with group EBITDA rising at a 22 per cent CAGR between FY23 and FY26, supported by capacity additions across businesses. The brokerage said that the group’s net debt-to-EBITDA ratio, which peaked at 4.4 times during the Hindenburg episode, fell to 2.7 times by September 2024 before rising again to 3.9 times by March 2026. Bernstein also said concerns around pledged promoter shares, which were one of the biggest fears during the Hindenburg episode, had reduced sharply. Further, overseas fundraising options for the group could reopen as legal uncertainty eases. Bond yields for several Adani entities have fallen sharply and are now below India’s five-year government bond yield levels.

Investors bet on index funds in volatile times

Our Bureau

Mumbai

Passives gaining ground (inflows in ₹ cr)

	Index funds	Equity ETFs
Nov	2,606.53	6,303.42
Dec	3,148.90	8,981.30
January	2,827.79	5,885.31
February	3,145.86	4,140.58
March	6,414.77	23,820.37
April	10,218.31	9,667.54
	28,362.16	58,798.52

Source: AMFI

The volatile equity markets have been driving interest of MF investors to bet big on index funds and equity-oriented ETFs, particularly when the market tanks sharply in reaction to global events. For instance, in March investors pumped a whopping ₹23,820 crore in domestic equity ETFs and another ₹6,415 crore in equity-oriented index funds to take advantage of the crash in the market on the back of geopolitical tensions in West Asia. In March, the Sensex and Nifty 50 crashed about 11 per cent, marking its worst

monthly performance since the pandemic-driven sell-off of March 2020. The market correction wiped out nearly ₹41 lakh crore in investor wealth, primarily triggered by escalation in West Asia conflict, inflation concerns on surge

in crude oil prices and aggressive foreign investors outflows. However, both the Sensex and the Nifty bounced ever since. The Sensex crashed from 81,287 points in February to 71,948 points in March only to bounce back to 76,913 points in April. The Nifty also followed a similar trend. After record flows in the previous month, domestic equity ETFs attracted investment of ₹9,668 crore while equity index funds received ₹10,218 crore inflows in April. DD Sharma, MD, MF King, said the index funds are a safer bet as they include only the big companies which are considered the backbone of the economy. Since the indices are rebalanced every

six months, investors in index funds gets the benefit of automatic rebalancing, diversification and low costs. **EXPENSE RATIO** Nifty 50 index MFs are low-cost, passively managed index funds that are market-linked and come with a low expense ratio, increasing net returns for investors, said Sandeep Chawla, an independent MF distributor. The expense ratio on these funds range between 0.02 per cent and 0.20 per cent. Among the large fund houses, Nippon MF’s Nifty fund charges expense ratio of 0.07 per cent, while Motilal Oswal MF and Axis MF charge expense ratio of 0.12 per cent and 0.17 per cent on their Nifty 50 Index Fund.

Sanjana B

Bengaluru

Wipro has fixed June 5 as the record date to determine eligible shareholders to participate in its proposed ₹15,000-crore buyback offer. In April, Wipro’s board approved a ₹15,000-crore buyback at ₹250 per share, involving up to 60 crore shares, or 5.7 per cent of the company’s total paid-up equity capital. The move marks the largest buyback in Wipro’s history, exceeding the ₹12,000-crore buyback announced in June 2023. **CAPITAL ALLOCATION** During its Q4 earnings call, Aparna Iyer, Chief Financial Officer, said: “We are return-

Private banks steer indices higher as Iran tensions ease

Anupama Ghosh

Mumbai

Brent crude hovering near \$105 a barrel and persistent foreign outflows did little to dent Dalal Street on Friday as private sector banks anchored a broader recovery and the rupee posted its sharpest two-day gain in weeks, giving investors a rare reason to exhale. “The positive undertone in the market was primarily supported by gains in private banking counters, recovery in the rupee against the US dollar and resilient corporate earnings, which helped offset concerns arising from elevated crude oil prices,” said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking. The Sensex advanced 231.99 points to close at 75,415.35, while the Nifty 50 gained 64.60 points to settle at 23,719.30. The session, however, was not without turbulence. After gaining as

much as 164 points in the first half, the Nifty surrendered 135 points from its intra-day peak as profit-taking kicked in. **MIXED TREND** On the sectoral front, Nifty Private Bank and Financial Services led the gains, followed by metal and PSU bank indices. Healthcare, media and pharma were the day’s underperformers. At the stock level, Shriram Finance and Trent topped the gainers’ list, while Max Healthcare, Sun Pharma and ONGC weighed on sentiment. The Nifty Midcap 100 ended marginally higher by 0.14 per cent, whereas the Nifty Smallcap 100 slipped 0.15 per cent, reflecting cautious positioning in the broader market. On a weekly basis, the Nifty ended 64 points higher and the Sensex added 232 points, with IT gaining 4.25 per cent and the Digital index up 2.75 per cent.

June 5 is record date for Wipro buyback

ing excess cash on our balance sheet.” “Wipro’s ₹15,000 crore buyback underlines its confidence in its balance sheet and future outlook. But at a time when the IT sector is entering a heavy AI investment cycle, the move also raises a broader capital allocation question. Investors would want to see a balanced approach between rewarding shareholders and continuing to invest aggressively in AI capabilities, acquisitions and execution. That said, Wipro remains comfortably placed from a cash perspective, so the focus now shifts to how effectively it translates its AI strategy into revenue growth,” said Tushar Badjate, Director of Badjate Stock Shares. Pareekh Jain,

Founder and CEO, EIIR Trend, said, “With IT stocks under pressure this year, buybacks are a way to reward shareholders and support investor sentiment by improving EPS through a reduction in outstanding shares.” In recent years, Wipro has pursued a mix of capability-led acquisitions, including the \$375 million Harman’s Digital Transformation Solutions in 2025 to strengthen its AI and engineering offerings, and \$375 million deal of Olam Group’s IT services arm Mindsprint in April. “Given subdued market conditions, this is seen as an appropriate time for buybacks, particularly for companies that are not pursuing aggressive acquisitions,” Jain said.

Employers’ paycheque: From workforce to wealth creators

RINGSIDE VIEW.

KS BADRI NARAYANAN

Capital market regulator SEBI has proposed a change that would allow third parties, like employers or mutual fund companies, to pay for investments on an individual’s behalf. According to the Securities and Exchange Board of India, the current regulatory framework mandates that all payments for investments in MFs must originate directly from the investor’s own bank account and be routed exclusively through RBI-authorised payment aggregators or SEBI-recognised clearing corporations. To mitigate third-party payment risks, asset management companies (AMCs) must ensure compliance with the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA), verify that the source bank account belongs to the unit-holder and use payment modes with independent traceability, per the current rule. Further, all pay-

ments are required to be credited to the investors’ verified bank accounts, thereby ensuring maintenance of a full audit trail. Requests have been made by the mutual fund industry to relax the extant conditions for third party payments in certain cases, such as payment of salaries by employers, payment of commissions by AMCs, etc., with adequate safeguards in place, SEBI said in a consultation paper on the proposed norms. **WHO ARE ELIGIBLE** One of the key proposals is to allow employers to invest in MF schemes on behalf of employees through salary deductions. According to the draft paper, the facility would be available to all listed and EPFO-registered companies and AMCs. But only interested employees may opt for such an arrangement and agree for salary deduction for MF schemes of their choice. “The proposed scenario acknowledges the established practice of employers offering various benefits and savings avenues to their employees,” SEBI said. It added that this mechanism would



OWNERSHIP. SEBI plans to allow employers to invest in MF schemes on behalf of employees through salary deductions

allow AMCs to accept consolidated payments for mutual fund investments through payroll systems, with employee consent. **EPFO/NPS SECURITIES** Currently, employees are indirectly investing in equity markets through EPFO contribution. The EPFO is authorised to invest up to 15 per cent of its fresh accretions into equities through exchange traded funds, tracking Nifty50 and S&P BSE Sensex, as well as specific CPSE ETFs for government disinvestments. Currently, the EPFO has invested over ₹3 lakh crore in equities. Similarly, the National Pension System (NPS) also invests in market-linked retirement schemes. While it is mandatory for Central government employees (joined from 2004), it can be voluntarily adopted by corporates for their employees. According to the NPS annual report, at the end of 2024-24, it managed ₹14.44 lakh crore.

vestors, mutual funds and the market. Investors stand to benefit, as this will make them disciplined investors over the long term. Beyond its immediate scope, the proposal presents an opportunity to establish in India an ecosystem comparable to the US 401(k) framework. But there will be a lot of operational challenges, especially what happens if employees discontinue and quit the company. Whether it will be portable like EPFO accounts is an important issue which an employee should know before investing. Also, SEBI should come out with clear norms on hassle-free withdrawals. This will also drive AMCs to launch innovative products targeting different types of investors based on their needs. However, they should not indulge in mis-selling. For the market, these funds will be instrumental in bolstering systemic stability and investor confidence, especially during volatile periods like the current one. Industry should welcome the new proposal and help the market broaden.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 64.60 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
ICICI Bank	1264.30	33.51	15.62	8.31	
HDFC Bank	766.80	25.53	14.90	10.79	
Axis Bank	1285.40	20.08	15.05	3.39	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	941.00	8.02	22.08	1.21	
Reliance Ind.	1354.50	7.22	19.14	8.41	
Trent Ltd.	4296.50	6.10	88.73	0.88	
Kotak Bank	384.15	5.30	19.81	2.60	
Bajaj Finance	916.55	5.19	29.50	2.25	
Hind Unilever	2203.60	4.76	48.93	1.80	
Asian Paints	2639.80	4.04	64.76	1.10	
Hindalco	1109.20	3.12	15.50	1.46	
Eicher Motors	6981.50	2.69	35.75	0.88	
NestleIndia	1423.10	2.60	78.43	0.94	
UltraTech Cement	11569.00	2.45	41.63	1.26	
Wipro	2031.11	2.10	16.06	0.53	
Int'lGlobeVai	4438.60	1.76	53.45	0.92	
Bajaj Finserv	1766.00	1.74	14.37	0.94	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	238.19	1.72	96.95	0.72	
Adani Enter	2717.30	1.23	35.28	0.72	
Apollo Hosp	8362.50	1.21	60.04	0.79	
Tata Steel	209.19	1.10	23.99	1.59	
SBI Life	1870.70	1.06	75.95	0.77	
Tata Motors PV	363.35	0.91	4460.27	0.70	
JSW Steel	1285.50	0.86	12.32	1.11	
HDFC Life	616.60	0.53	69.57	0.61	
Tech Mahindra	1422.20	0.30	29.00	0.83	
Grassim Ind	3155.30	0.07	20.85	1.10	
Eternal Ltd.	241.95	-0.16	637.95	1.60	
NTPC	888.65	-0.16	15.18	1.69	
Titan	4079.80	-0.30	71.38	1.55	
Cipla	1399.20	-0.33	29.27	0.72	
TataConsumerProduct	1191.80	-0.44	76.24	0.71	
L&T	3926.60	-0.49	28.50	1.24	
Maruti Suzuki	12987.00	-0.66	27.82	1.57	
HCL Tech	1164.00	-0.97	18.97	1.13	
Adani Ports	1786.90	-1.07	32.12	1.45	
Dr Reddys Lab	1307.20	-1.50	26.24	0.73	
State Bank	949.20	-1.54	10.11	3.62	
Coal India	456.55	-1.81	9.06	0.95	
TCS	2317.30	-2.20	16.95	2.18	
Bajaj Auto	10549.50	-2.84	27.88	1.07	
Bharat Elec	1163.55	-4.30	50.23	1.37	
MUM	3081.30	-3.45	20.58	2.83	
ONGC	2900.49	-4.95	8.11	1.04	
Infosys	1174.50	-5.12	16.16	3.79	
PowerGrid Corp	294.30	-5.18	17.18	1.23	
Bharti Airtel	1871.40	-9.30	33.71	5.28	
Sun Pharma	1844.60	-10.78	40.41	1.80	
Max Healthcare	1023.25	-11.07	70.16	0.70	
ITC	301.70	-13.34	18.26	2.67	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers					▲ 277.45 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
Varun Beverages .	539.45	75.72	56.85	2.99	
Cholamandalam&Fin	1539.80	43.28	25.07	2.67	
Gail (India)	160.77	37.08	12.28	1.75	
Adani Energy Solutions .	1387.90	25.17	68.68	1.92	
Tvs Motor Cmp.	3417.50	24.40	50.95	3.25	
Siemens	3811.70	22.73	85.61	1.36	
Bosch	36065.00	20.93	38.59	1.27	
Tata Motors Cv	382.95	17.99	46.57	3.24	
Jindal Steel	1209.90	13.70	36.72	1.81	
Ab In India	6689.50	13.65	98.71	1.42	
Bank Of Baroda	265.40	12.05	6.84	1.93	
Godrej Consumer	1027.50	11.58	56.48	1.67	
Rural Elec	336.95	11.46	5.44	1.70	
Divis Lab	6887.00	10.40	73.75	3.54	
Bajaj Holdings	10483.00	9.90	11.92	1.84	
United Spirits	1282.10	7.92	49.95	1.53	
MuthootFin	3296.70	7.27	12.48	1.43	
Punjab Natl Bank	102.66	7.20	6.39	1.43	
Shree Cement	24785.00	6.80	51.14	1.34	
Hdfc Amc	2738.70	6.21	41.05	2.26	
Hindus Zinc	632.25	5.14	19.31	1.11	
Torrent Pharma	4486.20	5.02	66.83	1.90	
Pillitteri	1478.40	4.90	50.90	1.85	
Adanigreenenergy	1362.30	3.88	112.93	1.85	
Union Bank	160.72	3.27	6.31	1.26	
Mazgaon Dock	2469.10	3.07	36.14	1.76	
Canara Bank	128.23	2.47	6.51	1.75	
MacroTech Developers .	886.75	2.38	25.82	1.01	
Tata Capital	299.70	2.32	26.01	0.52	
Zyffusfinteciences	1028.95	1.77	20.40	1.06	
Cg Power & Ind Sol	865.70	1.55	113.93	2.40	
Hyundai Motor India .	1848.60	1.37	27.65	1.07	
Vedanta	329.95	0.96	8.14	2.27	
Indian Railway Finance Corp	98.19	0.11	18.31	0.80	
Adani Power	219.32	-0.12	32.61	3.67	
Ambuja Cements	416.35	-0.17	24.53	1.92	
Brittania Ind	5331.50	-0.50	50.62	2.54	
Hindustaneronautics	4368.40	-1.07	32.05	3.35	
Power Finance	430.55	-1.85	4.23	2.54	
Bpl	586.70	-2.26	32.90	1.52	
Dfci	295.60	-4.58	4.96	2.42	
Tata Power	408.90	-7.56	26.53	2.77	
AvenueSupergr	4117.00	-8.40	90.21	2.45	
Sarmadmothersoninternatl	136.18	-10.24	35.18	2.44	
Indian Oilcorp	139.47	-11.18	4.51	2.11	
Cummins India	5353.00	-14.11	66.19	2.93	
Siemens Energy India .	3508.30	-16.53	95.39	1.26	
Indian Hotels Co .	100.25	-17.72	41.19	2.31	
Solar Industries	18132.00	-4.40	94.45	1.79	
Ltimitndree	4007.80	-31.93	23.85	1.50	

Pts: Impact on index movement

CERC approves 3 time slots for TAM contracts

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi



The Central Electricity Regulatory Commission (CERC) on Thursday approved three pre-specified time slots — round-the-clock (RTC), solar and non-solar — for the term-ahead market (TAM) on power exchanges.

TAM offers a range of products that allow participants to buy or sell electricity on a term basis for up to 90 days.

The regulator was hearing petitions from Indian Energy Exchange (IEX), Power Exchange India (PXIL) and Hindustan Power Exchange (HPX) seeking approval for pre-specified slots in TAM, Green TAM (G-TAM) and High Price TAM (HP-TAM) on their platforms.

‘CORE INTENT’

CERC said the “core intent” behind introducing pre-specified time slots in TAM contracts is to align with the conditions laid down in its June 7, 2022, and December 13, 2022, orders and prevent any scope for manipulation by restricting contracts to fixed specifications.

The Commission noted that Grid India had proposed structuring TAM contracts around “solar and non-solar hours” instead of “peak and off-peak hours”.

According to Grid India, a uniform four-hour peak slot cannot be defined nationally because each State reaches peak demand at different times based on its demand curve.

Further, imposing uniform peak-hour slots across regions would prevent buyers from optimising procurement in line with actual demand patterns, while region-specific peak-hour contracts could fragment liquidity in TAM.

Grid India also pointed out that peak and off-peak hours are notified only a month in advance by RLDCs, whereas TAM contracts are available for trading up to three months ahead.

CERC said it found “merit” in Grid India’s proposal to structure TAM contracts on the basis of solar and non-solar hours instead of peak and off-peak hours.

SLOT STRUCTURES

On the slot structures proposed by power exchanges and stakeholders, the Commission observed that suggestions such as region-specific peak hours, two-hour delivery slots and seasonally adjusted variations were not aligned with the objectives of pre-specified time slots envisaged in its April 28, 2025 order for TAM, G-TAM and HP-TAM.

RTC contracts will run for 24 hours, while solar contracts will cover 6 am to 6 pm and non-solar contracts 6 pm to 6 am.

“Broadly, we approve three types of pre-specified time slots for TAM contracts, namely RTC, solar and non-solar contracts. Under solar and non-solar contracts, there shall be further classification of contracts. These time slots are based on the prevailing national solar and non-solar hours,” CERC said in its order.

The regulator also directed Grid India to issue a detailed procedure for separately notifying solar and non-solar hours on a national basis, while factoring in regional variations as far as possible.

“The directions to the power exchanges pertaining to pre-specified time slots for TAM/HP-TAM/GTAM (hydro) and GTAM (other than hydro) contracts shall come into effect within a week from the date of the order. However, all such contracts traded or entered into before the date of this order shall continue to be valid,” the order said.

solar hours has now hit record highs for four consecutive days.

HEATWAVE PERSISTS

Since May 17, temperatures have crossed 47°C in several parts of east, central, north-west and peninsular India, with heatwave conditions expected to persist into next week.

Coal accounted for 63.16 per cent of the electricity supplied to meet Friday’s peak demand, followed by solar at 22.11 per cent, hydro at 5.64 per cent, wind at 5.54 per cent and nuclear at 2.66 per cent.

The Ministry of Power had projected peak electricity demand to touch around 270 GW this fiscal.



GHCL
TEXTILES

GHCL Textiles Limited

Regd. Off. : GHCL House, Opp. Punjabi Hall, Navrangpura, Ahmedabad-380009 (Gujarat). Phone : 079-26427818, 26427519
Email : secretarial@ghcltextiles.co.in; Website : www.ghcltextiles.co.in (CIN: L18101GJ2020PLC114004)

NOTICE OF 6TH ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING, REMOTE E-VOTING INFORMATION AND RECORD DATE

NOTICE is hereby given that the 6th Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company will be held on Saturday, June 27, 2026 at 10.00 A.M. (IST) through Video Conferencing (VC) or Other Audio Visual Means (OAVM), as per the framework issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) through its General Circular Nos. 14/2020 dated April 8, 2020, 17/2020 dated April 13, 2020, 20/2020 dated May 5, 2020, and the most recent Circular No. 03/2025 dated September 22, 2025 (collectively referred to as “MCA Circulars”) read with SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements), 2015 (“Listing Regulations 2015”), SEBI Master Circular no. SEBI/HO/49/14/14(7)/2025-CFD-POD2/I/3762/2026 dated January 30, 2026, Secretarial Standards (SS-2) and other applicable provisions, if any (including any statutory modification or re-enactment thereof for the time being in force).

In compliance with the above circulars and SEBI Listing Regulations, 2015, Notice of the 6th AGM and Annual Report (including Financial Statements, Board’s report, Auditor’s report and other documents required to be attached therewith) for FY 2025-26 will be sent through email to all the members (as per the Benepos Report dated May 15, 2026), on their registered email id and no physical copy of the same would be dispatched. The Company will also send a letter providing QR code and web-link including the exact path, where complete details of the Annual Report are available, to those members who have not registered their email addresses with Company or RTA or Depositories. Physical copy of the Annual Report will also be sent on request from shareholder. The Annual Report shall also be available on the website of BSE Limited (www.bseindia.com) and National Stock Exchange of India Limited (www.nseindia.com) where the Company’s shares are listed and on the website of the Company (www.ghcltextiles.co.in).

Please note that Company is convening the 6th AGM through VC / OAVM and no physical presence of Members, Directors, Auditors and other eligible persons shall be required for this AGM. As per MCA circulars, the facility to appoint proxy to attend and cast vote for the members is not available for this 6th AGM. However, the Body Corporates are entitled to appoint authorised representatives to attend the 6th AGM through VC/OAVM and participate thereat and cast their votes through e-Voting. Members, directors, auditors and other eligible persons to whom this notice is being circulated can attend this AGM through video conferencing at least 15 minutes before the schedule time. The attendance of the Members attending the AGM through VC/OAVM will be counted for the purpose of reckoning the quorum under Section 103 of the Companies Act, 2013.

In order to send Annual Report and other communication to Members in electronic form, we request the members of GHCL Textiles Limited (the Company), who have not yet registered their email and mobile number, to register the same immediately in respect of shares held in electronic form with their Depository Participant and in respect of shares held in physical form by communicating to the RTA of the Company, MUG Intime India Pvt. Ltd. (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited), C101, 247 Park, L. B. S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400083; Telephone number : +91-8108116767, and Email : mt.helpdesk@in.mpmc.mugf.com.

The members are hereby informed that pursuant to provisions of Section 108 of the Companies Act, 2013 read with Rule 20 of the Companies (Management and Administration) Rules, 2014, as amended and Regulation 44 of the SEBI (Listing Obligations & Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 read with SEBI Master Circular no. SEBI/HO/49/14/14(7)/2025-CFD-POD2/I/3762/2026 dated January 30, 2026 and other applicable provisions, if any, the Company is providing its members facilities for e-Voting Services provided by Central Depository Services (India) Limited (CDSL) in respect of the following businesses :

Ordinary Business :

- Adoption of audited financial statements of the Company for the financial year ended March 31, 2026, and the reports of the Board of Directors and Auditors thereon.
- Declaration of dividend for the financial year ended on March 31, 2026.
- Re-appointment of Mr. Raman Chopra (DIN: 00954190) as a Director of the Company, liable to retire by rotation.
- Appointment of Deloitte Haskins & Sells, Chartered Accountants LLP, as Statutory Auditor of the Company.

During the remote e-Voting period, members of the Company, holding shares as on the cut-off date i.e. **Saturday, June 20, 2026**, may cast their vote electronically. The remote e-Voting period commences at 9:00 a.m. (IST) on **Tuesday, June 23, 2026** and ends at 5:00 p.m. (IST) on **Friday, June 26, 2026**. The e-Voting module shall be disabled by CDSL for voting thereafter. Once a vote on resolution is cast, the member shall not be allowed to change it subsequently. The facility for voting, through electronic voting system, shall also be made available during the meeting and members attending the meeting who have not already cast their vote by remote e-Voting shall be able to exercise their right at the meeting. The members who have cast their vote by remote e-Voting prior to the meeting may also attend the meeting, but shall not be entitled to cast their vote again.

1. Instructions for members for remote e-Voting are as under :

Pursuant to Regulation 44 of the SEBI Listing Regulations, 2015 read with SEBI Master Circular no. SEBI/HO/49/14/14(7)/2025-CFD-POD2/I/3762/2026 dated January 30, 2026 and other applicable provisions, on e-Voting facility provided by Listed Companies, Individual Members holding securities in Demat mode are allowed to vote through their Demat account maintained with Depositories and Depository Participants. Members are advised to update their mobile number and email ID in their Demat accounts in order to access e-Voting facility.

In order to increase the efficiency of the voting process, all the Demat account holders, by way of a single login credential, through their Demat accounts / websites of Depositories / Depository Participants, able to cast their vote without having to register again with the e-Voting service providers (ESPs), thereby, not only facilitating seamless authentication but also enhancing ease and convenience of participating in e-Voting process.

Pursuant to above said SEBI Master Circular, login method for e-Voting for Individual Members holding securities in Demat mode with NSDL/CDSL are given below:

(A) Access through Depositories CDSL / NSDL e-Voting system in case of individual shareholders holding shares in demat mode

Type of Members	Login Method
Individual Members holding securities in Demat mode with CDSL	A. Existing users who have opted for Easi / Easiest 1) Users who have opted for CDSL Easi / Easiest facility, can login through their existing user id and password. An option will be made available to reach e-Voting page without any further authentication. The users to login to Easi / Easiest are requested to visit CDSL website www.cdslindia.com and click on login icon & New System My Easi Tab. 2) After successful login the Easi / Easiest user will be able to see the e-Voting option for eligible companies where the e-Voting is in progress as per the information provided by Company. On clicking the e-Voting option, the user will be able to see e-Voting page of the e-Voting service provider for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period or joining virtual meeting & voting during the meeting. Additionally, there is also links provided to access the system of all e-Voting Service Providers, so that the user can visit the e-Voting service providers’ website directly. B. User not opted for Easi / Easiest : If the user is not registered for Easi / Easiest, option to register is available at CDSL website www.cdslindia.com and click on login & New System My Easi Tab and then click on registration option. C. By visiting the e-Voting website of CDSL : The user can directly access e-Voting page by providing Demat Account Number and PAN No. from a link in www.cdslindia.com home page. The system will authenticate the user by sending OTP on registered Mobile & Email as recorded in the Demat Account. After successful authentication, user will be able to see the e-Voting option where the e-Voting is in progress and also able to directly access the system of all e-Voting Service Providers.
Individual Members holding securities in demat mode with NSDL	A. User already registered for NSDL IdeAS facility If you are already registered for NSDL IdeAS facility, please visit the e-Services website of NSDL. Open web browser by typing the following URL: https://eservices.nsdl.com either on a Personal Computer or on a mobile. Once the home page of e-Services is launched, click on the “Beneficial Owner” icon under “Login” which is available under “IdeAS” section. A new screen will open. You will have to enter your User ID and Password. After successful authentication, you will be able to see e-Voting services. Click on “Access to e-Voting” under e-Voting services and you will be able to see e-Voting page. Click on company name or e-Voting service provider name and you will be re-directed to e-Voting service provider website for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period. B. User not registered for IdeAS e-Services : If the user is not registered for IdeAS e-Services, option to register is available at https://eservices.nsdl.com. Select “Register Online for IdeAS *Portal or click at https://eservices.nsdl.com/SecureWeb/IdeasDirectReg.jsp After successful registration, please follow the steps given above to cast your vote. C. by visiting E-Voting website of NSDL 1. Visit the e-Voting website of NSDL. Open web browser by typing the following URL: https://www.evoting.nsdl.com/ either on a Personal Computer or on a mobile. 2. Once the home page of e-Voting system is launched, click on the icon “Login” which is available under ‘Shareholder/Member’ section. A new screen will open. You will have to enter your User ID (i.e. your sixteen digit demat account number hold with NSDL), Password/OTP and a Verification Code as shown on the screen. 3. After successful authentication, you will be redirected to NSDL Depository site wherein you can see e-Voting page. Click on company name or e-Voting service provider name and you will be redirected to e-Voting service provider website for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period. D. NSDL Speede Shareholders/Members can also download NSDL Mobile App “NSDL Speede” facility by scanning the QR code mentioned below for seamless voting experience.

Type of Members	Login Method
Individual Members holding securities in demat mode with NSDL	A. User already registered for NSDL IdeAS facility If you are already registered for NSDL IdeAS facility, please visit the e-Services website of NSDL. Open web browser by typing the following URL: https://eservices.nsdl.com either on a Personal Computer or on a mobile. Once the home page of e-Services is launched, click on the “Beneficial Owner” icon under “Login” which is available under “IdeAS” section. A new screen will open. You will have to enter your User ID and Password. After successful authentication, you will be able to see e-Voting services. Click on “Access to e-Voting” under e-Voting services and you will be able to see e-Voting page. Click on company name or e-Voting service provider name and you will be re-directed to e-Voting service provider website for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period. B. User not registered for IdeAS e-Services : If the user is not registered for IdeAS e-Services, option to register is available at https://eservices.nsdl.com. Select “Register Online for IdeAS *Portal or click at https://eservices.nsdl.com/SecureWeb/IdeasDirectReg.jsp After successful registration, please follow the steps given above to cast your vote. C. by visiting E-Voting website of NSDL 1. Visit the e-Voting website of NSDL. Open web browser by typing the following URL: https://www.evoting.nsdl.com/ either on a Personal Computer or on a mobile. 2. Once the home page of e-Voting system is launched, click on the icon “Login” which is available under ‘Shareholder/Member’ section. A new screen will open. You will have to enter your User ID (i.e. your sixteen digit demat account number hold with NSDL), Password/OTP and a Verification Code as shown on the screen. 3. After successful authentication, you will be redirected to NSDL Depository site wherein you can see e-Voting page. Click on company name or e-Voting service provider name and you will be redirected to e-Voting service provider website for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period. D. NSDL Speede Shareholders/Members can also download NSDL Mobile App “NSDL Speede” facility by scanning the QR code mentioned below for seamless voting experience.
Individual Members holding securities in demat mode) login through their Depository Participants	1. You can also login using the login credentials of your demat account through your Depository Participant registered with NSDL/CDSL for e-Voting facility. 2. After Successful login, you will be able to see e-Voting option. Once you click on e-Voting option, you will be redirected to NSDL/CDSL Depository site after successful authentication, wherein you can see e-Voting feature. 3. Click on company name or e-Voting service provider name and you will be redirected to e-Voting service provider website for casting your vote during the remote e-Voting period.

Important note : Members who are unable to retrieve User ID / Password are advised to use Forget User ID and Forget Password option available at abovementioned website.

(B) Access through CDSL e-Voting system in case of Members holding shares in physical mode and non-individual Members in demat mode

Login method of e-Voting for Members (including HUF) other than individual Members & physical Members.

- Log on to the e-Voting website www.evotingindia.com
- Click on “Members” tab.
- Now Enter your User ID
 - For CDSL : 16 digits beneficiary ID,
 - For NSDL : 8 Character DP ID followed by 8 Digits Client ID.
- Next enter the Image Verification as displayed and Click on Login.
- If you are holding shares in Demat form and had logged on to www.evotingindia.com and voted on an earlier voting of any company, then your existing password is to be used.

Place : Noida
Date : May 22, 2026

- If you are a first time user follow the steps given below :

	For Physical Members and other than individual Members holding shares in Demat.
PAN*	Enter your 10 digit alpha-numeric *PAN issued by Income Tax Department (Applicable for both demat Members as well as physical Members) Members who have not updated their PAN with the Company/Depository Participant are requested to use the sequence number sent by Company / RTA or contact Company / RTA.
Dividend Bank Details OR Date of Birth (DOB)	Enter the Dividend Bank Details or Date of Birth (in dd/mm/yyyy format) as recorded in your demat account or in the company records in order to login. If both the details are not recorded with the depository or company, please enter the member id / folio number in the Dividend Bank details field.

- After entering these details appropriately, click on “SUBMIT” tab.
- Members holding shares in physical form will then reach directly the Company selection screen. However, members holding shares in demat form will now reach “Password Creation” menu wherein they are required to mandatorily enter their login password in the new password field. Kindly note that this password is to be also used by the demat holders for voting for resolutions of any other company on which they are eligible to vote, provided that company opts for e-Voting through CDSL platform. It is strongly recommended not to share your password with any other person and take utmost care to keep your password confidential.
- Click on the EVSN for the relevant <GHCL Textiles Limited> on which you choose to vote.
- On the voting page, you will see “RESOLUTION DESCRIPTION” and against the same the option “YES/NO” for voting. Select the option YES or NO as desired. The option YES implies that you assent to the Resolution and option NO implies that you dissent to the Resolution.
- Click on the “RESOLUTIONS FILE LINK” if you wish to view the entire Resolution details.
- After selecting the resolution, you have decided to vote on, click on “SUBMIT”. A confirmation box will be displayed. If you wish to confirm your vote, click on “OK”, else to change your vote, click on “CANCEL” and accordingly modify your vote.
- Once you “CONFIRM” your vote on the resolution, you will not be allowed to modify your vote.
- You can also take out print of the voting done by you by clicking on “Click here to print” option on the Voting page.
- If Demat account holder has forgotten the changed password then Enter the User ID and the image verification code and click on Forget Password & enter the details as prompted by the system.
- There is also an option to upload BR/POA if any uploaded, which will be made available to scrutinizer for verification

(C) Additional facility for Non-Individual Members and Custodians for remote voting only

Step 1: Non-Individual Members (i.e. other than Individuals, HUF, NRI etc.) and Custodian are required to log on to www.evotingindia.com and register themselves in the “Corporates” module.

Step 2: A scanned copy of the Registration Form bearing the stamp and sign of the entity should be emailed to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com.

Step 3: After receiving the login details a Compliance User should be created using the admin login and password. The Compliance User would be able to link the account(s) for which they wish to vote on.

Step 4: The list of accounts linked in the login will be mapped automatically & can be delink in case of any wrong mapping.

Step 5: It is mandatory that a scanned copy of the Board Resolution and Power of Attorney (POA) which they have issued in favour of the Custodian, if any, should be uploaded in PDF format in the system for the scrutinizer to verify the same.

Step 6: Alternatively, Non Individual Members are required to send the relevant Board Resolution/ Authority letter etc. together with attested specimen signature of the duly authorised signatory who are authorized to vote, at least 48 hours before the meeting to the Company at secretarial@ghcltextiles.co.in, if voted from individual tab & not uploaded same in the CDSL e-Voting system for the scrutinizer to verify the same.

2. Process for those members whose email/mobile no. are not registered with the company/depositories.

For Demat Members - please provide Demat account details (CDSL -16 digit beneficiary ID or NSDL-16 digit DPID + CLID), Name, client master or copy of Consolidated Account statement, PAN (self-attested scanned copy of PAN card), AADHAR (self-attested scanned copy of Aadhar Card) to Company (secretarial@ghcltextiles.co.in) / RTA (mt.helpdesk@in.mpmc.mugf.com).

For Individual Demat Members - Please update your email id & mobile number with your respective Depository Participant (DP) which is mandatory while e-Voting & joining virtual meetings through Depository.

3. The instructions for Members attending AGM through VC/OAVM and voting on the day of the AGM through e-Voting system are as under :

- The procedure for e-Voting on the day of the AGM is same as the instructions mentioned above for Remote e-Voting.
- The link for VC/OAVM to attend meeting will be available where the EVSN of Company will be displayed after successful login as per the instructions mentioned above for e-Voting.
- Members who have voted through Remote e-Voting will be eligible to attend the meeting. However, they will not be eligible to vote at the AGM.
- Members are encouraged to join the Meeting through Laptops / iPads for better experience.
- Further Members will be required to allow Camera and use Internet with a good speed to avoid any disturbance during the meeting.
- Please note that Participants Connecting from Mobile Devices or Tablets or through Laptop connecting via Mobile Hotspot may experience Audio/Video loss due to Fluctuation in their respective network. It is therefore recommended to use Stable Wi-Fi or LAN Connection to mitigate any kind of aforesaid glitches.
- Members who would like to express their views/ask questions during the meeting may register themselves as a speaker by sending their request in advance at least **seven days prior to meeting** mentioning their name, demat account number/folio number, email id, mobile number at (company email id). The Members who do not wish to speak during the AGM but have queries may send their queries in advance **seven days prior to meeting** mentioning their name, demat account number/folio number, email id, mobile number at (secretarial@ghcltextiles.co.in). These queries will be replied to by the company suitably by email.
- Those Members who have registered themselves as a speaker will only be allowed to express their views/ask questions during the meeting.
- Only those Shareholders/ Members, who will be present in the AGM through VC/OAVM facility and have not casted their vote on the Resolutions through remote e-Voting and are otherwise not barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through e-Voting system available in the AGM.
- If any votes are cast by the members through the e-Voting available during the AGM and if the same members have not participated in the meeting through VC/OAVM facility, then the votes cast by such members shall be considered invalid as the facility of e-Voting during the meeting is available only to the members participating in the meeting.

3. For Assistance / Queries for e-Voting etc.

Login type	Helpdesk details
Individual Members holding securities in Demat mode with CDSL	If you have any queries or issues regarding attending e-Voting from the e-Voting system, you may refer the Frequently Asked Questions (“FAQs”) and e-Voting manual available at www.evotingindia.com under help section or write an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at toll free no. 18002109911 All grievances connected with the facility for voting by electronic means may be addressed to Mr. Nitin Kunder (022-62343626) or Ms. Asawari Kalokhe (022-62343624) or Mr. Rakesh Dalvi (022-62343611) (CDSL) Central Depository Services (India) Limited, A Wing, 25th Floor, Marathon Futrex, Mafatlal Mill Compounds, N M Joshi Marg, Lower Parel (East), Mumbai - 400013 or send an email to helpdesk.evoting@cdslindia.com or contact at toll free no. 18002109911.
Individual Members holding securities in Demat mode with NSDL	Members facing any technical issue in login can contact NSDL helpdesk by sending a request at evoting@nsdl.co.in or call at : 022-48867000 and 022-24997000.

- Mr. Manoj R. Hurkat, Practicing Company Secretary holding Membership No. F4287 and Certificate of Practice No. 2574 has been appointed as the Scrutinizer to scrutinize the voting and remote e-Voting process in a fair and transparent manner. The Board has also authorised the Chairman of the Board to appoint one or more scrutinizers, who shall be practicing Company Secretary, in the event of absence or inability of Mr. Hurkat to discharge his duties.
- The Scrutinizer shall, immediately after the conclusion of voting at the general meeting, first count the votes cast at the meeting, thereafter unblock the votes cast through remote e-Voting in the presence of at least two witnesses not in employment of the Company and make, not later than two working days from the conclusion of meeting, a consolidated scrutiniser’s report of the total votes cast in favour or against, if any to the Chairman of the Meeting or a person authorised by him in writing who shall countersign the same. Thereafter, the Chairman of the Meeting or the person authorised by him in writing shall declare the result of the voting forthwith.
- The Results declared along with the Scrutinizer’s Report shall be placed on the Company’s website www.ghcltextiles.co.in and on the website of CDSL immediately after the result is declared by the Chairman of the Meeting; and results shall also be communicated to the Stock Exchanges.

Members are requested to send their queries, if any, at least seven days in advance of the meeting so that the information can be made available at the meeting.

Payment of Dividend

Members may note that the Board of Directors of the Company at their meeting held on Thursday, April 30, 2026 has recommended payment of final dividend of ₹ 0.60 (Sixty Paise) per equity shares of ₹ 2/- each i.e. 30% on the paid-up share capital, if declared by members of the Company at the ensuing AGM and the dividend will be paid on or after Monday, June 30, 2026, to the Members whose names appears in the Register of Members or Register of Beneficial Owners, as the case may be, as on the Record Date i.e. Saturday, June 20, 2026. The final dividend will be paid electronically through various online transfer modes to those Members who have updated their bank account details. For Members who have not updated their bank account details, dividend warrants/demand drafts/intimation in lieu of dividend instrument will be sent to their registered address in due course.

As Members may be aware, as per the Income Tax Act, 2025, dividends paid or distributed by the Company shall be taxable in the hands of the Members and the Company shall be required to deduct tax at source (“TDS”) at the prescribed rates from the dividend. The TDS rate would vary depending on the residential status of the Members and the documents submitted by them and accepted by the Company. In this regard, a separate email communication was sent to the Members on **Wednesday, May 20, 2026** informing them the relevant procedure to be adopted by them/documents to be submitted for availing the applicable tax rate. The detailed tax rates, exemption forms and other documents required for availing the applicable tax rates are available on the website of RTA i.e. MUG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited) <https://web.in.mpmc.mugf.com/formsreg/submission-of-Form-121-41.html>. Members are requested to submit the documents in accordance with the applicable provisions of the IT Act on or before June 12, 2026.

The Members are requested to note that as per the provisions of the SEBI Master Circular No. SEBI/HO/MRSD/POD-1/P/CIR/2024/37 dated 7th May, 2024 read with SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/MRSD/POD-1/P/CIR/2024/81 dated 10th June, 2024, it is mandatory for all Members holding shares in physical form to furnish PAN, contact details (Postal Address with PIN and Mobile Number), bank account details, and specimen signature for their corresponding folio numbers. The Members may register/update the said details in the prescribed Form ISR-1 and other relevant forms with MUG Intime India Private Limited, Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (“RTA”) of the Company. Further, the Members can also access the relevant forms on the Company’s website at <https://ghcltextiles.co.in/claim-procedure-physical-shares>. Further, the concerned folios wherein any of the said details are not registered shall be eligible for any payment including dividend, only through electronic mode with effect from 1st April, 2024. An intimation shall be sent by the Company to such Members whose details are not registered that their payment is due and has been withheld. Further, the same shall be released electronically only upon registering the aforesaid required details. Alternatively, you may register your email address with RTA on a temporary basis to ensure the receipt of Annual Report for the financial year 2025-26 by visiting the link: https://web.in.mpmc.mugf.com/EmailReg/Email_Register.html on or before 5.00 p.m. IST on Friday, May 29, 2026. The above information is being issued for the information and benefit of all the Members of the Company and is in compliance with the applicable MCA and SEBI Circular(s). The Members may contact the Company’s RTA at : MUG Intime India Private Limited (Formerly Link Intime India Private Limited), Unit : GHCL Textiles Limited, C101, 247 Park, L. B. S. Marg, Vikhroli (West), Mumbai 400083, Telephone number : +91-8108116767, Email : mt.helpdesk@in.mpmc.mugf.com

For GHCL Textiles Limited
Lalit Narayan Dwivedi
Company Secretary
Membership No. F10487

**COCHIN INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT LTD.**

CIAL/COML/PRJ46/2026 **NOTICE INVITING EXPRESSION OF INTEREST** 23.05.2026

SUPPLY AND INSTALLATION OF SCULPTURE & ART WORKS FOR THE AIRPORT APPROACH ROAD BEAUTIFICATION PROJECT

CIAL hereby invites EOI for **"Supply and Installation of Sculpture & Art Works for the Airport Approach Road Beautification Project."** The proposals must reach the office of the Managing Director, CIAL on or before 15th June 2026. For eligibility criteria and other terms & conditions, please visit www.cial.aero.

Sd/-
Managing Director



swelect

Powering the world responsibly

SWELECT ENERGY SYSTEMS LIMITED
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Registered Office : 'SWELECT HOUSE', No.5,
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CORRIDGENDUM
In the financial results of the Company for the year ended 31 March 2026, published on 22.05.2026 in The Hindu Business Line and The Hindu Tamil Thisai (vernacular), the Earnings Per Share (EPS) was reported as follows:

	Quarter ended		Year ended	
Earnings Per Share (EPS) (of Rs.10/- each)	31 March 2026	31 March 2025	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
Basic:	7.31	5.93	37.99	9.22
Diluted :	7.31	5.93	37.99	9.22

It is clarified that the Earnings Per Share (EPS) should be read as follows:

	Quarter ended		Year ended	
Earnings Per Share (EPS) (of Rs.10/- each)	31 March 2026	31 March 2025	31 March 2026	31 March 2025
Basic:	6.73	5.31	36.40	8.31
Diluted :	6.72	5.31	36.36	8.31

There is no change in any other published information.

for SWELECT ENERGY SYSTEMS LIMITED

Sd/

Arulkumar Pudur Shanmugasundaram
CEO & Managing Director
DIN : 08371976

Place : Chennai
Date : 22.05.2026

QUICKLY.

Gold on track for second weekly loss



Gold on Friday headed for its second straight weekly loss, pulled lower by a firmer dollar and rising oil prices that kept inflation concerns in focus and increased bets for a US interest rate hike. Spot gold fell 0.5 per cent to \$4,519.69 per ounce by 1255 GMT. US gold futures for June delivery lost 0.5 per cent to \$4,520.90. Silver fell 1.2 per cent to \$75.77. REUTERS

Falling LME stocks buoy copper

London: Copper prices rose as falling available inventories outweighed expectations of seasonally muted demand in top metals consumer China and uncertainty around progress in US-Iran peace talks. Three-month copper on the LME was up 0.6 per cent at \$13,599 a tonne. Available copper stocks in LME-registered warehouses fell to a 10-week low. REUTERS

Crude oil up as investors sceptical over peace talks



London: Crude oil prices climbed as investors doubted the prospect of a breakthrough in US-Iran peace talks, but held on track for a weekly loss. Brent crude futures were up \$3.3 at \$105.88 a barrel by 0845 GMT, while US West Texas Intermediate futures were \$2.53 higher at \$98.88. REUTERS

At over 33 mt, govt’s wheat buy nears this year’s target

STEPPING UP. Purchases in Madhya Pradesh rise on pressure from the Opposition and farmers’ associations; procurement in other States also up

Prabhudatta Mishra
New Delhi

Wheat procurement by the government in the ongoing season has reached 33.39 million tonnes (mt) as on May 21. This is about 1 million tonnes less than the target, but up 13 per cent from 29.64 mt in the corresponding period last year.

Last year, the government procured 30 mt of wheat, but with a higher production of 120.21 mt, the target for this year’s purchase has been fixed at 34.5 mt.

According to the latest data, procurement in Punjab ended at 12.16 mt against 11.92 mt a year ago, up 2 per cent. The Centre fixed a target to procure 12.2 mt wheat from Punjab in 2026-27, against 11.92 mt bought in the entire 2025-26. Notably,



almost the entire quantity in the current year’s purchase in Punjab was under relaxed quality due to widespread lustre loss in several districts because of unseasonal rain and hailstorms.

M.P. BUY UP

In Haryana, the Centre purchased nearly 8.12 mt of wheat as the procurement

ended on May 15, and it is higher than the target of 7.2 mt. In 2025-26, the Centre bought 7.14 mt of wheat from Haryana.

In Madhya Pradesh, the Centre purchased 9.5 mt against 7.8 mt year-ago, up by 22 per cent. In the last week of April, the Centre accepted the State’s request and revised the target to 10 mt

from the earlier fixed 7.8 mt.

Due to a delayed start and a slow pace of purchase, which officials blamed on the non-preparedness of agencies with inadequate gunny bags and purchase centres, the target looked an uphill task. But with consistent pressure from the Opposition and farmer organisations, the government man-

Procurement surge

	2025	2026	% change
Madhya Pradesh	77.75	95.00	22.19
Rajasthan	18.06	20.32	12.50
Uttar Pradesh	10.17	14.75	45.00
Haryana	70.83	81.21	14.70
Punjab	119.24	121.63	2.00
Bihar*	17609	33295	89.10
All India	296.38	333.87	12.60

Source: CFPP Portal

Until May 21

*in tonnes

aged to step up purchases.

The procurement in Madhya Pradesh was lower by 59 per cent until April 30 despite the State being allowed by the Centre to buy the crop from farmers from March 15, against the normal schedule of April 1. Data show that purchase in the State during May 1-21 was about 9.2 mt, whereas in the correspond-

ing period last year it was only 3.8 mt.

Agriculture Minister Shivr-raj Singh Chouhan in April had raised the issue of lower procurement with Chief Minister Mohan Yadav.

OTHER STATES

The purchase in Uttar Pradesh has reached 1.48 mt against 1.02 mt, and in Ra-

ajasthan 2.03 mt from 1.81 mt year-ago, the data show. In Bihar, the procurement has reached 33,295 tonnes, up 89 per cent from 17,609 tonnes year-ago.

The Centre had raised the purchase target in Uttar Pradesh from earlier 1 mt to 2.5 mt, in Rajasthan from 2.1 mt to 2.35 mt and in Bihar from 18,000 tonnes to 0.18 mt.

State procuring agencies have been asked to keep wheat procured under the relaxed specifications (URS) category separately stored and accounted for. Unseasonal rain in March and April led to higher moisture content in grains, along with issues such as shrinkage and loss of lustre.

As a result, a large portion of the crop was falling outside the prescribed quality standards, affecting the procurement process.

Pineapple growers in Kerala seek 1-year pause on new crop amid price crash

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi



The Pineapple Growers Association Keralam has launched a campaign urging farmers to avoid fresh pineapple cultivation for the next 12 months and instead focus on maintaining existing farms amid acute labour shortages and falling prices.

Baby John, President of the association, said the migration of workers to northern India during the election season had severely affected labour availability, making it difficult for farmers to harvest and manage existing plantations efficiently.

He said the immediate priority should be the upkeep of current farms, which would help reduce unnecessary ex-

penditure, ease labour pressure and support market stability that could improve prices in the coming months.

LOWER RETURNS

At present, first-grade green pineapple is selling around ₹46 per kg, while ripe pineapple prices (wholesale) have plunged to ₹10-13. Farmers require at least ₹35-40 to break even, resulting in significant losses under current market conditions.

The association also pointed to extreme temperatures

during March and April, which disrupted flowering and fruit cycles, affecting production patterns and contributing to excess supply in the market.

Typically, pineapple cultivation yields three harvests over a period of 2-3 years. However, rising fertilizer prices and persistent labour shortages have increased pressure on small and medium farmers, many of whom are struggling to realise adequate yields from existing farms.

Growers said strong demand and high prices in recent years had encouraged many to venture into pineapple farming. Combined with favourable growing conditions, this led to a sharp rise in production, eventually leading to a market glut

and a steep fall in prices.

WEAK DEMAND

The sector is also facing weaker upcountry demand from the hospitality industry and lower consumption of processed fruit products and juices, leaving large quantities of harvested pineapples unsold.

The association further warned that the Centre’s push to reduce fertilizer usage and concerns over possible shortages arising from geopolitical tensions could affect new planting, since fresh cultivation requires higher manure application.

Against this backdrop, the growers’ body believes suspending new cultivation for a year would help stabilise the market and provide financial relief to farmers.

BEATING THE HEAT



AC POULTRY FARM. A farmer at Brahmana Nidamanuru village in Prakasam district of Andhra Pradesh has set up a poultry farm with enclosed sheds and a centralised air-conditioning system to protect chicken from the extreme summer heat, hot winds and viral infections, helping reduce weather-related losses. KOMMURI SRINIVAS

Cautious demand hits tea prices in Kochi auctions

V Sajeew Kumar
Kochi



The CTC dust market witnessed fair yet cautious demand in the Kochi tea auctions, with buyers remaining highly quality-conscious.

Traders said that market uncertainty and closure of hotels and way-side eateries due to LPG and labour shortages had hit local tea sales as well in the auction market.

In sale 21, good liquoring teas were lower by ₹1-2 a kg, and some withdrawal was noticed. Medium teas were also lower and witnessed a lot of withdrawal due to a lack of bids.

The offered quantity was 5,61,688 kg, witnessing a sales percentage of 76. The average price realisation was down by ₹2 per kg at ₹155.55, compared to ₹157.88 in the

previous week.

All blenders together absorbed 71 per cent of the total CTC quantity sold, the auctioneers Forbes, Ewart & Figgis said.

The orthodox dust market was also down with primary grades firm to dearer, while secondary teas were unsold.

ORTHODOX MARKET

Anil George, President of the Tea Trade Association of

Cochin, said that the orthodox market continued firm, supported by strong demand for well-made whole leaf teas. Active participation from the Middle East and CIS buyers ensured healthy sales percentage.

The auctioneers said that the total weighted average in the auction was lower compared to the previous week, primarily due to the higher quantity of low, medium and secondary teas sold.

The offered quantity was 1,76,993 kg with a sales percentage of 94. The average price realisation was down by ₹6 per kg at ₹178.44. The market for whole leaf and broken teas was firm to dearer, while the rest was irregular and lower.

CIS and neighbouring countries lent useful support, while fair enquiry was noticed from West Asia.

Palm oil snaps 3 weeks of losses

Reuters
Jakarta

Malaysian palm oil futures rose on Friday on some bargain buying after a steep decline following the announcement of a new Indonesian export monitoring system earlier this week.

The benchmark palm oil contract for August delivery on the Bursa Malaysia Derivatives Exchange closed higher by 27 ringgit at 4,485 ringgit (\$1,131.15) a tonne.

Dalian’s most-active soyoil contract fell 0.85 per cent, while its palm oil contract shed 1.7 per cent. Soyoil prices on the Chicago Board of Trade were up 0.8 per cent.

Cargo surveyors estimated that exports of Malaysian palm oil products for May 1-20 fell between 13.9 per cent and 20.5 per cent from a month earlier.

Coffee output for 2026-27 may dip 4%

Vishwanath Kulkarni
Bengaluru

Coffee output in India for the 2026-27 crop year starting October is likely to see a decline of about 4 per cent at around 6.14 million bags (of 60 kg each) or 3.68 lakh tonnes (lt) on a drop in yields due to the unfavourable weather, according to the US Department of Agriculture’s local office in Mumbai.

FAS Mumbai, in a recent report, said the projected output was 6.14 million bags, comprising 1.56 million bags of arabica (93,600 tonnes) and 4.58 million bags of robusta (2.74 lt). For 2025-26, the USDA Post maintained production at around 6.4 million bags or 3.84 lt, comprising 1.73 million bags of arabica and 4.7 million bags of robusta.

The state-run Coffee Board is yet to announce its initial or post-blossom crop

projections for 2026-27 and the final crop estimates for 2025-26. In its initial estimates for the 2025-26, the Board had projected a crop of 4.03 lt, comprising 1.18 lt arabicas and 2.84 lt robustas.

BELOW-NORMAL RAIN

According to the Post, India’s arabica output is expected to decline due to below normal monsoon rainfall, combined with unusually high temperatures, which may affect flowering and fruit-set. In contrast, robusta production is projected to remain relatively strong, reflecting greater resilience to weather variability, it said. Robusta accounts for over 75 per cent of India’s total coffee production.

“Timely rain in March and April supported flowering and early crop development, but recent extreme heat has increased moisture stress and evapotranspiration. Erratic, light showers have



been insufficient to stabilise the conditions, raising concerns over fruit set and reinforcing the need for adequate blossom (February-March) and backing rain (April-May) for optimal development. This is particularly significant for arabica, which is more temperature sensitive and has higher water requirements compared to robusta. Under sustained heat stress, arabica plants may experience reduced photosynthetic efficiency, increased flower drop and greater irrigation demand,” it said.

mand,” it said.

“This is particularly significant for arabica, which is more temperature sensitive and has higher water requirements compared to robusta. Under sustained heat stress, arabica plants may experience reduced photosynthetic efficiency, increased flower drop and greater irrigation demand,” it said.

OUTPUT UNCERTAINTY

However, the below-normal rainfall in 2026-27 is expected to be broadly favourable for the robusta coffee crop, particularly following two consecutive seasons of excessive rainfall, and will likely lower the incidence of fungal diseases that proliferate under prolonged wet conditions.

But the increasing frequency of erratic rainfall events and extended dry spells after heat events has added to production uncertainty in recent years, it said.

Salam Kisan aims for 100 agri-drone hubs to deliver AI-driven farming solutions

Our Bureau
Mumbai



AIMING BIG. The company has already engaged with 5 lakh farmers, serviced over 2.5 lakh acres and created a network of 200 trained drone entrepreneurs

Salam Kisan, the precision agriculture platform of the PRYM Group, has launched a nationwide agri-drone business franchise model aimed at creating district-level agri-tech infrastructure across the country.

The company plans to establish over 100 agri-drone hubs in the first phase, empowering entrepreneurs in tier-2 and -3 cities to deliver AI-driven farming solutions, including precision spraying, crop monitoring, pest detection, farm mapping and mechanised agricultural services.

The franchise-led model builds on Salam Kisan’s successful deployment across Maharashtra through its *Ma-hashakti* and *Sarathi* entre-

preneur programmes. The company has engaged with 5 lakh farmers, serviced over 2.5 lakh acres, and created a network of 200 trained drone entrepreneurs operating across agricultural belts.

Backed by a memorandum of understanding with the Maharashtra government and a technology collaboration with Microsoft, Salam Kisan operates through a fully integrated ecosystem

spanning drone manufacturing, pilot training, field deployment and precision agriculture services.

Dhanashree Mandhani, Founder and CEO, Salam Kisan, said the future of farming will not be driven only by tractors and labour, but also by AI-powered precision systems, drone intelligence, predictive crop analytics and real-time farm data.

BUSINESS MODEL

The company will be building a technology ecosystem that can dramatically improve productivity, reduce wastage, optimise pesticide usage and make Indian agriculture globally competitive, she said.

The business model offers franchise categories ranging from ‘Base’ (2 drones) to ‘Platinum’ (20 drones), with investment plans starting from ₹22 lakh up to ₹1 crore.

Each package includes DGCA-certified PRYM Aerospace drones, deployment vehicles, farm mechanisation units, pilot training, operational support and access to Salam Kisan’s integrated ERP and agri-tech ecosystem.

Its *Sarathi* programme focuses on training rural youth as licensed drone entrepreneurs.

Grain commerce platform Arya.ag adds onion to list of commodities it funds

Subramani Ra Mancombu
Chennai



Anand Chandra, ED and Co-founder, Arya.ag

Arya.ag, one of India’s largest integrated grain commercial platforms, has added onions to the list of commodities it funds, and plans to include apple too.

“Onion is one commodity we have added. We are exploring adding apples. We will start a study on this and work mostly in Himachal (on this),” said Executive Director and Co-founder Anand Chandra in an online interaction with *businessline*.

Stating that the company is looking at new ventures and segments, he said it had now evolved how onions could be stored for a longer period and lend against it.

The company, which deals with over 40 commodities, uses technology that is cost-

the bulb in well-aerated hut-like structures.

On the other hand, the company is looking for cutting-edge technologies rather than opting for non-remunerative systems. For example, it favours artificial intelligence (AI)-based camera monitoring systems over close circuit television cameras.

“AI-based cameras will work only on certain triggers which we define. It will help to understand if the warehouse is not open at 10 am or is not closed at 6 pm or if there is some movement of a person around the warehouse at night,” he said.

Arya is in talks with some entities in Africa to provide technical know-how on commodities lending and warehousing.

“They expect us to come and start the business. What

we are comfortable doing is to help them on the knowledge and the tech part,” said Chandra.

The company does not have the bandwidth to start operations in Africa now, as it is operationally intensive. “We are happy with what is happening in the country right now,” the firm’s Executive Director and Co-founder said, adding it does not make economic sense for it to take manpower from India to other countries.

Arya, which has popularised hermetic storage bags, has put its expansion plans on hold as its vendor had not been able to keep up with supplies.

In West Bengal, its presence is in a few locations due to government “challenges” faced earlier. However, the company sees potential for pulses crops there.

QUICKLY.

IUML, VCK MLAs inducted into TVK govt in TN



Chennai: Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Friday further expanded his Council of Ministers by inducting Vanni Arasu of the Viduthala Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) and AM Shahjahan of the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) as Ministers, a day after a major Cabinet expansion that saw 23 Ministers being sworn in. Tamil Nadu Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar administered the oath of office to both at the Lok Bhavan on Friday, taking the size of the TVK government's Cabinet to 35. Shahjahan has been allotted the Minorities Welfare portfolio and Arasu will handle the Social Justice Department, a release said. **OUR BUREAU**

EC sets Rajya Sabha polls for 24 seats on June 18

New Delhi: The Election Commission on Friday announced polls for 24 Rajya Sabha seats on June 18 following the retirement of incumbents, including former Prime Minister HD Deve Gowda and Congress leaders Mallikarjun Kharge and Digvijay Singh. In a statement, the EC said the elections for the RS seats will be held in 10 States, where the incumbents are retiring on different dates beginning June 21 to July 19. The elections will be held for four seats each in Andhra Pradesh, Gujarat and Karnataka, three seats each in Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, two seats in Jharkhand and one seat each in Manipur, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh and Mizoram. The last date for filing nominations is June 8. **PTI**

PM to launch mission to curb illegal immigration in border States: Amit Shah

IMPERMEABLE LINE. Centre will meet CMs of Tripura, Assam and West Bengal to discuss the issue

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi is going to soon announce a “High-Powered Demography Mission,” a national initiative to curb illegal immigration into the border States from neighbouring countries, especially Bangladesh and Myanmar, and address artificial demographic changes across the country, said Union Home Minister Amit Shah. Delivering the annual Rustamji Memorial lecture hosted by the Border Security Force (BSF) here, Shah said that after making the country naxal-free, the time had come to stop the infiltration going on for years. “Many retired police officers told me not to undertake the naxal-free campaign... They said the same to the Prime Minister, too. But

the Indian government remained steadfast... A five-decade-old problem is now ending, and India has become naxal-free... Now the BSF should proceed with the same determination to combat infiltration... The Prime Minister has launched the High-Powered Demography Mission, which will be announced in a few days... The High-Powered Demography Mission will also make identified points available to BSF,” Shah said. Modi, during the recent election campaign for the West Bengal and Assam Assembly polls, had vowed to end infiltration. On numerous occasions, he stated that largescale infiltration from across the border was being used as a tool to artificially alter demography and undermine the cultural identity of West Bengal. The Union Home Minister



Union Home Minister Amit Shah delivering the Rustamji Memorial lecture in New Delhi **ANI**

said that in the coming days, he will hold a meeting of the affected States.

UNIFIED POLICY “Now, in Tripura, Assam and West Bengal, there are governments that, as a matter of policy, believe that there should be no infiltration into the country... In the coming days, we will be holding a meeting with the Chief Min-

isters of the three States at the Home Ministry, and we will be creating a strong security layer to prevent infiltration,” he stated. At the same time, he urged the BSF, that instead of just the border, “we should now communicate with everyone from the District Collector to the *patwari*, from the Superintendent of Police to the police station-in-charge, and

using all the information received from them, we should also create a smooth system to expel infiltrators.”

STRONG BORDERS He also announced that the government will launch a “smart border” project next year to make the 6,000 km fronts with Pakistan and Bangladesh impenetrable, and ensure that the “conspiracy” to change the demography of the areas is defeated. West Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Friday met Union Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and called on President Droupadi Murmu at the Rashtrapati Bhavan. The meetings assume importance as the West Bengal government handed over a crucial 27-km stretch to the BSF for fencing work along the India-Bangladesh border in Siliguri subdivision.

ILO Convention No 87 protects right to strike, affirms World Court

Dalip Singh
New Delhi



At a time when 87 per cent of countries violate the right to strike, the International Court of Justice (ICJ) on Thursday gave a landmark advisory opinion that workers and their organisations have that right protected under the Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise Convention, 1948. This comes under the International Labour Organisation (ILO) Convention No 87 — the international labour treaty which guarantees workers and employers the right to establish and join organisations of their own choice without prior authorisation and protects them from government interference. The ICJ’s advisory opinion follows a request by the International Labour Organisation to resolve whether the ILO Convention No 87 protects workers’ right to strike. The convention does not explicitly mention the “right to strike” and has been a cause for ambiguity. The court concluded that, in accordance with the customary rules of interpretation reflected in Articles 31 and 32 of the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties, the right to strike is protected under Convention No 87. But it does not entail any determination on the precise content, scope or conditions for the exercise of that right, the ICJ said in a 10-4 majority judgment in favour of the right to strike. Despite arguments from one participant that an advisory opinion could harm internal social dialogues or disrupt the tripartite nature of the ILO (governments, employers and workers), the court found no compelling reason to decline the re-

quest. It noted that internal procedures within the ILO do not need to be exhausted before seeking an ICJ opinion. On the other hand, the dissenting judges relied on the literal and ordinary meaning of the treaty text, aligning with the rules of interpretation under the Vienna Convention on the Law of Treaties (VCLT). They pointed out that the word “strike” does not appear anywhere in Convention No 87.

INDIA NOT SIGNATORY However, this landmark judgment by the 15-judge ICJ panel will not apply to India, which has not ratified one of the core conventions of the ILO, Freedom of Association and Protection of the Right to Organise Convention, 1948 (No 87). But the ICJ judgment will embolden trade unions which believe that their right to strike has been weakened under the four labour codes due to imposed restrictions. Of the 151 countries surveyed in the 2025 International Trade Union Confederation Global Rights Index, 87 per cent, or roughly 131 countries, globally violate, restrict or entirely ban the right to strike. According to the findings, in these 131 countries, workers face severe restrictions, instant dismissal, criminal prosecution or outright bans when attempting to walk off the job.

Food Processing Ministry mulling continuation of PMFME scheme

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Food Processing Industries is considering continuation of the Pradhan Mantri Formalisation of Micro Food Processing Enterprises (PMFME) scheme for five more years with revised guidelines. Speaking to reporters on Friday, Devesh Deval, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Food Processing Industries, said the central scheme, which was launched in 2020, had currently been extended till September 2026. “We are looking into proposing some changes, including increasing credit-linked subsidy



NEW NORMS. The central scheme was launched in 2020 and has now been extended till September 2026 **NAGARA GOPAL**

from the current upper limit of ₹10 lakh per unit and more focus on encouraging women entrepreneurs,” he said.

FOCUS NORTH EAST The Ministry will also look at provisions to focus more on

branding and marketing and enterprises in the North-Eastern region, he added. Currently, the scheme provides a subsidy of up to 35 per cent of the eligible project cost, capped at ₹10 lakh per micro-enterprise, for in-

dividuals or groups setting up or upgrading food processing units. The centrally sponsored scheme was designed to bridge the gaps by addressing the challenges faced by micro-enterprises while leveraging the potential of groups and cooperatives to drive upgradation, formalisation and sustainable growth of the sector, he added.

WIDE COVERAGE So far, 1.96 lakh micro food processing enterprises have been supported under the credit linked subsidy component with more than 40 per cent of beneficiaries being women entrepren-

eurs. Deval said this number is expected to touch 2 lakh units by next month. Seed capital assistance has also been approved for more than 4 lakh SHG members. “The scheme has covered 1.72 lakh beneficiaries and other stakeholders under the capacity building programme,” an official statement added. Deval said that around 65,000 units had been modernised. Bihar leads in the number of beneficiaries, followed by Maharashtra, Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Madhya Pradesh. Processing of cereals, oil and oilseeds, fruits and vegetables accounts for the bulk of activity, he noted.

TN govt effects fresh IAS reshuffle

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu government on Friday effected another major bureaucratic reshuffle, transferring several senior IAS officers across key departments. According to a government order, Sandeep Nanduri, Managing Director of Tamil Nadu Industrial Development Corporation (TIDCO), has been appointed as Special Secretary to Government, Industries, Investment Promotion and Commerce Department, replacing Mariam Pallavi Baldev. Sandhya Venugopal Sharma, Chairperson of TIDCO, has been transferred and posted as Addi-



tional Chief Secretary to Government, Planning and Development Department, succeeding Sajjansingh R Chavan. D Karthikeyan, formerly Principal Secretary to Government, Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department has been ap-

pointed as TIDCO Chairman and Managing Director. Shilpa Prabhakar Satish, Secretary to Government, Commercial Taxes and Registration Department, has been appointed Commissioner of Labour in place of SA Raman who has been posted as Managing Director of State Industries Promotion Corporation of Tamil Nadu, replacing K Senthil Raj. TG Vinay, former Managing Director of Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply and Sewerage Board, has been placed at the disposal of Tamil Nadu Green Energy Corporation for appointment as its Managing Director in place of S Aneesh Sekhar who has been transferred as Mission Director of the National Health Mission, the order added.

Athulya Senior Care to raise funds, launch geriatric care hospitals

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

Senior citizens care provider Athulya Senior Care is gearing up to position itself as a full-spectrum geriatric care provider with the launch of its own hospital as it embarks on a funding round of around \$30 million. While Athulya is currently in assisted living and home care, it will soon launch a fully integrated geriatric care hospital in Chennai, in June. “We are also going for a \$30 million fundraise this year; we’ll go to market probably three months from now, and we expect this round to also take us closer to the listed story,” Karthik Narayan,



Karthik Narayan R, Founder and MD, Athulya Assisted Living Pvt Ltd. **BIJAY GHOSH**

Founder and Managing Director, Athulya Senior Care, said in an interaction with *businessline*. It will likely be a global institutional investor such as a sovereign fund as they have clear allocation on

social impact investments especially senior care, he added. The company raised around ₹100 crore from a Morgan Stanley managed PE fund in 2023. Athulya, which recorded revenue of ₹85 crore in FY26, expects it to grow to ₹125 crore in FY27, maintaining a 30-40 per cent annual growth rate. It is also profitable. The funding support will go towards ambitious expansion plans from 1,500 to 3,500 assisted living beds, and from one to 10 hospitals, Narayan said. India faces a severe shortage in senior care infrastructure, with only 20,000 beds available against an estimated requirement of 400,000, he points out.

SAEL Industries commissions ₹3,000 crore solar projects in AP

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

SAEL Industries has commissioned 600 MW AC solar power projects in Rayalaseema in 11 months after signing a pact with the State government with an investment of ₹3,000 crore. These are among first largescale renewable energy projects to be completed under the State’s Integrated Clean Energy Policy 2024. The projects were formally inaugurated by Nara Lokesh, Minister for Information Technology, Electronics & Communications, Real Time Governance and Human Resources Development, in Kurnool on Friday. The projects comprise two 300 MW AC solar facilities developed by SAEL subsidiaries, SAEL Solar MHP1 Pvt Ltd and SAEL Solar MHP2 Pvt Ltd, across nearly 2,400 acres in Kurnool district. The facilities will supply renewable power directly to the national grid under 25-year power purchase agreements with the Solar Energy Corporation of India, supporting India’s long-term clean energy transition, while strengthening the country’s renewable power capacity. The projects are expected to offset nearly 11 lakh tonnes of carbon dioxide emissions annually.

21-km Chennai Port-Maduravoyal elevated corridor set for November 2027 launch

Our Bureau
Chennai

The long-delayed four-lane elevated corridor connecting Chennai Port and Maduravoyal on the western outskirts of Chennai is expected to be operational by November 2027, according to S Viswanathan, Chairperson of the Chennai Port Authority. The ₹3,570-crore project, being executed by the National Highways Authority of India, has achieved around 25-27 per cent physical progress so far. Speaking to reporters on Friday, along with JP Irene Cynthina, Chairperson and Managing Director of Kamarajar Port Ltd, he said the construction was progressing at a rapid pace and expressed confidence that the elevated corridor would be completed within the target timeline. Chennai Port is also undertaking internal road and intersection improvement works at a cost of ₹37.18 crore.



S Viswanathan, Chairperson, Chennai Port Authority, and JP Irene Cynthina, Chairperson and MD, Kamarajar Port Ltd, at a press conference in Chennai **BIJAY GHOSH**

The 20.9-km elevated corridor project, originally launched in 2010, was stalled and eventually terminated in 2016. It was revived in 2023 following requests from the Tamil Nadu government and the Chennai Port Trust after recommendations by a technical committee. Once completed, the corridor is expected to substantially enhance cargo evacuation efficiency and boost the Chennai Port’s cargo handling capacity from the current 53 million tonnes per annum to nearly 200 mtpa by 2047.

Viswanathan said that the two ports together handled a record 107 million tonnes of cargo during FY26, surpassing the previous year’s 103.37 mt. Chennai Port handled 57.90 mt, while Kamarajar Port handled 49.08 MT. “Every 80 seconds, a car is being exported from Chennai and Kamarajar ports,” Viswanathan said. Chennai Port reported a record operating income of ₹1,185.01 crore and a net surplus of ₹434 crore in FY26. Kamarajar Port posted an 8.85 per cent year-on-year

rise in income from operations to ₹1,239 crore and recorded its highest-ever net profit of ₹596 crore. Total capital expenditure by the two ports stood at ₹992 crore in FY26, including ₹195 crore by Chennai Port, ₹478 crore by Kamarajar Port and ₹320 crore invested by PPP partners of KPL.

INFRA BOOST Among major infrastructure initiatives, Chennai Port will develop a multi-level car parking facility under the PPP mode at a cost of ₹400 crore. The Jawahar Dock entrance is also being widened and strengthened on an investment of ₹417 crore. Cynthina said that at Kamarajar Port, the ₹921-crore IOCL captive jetty and the ₹261-crore Coal Berth-3 project had been completed. The port will develop a second container terminal on a DB-FOT basis at an estimated cost of ₹4,288 crore, with bid documents currently under preparation.

Ladakh groups, Centre reach ‘in-principle understanding’ on democratic framework

Gulzar Bhat
Srinagar

Representatives of two major civil society groups from Ladakh said on Friday they had reached an “in-principle understanding” with the Centre on a framework to restore democratic governance and provide constitutional safeguards for the Union Territory.

The understanding emerged during talks between a subcommittee of the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) and leaders of the Leh Apex Body (LAB) and the Kargil Democratic Alliance (KDA), according to a joint statement issued after the meeting. Representatives from Ladakh, including climate activist Sonam Wangchuk, participated in the discussions held in New Delhi. Wangchuk attended the dialogue process for the first time since the talks began. The talks focused on Ladakh’s future administrative and political structure



A delegation of the Kargil Democratic Alliance and the Leh Apex Body with the Ministry of Home Affairs sub-committee

and addressed long-standing demands for greater autonomy and constitutional protections. According to the joint statement, the proposed framework envisages legislative, executive and financial powers being vested in an elected UT-level legislature. All bureaucrats, including the Chief Secretary, would function under the executive head of the elected body. **PATH TO STATEHOOD** The LAB and KDA reiterated their demands for restoration of democracy, constitutional safeguards and even-

tual Statehood, saying these reflected the aspirations of the people of Ladakh for an inclusive and sustainable governance model. According to the statement, MHA officials told the delegations that immediate Statehood for Ladakh was not feasible because the region currently lacks sufficient revenue generation to meet its expenditure commitments, including government salaries. However, the proposed arrangement could serve as a pathway towards full Statehood once Ladakh attains the necessary fiscal capacity, the statement said.

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EAST COAST RAILWAY

1) E-Tender Notice No. ST-SBP-TENDER-2026-14, Dt. 16.05.2026

NAME OF WORK : PROVISION OF RTU AT STATION GOOMTY OVER SAMBALPUR DIVISION AND SPLITTING OF DATALOGGER NETWORK AS PER NEW CONTROL BOARD IN SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Tender Value in (₹) : 4,31,89,319.56,

BID SECURITY (₹) : 8,63,800.00

2) E-Tender Notice No. ST-SBP-TENDER-2026-15, Dt. 16.05.2026

NAME OF WORK : PROVISION OF NEW GROUND CONNECTION SET FOR TWS OVER SAMBALPUR DIVISION.

Tender Value in (₹) : 63,03,005.00,

BID SECURITY (₹) : 1,26,100.00

Date and time of closing of Tender : At 1100 Hrs. of 08.06.2026 (for both SI No.)

No manual offers sent by Post / Courier / Fax or in person shall be accepted against such e-tenders even if these are submitted on firm's letter head and received in time. All such manual offers shall be considered invalid and shall be rejected summarily without any consideration. Complete information including e-tender documents of the above e-Tender is available in website : <https://www.treps.gov.in>

Note : The prospective tenderers are advised to revisit the website 15 (Fifteen) days before the date of closing of tender to note any changes / Corrigendum issued for this tender.

Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer (Sig)/ Sambalpur

QUICKLY.

Aurobindo edges past Dr Reddy's in revenue



Hyderabad: Aurobindo Pharma has overtaken Dr Reddy's Laboratories in the topline in the financial year 2025-26 with a total revenue of ₹33,653 crore registering a 5.6 per cent increase driven by spurt in the revenue from Europe. Dr Reddy's Laboratories, which maintained its lead over Aurobindo till FY25, fell behind it in FY26 with a total revenue of ₹33,593 crore. However, Dr Reddy's still leads in the bottom line. Even with a 24 per cent decline, it posted a net profit of ₹4,285 crore in FY26 while Aurobindo pegged its net profit for the year at ₹3,503 crore. With Sun Pharma being the top Indian drug maker in terms of revenue, Aurobindo has now become the second largest Indian Pharma company pushing Dr Reddy's to the third position. **OUR BUREAU**

Novo Nordisk uses AI to fast-track drug launches

Bengaluru: Novo Nordisk is aiming to slash the time it takes to bring new drugs to market by up to two-thirds using AI, a top executive said, as the Danish drugmaker looks to regain momentum in the booming obesity drugs market. "Historically, from 'last patient, last visit' to first filing might have been a year and a half. What we're able to do now by implementing AI is bring that time down by months," John Dawber, Managing Director for Global Business Services, said. The firm is deploying AI across critical parts of the launch process, including regulatory documents, analysing safety data and supporting commercial analytics for marketed drugs and those in clinical trials. **REUTERS**

Torrent Pharma Q4 net profit drops 26% on acquisition costs

Our Bureau
Ahmedabad

Torrent Pharmaceuticals Ltd reported a 26 per cent year-on-year decline in consolidated net profit for the fourth quarter of FY26, weighed down by acquisition-related expenses and severance compensation linked to the integration of JB Chemicals & Pharmaceuticals Ltd, even as revenue surged 42 per cent following consolidation of the acquired business. The Ahmedabad-based company, which operates in a single segment of generic formulations business, posted consolidated net profit of ₹364 crore for Q4 FY26, while revenue from operations rose to ₹4,197 crore. Torrent Pharma said profitability during the quarter was impacted by exceptional expenses related to the acquisition and integration of

Centre tightens pregabalin norms, brings drug under Schedule H1 list

REGULATION SHIFT. The Health Ministry classification will require prescriptions, strict record-keeping for sales

Our Bureau
Mumbai

In an effort to curb misuse and abuse, the Union Health Ministry has tightened the norms involving the supply and sale of pregabalin, a drug used in treating nerve-related pain. The drug has now been brought under Schedule H1 of the Drugs Rules, 1945, requiring a doctor's prescription for sale, besides meticulous record-keeping by the chemist. "The decision has been taken in view of reports received from certain States regarding the misuse and abuse of pregabalin, particularly among youth," the Ministry said on the drug that is used to treat chronic pain, neuropathies, fibromyalgia



TIGHTER CONTROLS. Pregabalin will now be regulated under stricter provisions

and certain neurological conditions. The drug has reportedly been misused for its sedative, euphoric and dissociative effects, the note said, adding that seizures of illegally stocked and unauthorised stocks have also been reported from some parts of the country. Dr Manish Chhabria,

Senior Consultant Neurologist at Mumbai's Sir HN Reliance Foundation Hospital, told *businessline* that pregabalin was a good drug, commonly used by neurologists to treat neuropathic pain, sometimes defined by patients as tingling or numbness, for example. Doctors are aware of the dosage that needs to be

given, he said, but when people take it for recreational uses in large doses, it causes drowsiness and sleepiness, he added. Indian Medical Association's former President Dr RV Asokan also agreed that the drug was a good product used in treating diabetic neuropathy, for example. Tightening of norms comes down to its implementation, he pointed out.

STRICTER NORMS Following the government notification, pregabalin will now be regulated under the stricter provisions of Schedule H1, instead of the existing Schedule H, under the Drugs and Cosmetics Rules, 1945, the Health Ministry said. Schedule H1 requires the drug to be sold only on med-

ical advice and on a prescription from a registered medical practitioner, besides requiring meticulous record keeping. "Retailers must maintain a separate register recording details of prescriptions and sales; manufacturers shall prominently display the prescribed 'Schedule H1 Drug Warning' label on product packaging; and violations and non-compliance will attract penal action under the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940 and Rules thereunder," the note said. The crackdown is aimed at strengthening accountability across the supply chain, preventing unauthorised access, enhancing prescription monitoring, curbing illegal trafficking, and safeguarding public health from drug misuse and abuse, it added.

Shareholders reject key Swiggy proposal as losses mount

Jyoti Banthia
Bengaluru

Food delivery and quick commerce major Swiggy has hit a roadblock in its plans to transition into an Indian owned and controlled company (IOCC), after shareholders voted down a proposal to appoint Chief Financial Officer Rahul Bothra and Co-founder Phani Kishan Addepalli to the company's board.

The resolution, which sought amendments to Swiggy's Articles of Association, received 72.35 per cent shareholder approval, falling short of the 75 per cent threshold required for passage. The changes would have allowed Founder and

Chief Executive Sriharsha Majety to nominate a management representative to the board. Bothra was expected to occupy one such seat, while Addepalli was set to replace Co-founder Nandan Reddy, who exited the company earlier this year.

INVESTOR UNEASE The rejection marks the first time that shareholders have voted against a resolution since Swiggy's public listing in November 2024, highlighting growing investor unease around governance changes and the company's widening losses. "Swiggy acknowledges the outcome of the resolution, which received 72.35 per cent shareholder approval, falling short of the required



threshold by 2.65 per cent," a company spokesperson said. "The proposed amendment reflects our long-term commitment to ensuring management representation on the Board and advancing our transition toward becoming an IOCC under applicable Indian foreign exchange laws and

H-1B registrations down in FY27; more approvals for higher degrees, salaries

Press Trust of India
Washington

Registrations for H-1B visas dropped by 38.5 per cent in fiscal year 2027 with the US saying it had approved more applicants with advanced degrees and higher salaries of those "making a real impact on the economy". The decision by the US Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) is likely to affect the Indians the most, who made up an estimated 71 per cent of all approved H-1B applications in recent years.

LOWEST WAGE In a post on X on Thursday, the USCIS said only 17.7 per cent of all selected registrations were in the lowest wage category. "The number of properly submitted registrations

plummeted by 38.5 per cent, from 3,43,981 in fiscal year 2026 to just 2,11,600 in financial year 2027," the USCIS said. "We're approving more applicants with advanced degrees and higher salaries - especially those who studied at US universities. An overwhelming 71.5 per cent of selected aliens hold a US master's degree or higher, compared to 57 per cent last year," it said. **SKILLED WORKERS** It said these skilled workers are making a real impact on the economy and the US was closing the door on the low-wage and low-skilled foreign labour pipeline approved under Joe Biden administration policies. The USCIS said President Donald Trump's policies of placing 'America first' were displaying results.

WHO raises Ebola outbreak risk in Congo to 'very high'

Reuters
Geneva

The World Health Organization (WHO) has raised the risk of the Bundibugyo strain of Ebola turning into a national outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo to "very high". The strain, for which there is no approved vaccine or treatment, was declared an emergency of international concern by the WHO on Sunday. "We are now revising our risk assessment to very high at the national level, high at the regional level and low at global level," WHO Chief Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus told reporters. So far, 82 cases have been confirmed in Congo, with seven confirmed deaths, 177 suspected deaths and almost 750 suspected cases. The situation in Uganda is stable, with two cases confirmed in



people who travelled from the DRC, one of them fatal, Tedros said. **SPREADING RAPIDLY** "The potential of this virus spreading rapidly is high, very high, and that changed the whole dynamic," said Abdirahman Mahamad, WHO Director of Health Emergency Alert & Response Operations. Measures taken in Uganda, including intense contact tracing and cancellation of a mass gathering, appear to have been effective in

stemming the spread of the virus, Tedros said. A US national, who was working in Congo, has been confirmed positive and transferred to Germany for care. The WHO's Chief Scientist, Sylvie Briand, said an antiviral treatment called Obeldesivir could be used among Ebola contacts to prevent them developing the disease. India's Health Ministry has asked all States and Union Territories to step up surveillance, hospital preparedness and screening of international travellers following the WHO's declaration of the Ebola outbreak in Congo and Uganda. Union Health Secretary Punya Salila Srivastava said countries bordering DRC and Uganda, including South Sudan, had been assessed to be at high risk of disease transmission.

'Bharti group seeks UK support to raise BT stake'

Reuters

Indian conglomerate Bharti Enterprises is seeking to potentially increase its stake in BT to just under the threshold that would require it to make a full takeover offer for the British telecoms group, sources said. Led by billionaire founder Sunil Bharti Mittal, the group is looking to secure the UK government's approval required for it to be able to increase its stake in the London-listed company, they said.

FULL TAKEOVER It could increase its stake to as much as 29.9 per cent to gain greater economic exposure to BT but does not plan to pursue a full takeover, one of the sources said. A Bharti spokesman



said that the company is pleased with its current 24.95 per cent shareholding and "currently has no plans to increase its stake". Any move by Bharti to increase its stake beyond 25 per cent would have to be reviewed by the government under the National Security and Investment Act, which gives the government greater say over deals where national interests might be involved.

App built by 14-year-old takes on Bengaluru's broken streets

Rasthe empowers citizens to report urban infrastructure issues - unusable footpaths, traffic bottlenecks - directly to BBMP

Adithya Lalgudi
Bengaluru

Bengaluru's broken footpaths, obstructed walkways and neglected pedestrian infrastructure may soon have a new watchdog. Rasthe, a civic-tech app launched this week, aims to turn citizens into active reporters of urban infrastructure issues, allowing them to flag damaged footpaths, traffic bottlenecks and construction-related disruptions directly to the BBMP. The platform takes an unconventional approach to civic participation. Borrowing a page from dating apps, users can swipe between footpaths to rate which is better or worse, while also nominating the best and worst pedestrian stretches in their neighbourhoods.

They can upload images of unusable footpaths, garbage-ridden walkways or other hazards, which are then displayed on a crowd-sourced map and ward-level grid visible to local authorities and residents. The goal, according to its creator, Surya Uthkarsha is simple: "Turn every citizen into a sensor for the city." **ROAD SAFETY** The app was born out of a personal experience. Surya said the idea traces back to an accident he was involved in and the broader concerns around road safety that led him to start The Marg Initiative, an organisation focused on road safety awareness that has worked with stakeholders including traffic police authorities and UNICEF. "With the



AWARENESS DRIVE. The platform takes an unconventional approach to civic participation

monsoon setting in, I realised how poor pedestrian infrastructure is in many parts of Bengaluru. There are platforms addressing issues like garbage, but footpaths are often ignored on a large scale," he told *businessline*. What makes Rasthe particularly noteworthy is not just the idea, but who built it. The app was created by

Surya, a 14-year-old student at National Public School, Bengaluru. The son of two doctors, he has already built an unusually diverse entrepreneurial portfolio for his age. **AI INFRASTRUCTURE** He is the founder of a stealth startup Flake, which focuses on AI infrastructure and design-to-code work-

flows, and has received a grant of around ₹7 lakh from Emergent Ventures, an initiative backed by Schmidt Futures and inspired by the Thiel Fellowship ecosystem. He is also the founding head of growth at Edza AI, an AI-based tutor for students, and founder of The Marg Initiative and Roadyz. The mobile version of Rasthe is currently under review on Apple's App Store, while its web version is functional. Surya said the platform had received its first reports and is currently being moderated manually to prevent misuse. "We haven't established a formal partnership with BBMP yet, but they already have citizen helplines. Our app makes reporting simple. With one click,

users can report an issue, and it becomes visible on a public map so others can verify it and collectively push for improvements," he said. For now, Surya reviews submissions himself every hour and removes irrelevant reports. As usage scales, he plans to introduce automated moderation tools that can identify and filter content unrelated to pedestrian infrastructure. Built in just four hours using the 10x Apps platform, Rasthe is simple. Yet its mix of gamification, crowd-sourced reporting and civic engagement could make it particularly appealing to Bengaluru residents, turning a daily frustration into a participatory effort to improve the city's streets.

The writer is an intern

